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National & States Affairs

News - 1

- AACL – to invest more than Rs 20,000 Cr in 1st phase of a large-scale airport city development programme
  - It spans over 655 acres across 6 airports in Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Lucknow, Jaipur & Guwahati
- AACL signed hotel management agreements with IHG Hotels & Resorts for 5 premium & luxury hotels
- Airport City projects have received LEED Gold pre-certification from US Green Building Council
- Adani Airport Holdings – manages 8 airports, including Mumbai & upcoming Navi Mumbai International Airport
- Adani Group – expanded into organic fertilizer sector with new brand, 'Harit Amrit', produced from agricultural waste
  - Through this brand, Adani Group expanded sales across Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh & Gujarat
- Adani TotalEnergies Biomass Ltd's Barsana project (UP) – being developed as India's largest agri-waste-based compressed biogas facility
- ATBL also secured municipal solid waste-to-CBG projects in Ahmedabad & Rajkot
- HQs of AAHL – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Whole-time Director – Arun Bansal | Non-Executive Director – Jeet Adani | Established in – 2019

News - 2

- Dr. Virendra Kumar – led concluding National Awareness Programme of 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah'
  - At Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV), Haridwar, Uttarakhand
  - Theme – "Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan - Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan"
- He led a 'Nasha Mukt Rally' & administered 'Pledge Against Drug Abuse' & 'Ageing with Dignity Pledge'
- DSJE + All World Gayatri Pariwar = an MoU to strengthen collaboration on awareness generation, community mobilisation, drug demand reduction & senior citizen welfare
- Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan (NMBA) – launched on Aug 15, 2020
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 3

- MoSPI – celebrated 20th Statistics Day at Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi
  - marking 133rd birth anniversary of Prof. Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis | Observed since 2007
- Theme 2026 – "Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data" | Chief Guest – Dr. P.K. Mishra (PS to PM)
- Key releases:
  - SDG National Indicator Framework (SDG-NIF) Progress Report 2026
  - SDG Data Snapshot 2026 - SDG-NIF 2026 (with metadata)
  - Labour Market Dynamics in Million-plus Cities
  - Urban Unincorporated Enterprise Landscape report

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- "Transforming Lives" SDG People Dimension bulletin
- Handbook on Harmonisation of Datasets
- MoSPI Vision Document 2026-2031

- Sukhatme National Award in Statistics 2026 – conferred to Arup Bose (Prof. Retd., Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata)
- Participation – ~500 officials from Central Ministries, NITI Aayog, States, UTs & domain experts
- 'NIF 2026' consists of 277 national SDG indicators, covering all 17 SDGs

News - 4

- Delhi Cabinet approved "Delhi EV Policy 2026" (EV Policy 2.0), w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026 until Mar 31, 2030
- From Jan 1, 2027, only electric three-wheelers & N1 goods carriers will be eligible for registration in Delhi
- From Apr 1, 2028, registration of new petrol & CNG-powered two-wheelers will be discontinued
  - Only electric two-wheelers – eligible for registration
- This policy primarily targets vehicle categories contributing most to vehicular pollution:
  - Commercial goods vehicles account for ~33% of vehicular pollution in Delhi
  - Two-wheelers & three-wheelers together contribute ~46%
  - Two-wheelers alone constitute nearly 67% of Delhi's total vehicle population
- It offers 100% exemption on road tax & registration fees for electric vehicles
- Purchase incentives include up to: ₹30,000 – for electric two-wheelers | ₹50,000 – for electric three-wheelers
  - ₹1 lakh – for N1 goods vehicles
- Scrappage incentives: ₹10,000 – two-wheelers | ₹25,000 – three-wheelers | ₹50,000 – N1 trucks
  - ₹1 lakh – four-wheelers, for BS-IV or older vehicles
- Delhi committed over ₹7,000 Cr over next 4 years for implementation
- It also targets installation of 32,000 active EV charging points & electrification targets for school bus fleets
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

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News - 5

- "Project BRAHMANK" of BRO – celebrated its 16th Raising Day at Ranaghat, East Siang district, Arunachal Pradesh
  - It was raised on – Jun 29, 2011 at Ranaghat | It became fully functional on – Dec 3, 2011
- It is responsible for development & maintenance of strategic road infrastructure across 5 districts of Arunachal Pradesh
  - Siang, East Siang, West Siang, Upper Siang & Shi-Yomi
- In FY26, Project BRAHMANK completed 13 bridges with a cumulative span of 390 metres across Siang & Siyom Valleys
- It is one of BRO's several projects in Arunachal Pradesh; others include 'Vartak', 'Arunank' & 'Udayak'
- BRO – established on May 7, 1960, under MoD, operates across 19 states, UTs & 3 friendly foreign countries
- HQs of BRO – New Delhi | DG – Lt. Gen. Harpal Singh

Join us

News - 6

- MIB announced 2 major structural initiatives to strengthen Indian film industry, increase cinema infrastructure & enhance global competitiveness of Indian cinema
- 1st initiative – constitution of a High-Level Study Group chaired by Prasoon Joshi (Chairman of Prasar Bharati)
  - It must submit its report to MIB within 3 months
- 2nd initiative – preparation & circulation of 'Model State Cinema Regulations' to all State Governments
- Minister of Information & Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

News - 7

- Amit Shah – launched "FCRA 2.0 Portal" & "Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card" in New Delhi
- It has been developed to simplify compliance under Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010 (FCRA)
- This portal is hosted on – National Government Cloud 'MeghRaj'
- e-OCI Card introduces a fully digital OCI ecosystem: entire OCI application process is now online
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

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News - 8

- GoI identified 25 of India's 58 Tiger Reserves as requiring priority interventions for tiger recovery
  - Announced at National Workshop on 'Tiger Re-introduction: Opportunities and Challenges'
- Bhupender Yadav released 3 key publications:
  (1) 'Road Map on Active Management of Tigers in India'
  (2) 'Booklet on Reintroduction and Recovery of Tigers in India'
  (3) 'Annual Report of Project Cheetah (September 2024-December 2025)'
- 3 key structural challenges identified: low prey density; fragmented habitat connectivity; & Left Wing Extremism (LWE)
- Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Bhupender Yadav | Constituency – Alwar, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Kirtivardhan Singh

News - 9

- Dr Jitendra Singh – inaugurated 3rd batch of "DAKSH (Development of Aspiration, Knowledge, Succession and Harmony)"
  - At – SCOPE Convention Centre, New Delhi
- DAKSH is jointly organised by = Standing Conference of Public Enterprises (SCOPE) + Capacity Building Commission (CBC)
  - Aim: To prepare senior executives of Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) for future Board-level responsibilities
  - Indian School of Business (ISB) – academic & knowledge partner
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

Join us

News - 10

- UIDAI inaugurated Nagaland's first "Aadhaar Seva Kendra (ASK)" in Dimapur
  - It is state's 1st Aadhaar facility to be directly established & operated by UIDAI
- It has been categorised as one of largest Category 'C' Aadhaar Seva Kendras in Northeast
- Aadhaar enrolment in Nagaland currently stands at around 67%
- HQs of UIDAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Neelkanth Mishra | CEO – Saurabh Vijay
- Nagaland: Capital – Kohima | CM – Neiphiu Rio | Governor – Nand Kishore Yadav

News - 11

- CCEA approved 2 national highway projects in UP & Delhi with a combined capital cost of ₹14,114.81 Cr
- Cabinet cleared construction of 117.7 km, 4/6-lane access-controlled Kanpur-Kabrai Greenfield Highway on NH-34 in UP
  - Capital cost – ₹7,145.14 Cr | To be implemented by – NHAI on BOT (Toll) mode
- Cabinet also approved a 6-lane road tunnel for NH-148AE connecting Dwarka Expressway (NH-248BB) with Nelson Mandela Marg in Vasant Kunj, Delhi
  - Capital cost – ₹6,969.67 Cr (on Hybrid Annuity Mode)
- Both projects are aligned with 'PM GatiShakti National Master Plan'

News - 12

- Ministry of Steel approved grant of 'Miniratna Category-I' status to MECON Ltd, a Schedule 'A' CPSE
- MECON reported continuous profits over last 3 financial years, with a Profit Before Tax (PBT) of:
  - ₹77.62 Cr – in FY24 (restated) | ₹32.08 Cr – in FY25 (restated) | ₹104.53 Cr – in FY26
  - A positive net worth – ₹535.42 Cr (as of Mar 31, 2026)
- Under Miniratna scheme introduced in Oct 1997, Category-I CPSEs must have posted profits continuously for 3 years
  - With a PBT of at least ₹30 Cr in one of those years & a positive net worth
- Minister of Steel & Heavy Industries: H. D. Kumaraswamy | Constituency – Mandaya, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Steel: Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

News - 13

- Bhupendra Patel – launched statewide "Namo Swachhata Abhiyan" & "Amritpan Abhiyan" from Civil Hospital campus in Gandhinagar
- Health & Family Welfare Department's 'Namo Swachhata Abhiyan' – comprises a 7-day statewide cleanliness drive
- 'Amritpan Abhiyan' – focuses on safeguarding maternal & child health
- They jointly released "Amritpan Abhiyan Guidelines" & an accompanying flip chart during launch event
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

Join us

News - 14

- West Bengal – added 23 more traditional products to its Geographical Indication (GI) portfolio
- Newly tagged products include:
  - 'Jalbhora' Sandesh from Chandernagore | 'Monohara' from Janai | Banglar 'Nolen Gur' | Kanakchur Popped Rice
  - Santiniketan Batik & Santiniketan Ektara from Birbhum | 'Mecha' Sandesh from Beliatore in Bankura
  - Krishnanagar Clay Doll | Sitalpati from Cooch Behar | Bengal Singing Bowl | Balagarh Boat from Hooghly
  - Kolkatti Jewellery from Kolkata | Khagra brass & bell-metal utensils | Ashapur Brinjal
  - Malda Silk | Wooden dolls | Conch shell craft | Cotton sarees
- Total GI products from West Bengal – 59
- India crossed 822 registered GI products as of May 2026, with UP leading at 83 & Tamil Nadu at 76
  - West Bengal – topped country in food-related GI registrations
- Darjeeling Tea – first product in country to receive a GI tag
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

News - 15

- Yogi Adityanath – launched statewide "Digi Rover (Digi Rover-GNSS) Special Land Measurement Campaign"
  - At Saharanpur (from Jul 1 to Aug 15, 2026)
- All pending cases of land demarcation & measurement across UP will be resolved using Digi Rover
  - It is a GNSS (Global Navigation Satellite System)-based instrument
- A dedicated GNSS Rover device has been provisioned for every tehsil in UP to enable simultaneous statewide coverage
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

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News - 16

- Govt raised procurement price of onions for Price Stabilisation Buffer by 13% to ₹2,125 per quintal, w.e.f. July 4, 2026
- Procurement of onions through NAFED & NCCF for government's Price Stabilisation Buffer is currently underway
- As per Second Advance Estimates of DAFW, onion production for 2025-26 – 307.37 lakh metric tonnes (LMT)

News - 17

- AAI developed & DGCA approved India's 1st Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure
  - For helicopter operations at Undavalli Heliport, Andhra Pradesh
  - It makes Undavalli 1st private heliport in India to receive approval for this advanced navigation procedure
- PinS procedures – specialised Instrument Flight Rules operations designed exclusively for helicopters
- GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation) satellite-based augmentation system – developed by ISRO, AAI & ICAO
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar
- HQs of DGCA – New Delhi | Director General – Vir Vikram Yadav

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News - 18

- 'Digital India Programme' – completed 11 years on Jul 1, 2026
  - Launched on – Jul 1, 2015, by PM Modi with 9-pillar vision
- Key milestones at 11-year mark across programme's pillars include:
  - Internet connections quadrupling to 1.02 billion from around 250 million in 2015
  - UPI processing 24,162 crore transactions in FY26
  - India emerging as world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer
- Electronics manufacturing sector grown to ₹13 lakh Cr with electronics becoming India's 3rd-largest export category
- Under India Semiconductor Mission (outlay: ₹76,000 Cr), 12 semiconductor manufacturing projects have been approved
  - Investment pipeline – ₹1.64 lakh Cr

News - 19

- Rekha Gupta – announced "Clean Air, Healthy Delhi" project, a ₹8,300 Cr, 7-year initiative (Sep 2026 to Aug 2033)
  - To combat air pollution in national capital | To be implemented in collaboration with – World Bank
  - Share of financial assistance: World Bank – 65% | Delhi Government – 35%
- This project, aligned with National Clean Air Programme (NCAP), rests on 2 central pillars:
  - Strengthening air quality management through a dedicated Project Management Unit
  - Reducing emissions from major pollution sources through phased removal of older, polluting vehicles
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor – Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

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News - 20

- MSJE released ₹24.06 Cr as Grant-in-Aid to 202 projects under "Atal Vayo Abhyudaya Yojana (AVYAY)"
  - It is a Central Government's umbrella scheme for welfare of senior citizens
- Dr Virendra Kumar (Min. for SJ&E) – also launched "JEEVAN" mobile application & "SHATAYU" dashboard
  - JEEVAN – Joint Elderly Empowerment and Virtual Assistance Network
  - SHATAYU – Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training For Your Utility
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 21

- Zoological Survey of India celebrated its 111th Foundation Day on Jun 30, 2026, at Dhano Dhanyo Auditorium, Kolkata
- ZSI inaugurated 4th edition of 3-day 'Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0)' from Jun 30 to Jul 2, 2026
  - Inaugurated by – Bhupender Yadav (Union Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change)
- MoEFCC released annual flagship publications 'Animal Discoveries-2025' & 'Plant Discoveries-2025'
  - Jointly prepared by – ZSI & Botanical Survey of India (BSI)

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- New faunal records added to India's biodiversity database in 2025 – 709
  - It comprises 483 species new to science & 226 species documented in India for 1st time
  - Now, India's total documented faunal wealth – 1,05,953 species
- Most regional discoveries – Kerala (98) | Followed by – West Bengal, Karnataka & Arunachal Pradesh
- ZSI unveiled Version 3.0 of 'Fauna of India Checklist' documenting 1,05,953 species & subspecies across 121 taxonomic inventories
- PaleoIndia Portal – also launched, documenting spatial distribution of fossil fauna across all 28 States & 8 UTs
  - Jointly developed with – National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management, Chennai
- '111-Hours Hackathon on Traditional Knowledge for Biodiversity Conservation' – organised across 16 regional centres
- ZSI formalised 4 MoUs with:
  - Centre for Marine Living Resources & Ecology (CMLRE) – for marine biodiversity research
  - Sathyabama Institute of Science & Technology – for marine ecology & bioindicator studies
  - Kalyani University – for inter-disciplinary research | Anthropological Survey of India (AnSI)
- Other publications released include Fauna of West Bengal, Jeev Darpan & faunal diversity studies of 5 West Bengal wildlife sanctuaries
- HQs of ZSI – Kolkata, West Bengal | Director – Dr. Dhriti Banerjee | Established in – 1916

News - 22

- Tamil Nadu School Education Department – reconstituted Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)
  - For school education through a Government Order (GO)
  - Dr. Mylswamy Annadurai (Moon Man of India) – appointed as its Chairperson (replacing - Dr. Sultan Ahmed Ismail)
- Now, it is a 17-member body with a 3-year tenure
- It has been mandated to develop State's curriculum & syllabus
- Director of State Council of Educational Research & Training (SCERT) – authorised to constitute sub-committees for syllabus development, textbook preparation & other academic activities
- Dr. Mylswamy Annadurai – currently serves as Vice President of Tamil Nadu State Council for Science & Technology
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 23

- Amit Shah announced plans to set up a cooperative life insurance company
  - While addressing 5th Foundation Day celebrations of Ministry of Cooperation at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- IFFCO-Tokio (incorporated in 2000) – a JV between IFFCO & Tokio Marine group (Japan)
- Govt would help establish a utility aggregator cooperative on lines of 'Bharat Taxi'
  - It is a ride-hailing platform operating under cooperative model through Sahakar Taxi Cooperative Ltd
- During this event, several other initiatives were launched, including:
  - Transfer of 135 godowns with a combined capacity of 75,000 tonnes

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- Inauguration of 85 godowns | Virtual foundation-laying for 47 additional grain storage godowns

- Ministry also marked transformation of 50,000 Primary Agricultural Cooperative Societies (PACS) into e-PACS
- Bharatiya Beej Sahakari Samiti Ltd + ICAR = an MoU to strengthen seed systems
  - alongside groundbreaking of BBSSL tissue culture facilities in Barabanki (UP) & Jalgaon (Maharashtra)
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 24

- Borjuli site (Sonitpur, Assam) – notified as a Biodiversity Heritage Site by National Biodiversity Authority
  - For harbouring a viable population of wild rice (Oryza rufipogon)
- Under project 'In-situ Conservation & Management of Wild Rice (Oryza rufipogon) in Sonitpur District of Assam'
  - Implemented since 2022 by ICAR-National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (ICAR-NBPGR)
  - In collaboration with – Assam State Biodiversity Board
  - Funded by – National Rainfed Area Authority (NRAA) under Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- Other notified Biodiversity Heritage Sites in Assam include: Majuli & Hajong Tortoise Lake (Dima Hasao district)
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

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News - 25

- CCRAS – launched 3 major initiatives during its 5th Executive Committee (EC) Meeting held in New Delhi
  - Chaired by – Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha (Secretary, Ministry of AYUSH)
- Initiatives include:
  - A Research Methodology Textbook – under 'Ayurved Prabodhini Granthamala' series
  - Expression of Interest (EoI) for 'CCRAS PRAYATNA 2026-27'
  - 'CCRAS Digital Ecosystem Dashboard'
- CCRAS – established in 1978 with its HQs in New Delhi | It is an apex body under Ministry of AYUSH
- Location of CCRAS – New Delhi | DG – Prof. Vaidya Rabinarayan Acharya

News - 26

- Grand finale of 2nd 'National Skill Olympiad on Seafood Value Addition' – held during 'Seafood Expo Bharat 2026' in Kochi
  - It is an initiative of Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA)
- P. Surya Bhaskar (Devi Fisheries Ltd, Kakinada, Andhra) – emerged as winner | He received a cash prize of ₹1,00,000
  - 2nd – Muthu Kumaran (Theva & Co Tuticorin, Tamil Nadu) (₹75,000)
  - 3rd – Sagarika Sardar of SS Seafoods Pvt Ltd (Kolkata) (₹50,000)
  - 4th – Barasarani Jena of Sabri Food Products Pvt Ltd (Bhubaneswar)
- 10 finalists were selected from regional rounds held in Mumbai (West Coast Zone) & Visakhapatnam (East Coast Zone)

Join us

- MPEDA conducted 50 Seafood Value Addition Training Programmes across India's east & west coasts
- HQs of MPEDA – Kochi, Kerala | Chairman – P. Jawahar | Established in – 1972

News - 27

- MoEF&CC notified Natural History Museum (NHM) at Mizoram University, Aizawl, as a Designated Repository
  - Under Section 39 of 'Biological Diversity Act, 2002' | It became India's 21st such repository
- NHM – established in 2022 under Mizoram University & is located within Indo-Burma Biodiversity Hotspot
- Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Bhupender Yadav | Constituency – Alwar, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Kirtivardhan Singh

News - 28

- 8 traditional products of Himachal Pradesh – registered as Geographical Indications (GIs)
  - Under 'Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999'
  - By Geographical Indications Registry under DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce & Industry
- Now, Himachal Pradesh's total portfolio of GI-tagged products – 17
- 8 newly registered products: Seabuckthorn (Chharma) from Spiti
  - Salooni Safed Makka (white maize) & Chamba Metal Art from Chamba
  - Sirmauri Loiya (a traditional woollen gown) from Sirmaur
  - Kinnauri Topi (traditional cap), Kinnauri Apple & Kinnauri Jewellery from Kinnaur
  - Sepuvadi (a traditional lentil-based dish) from Mandi
- 9 earlier GI-tagged products from Himachal Pradesh:
  - Kullu Shawl, Kangra Tea, Chamba Rumal, Kinnauri Shawl, Kangra Painting, Himachali Kalazeera, Himachali Chulli Oil, Chamba Chappal & Lahauli Knitted Socks & Gloves
- Himachal Pradesh is also pursuing GI registration for 4 more indigenous products:
  - Bhot Jau (barley from Pangi, Chamba) | Chamba Chukh
  - Plectranthus Honey from Bharmour region of Chamba | Sirmaur Ginger
- HP: Capital – Shimla & Dharamshala | CM – Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu | Governor – Kavinder Gupta

News - 29

- 17th "Toy Biz International B2B Expo 2026" in New Delhi – organised by Toy Association of India
- India's toy market – currently projected to reach $5 billion by 2034
- India's current toy exports value – reached $186 million in 2025-26
- National Action Plan for Toys – developed in 2020 & reinforced through FY26 Budget
  - It is being implemented in collaboration with 14 central ministries & departments
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

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News - 30

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan (Min. for AF&W) – launched "PRAGATI", in New Delhi
  - To empower 20,000 agri-entrepreneurs & support 20 lakh small & marginal farmers across India
- PRAGATI will be implemented across 8 key agricultural states – MP, Bihar, UP, Assam, WB, Jharkhand, MH & Rajasthan
- It is backed by a coalition of institutions, including PepsiCo Foundation, SBIF, Gates Foundation, IDH, Heifer International, EDF, Global Agri Entrepreneurship Academy, SAFIA, AEGF & Transform Rural India Foundation (TRIF)
- Minister of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Ram Nath Thakur & Bhagirath Choudhary

News - 31

- MoTA – launched "TribeX" at National Workshop on Strengthening Tribal Research Institutes in Bhubaneswar, Odisha
  - It is India's 1st dedicated digital learning platform for tribal arts, culture, traditional knowledge & skill development
  - Launched by – Jual Oram (Union Minister for Tribal Affairs)
- TribeX currently hosts 20 free certificate courses across tribal art forms
- MoTA + Sampurnanand Sanskrit Vishwavidyalaya, Varanasi = an MoU to develop these diploma programmes
- Minister of Tribal Affairs: Jual Oram | Constituency – Sundergarh, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Tribal Affairs: Durgadas Uikey

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News - 32

- Kutch Copper Limited (AEL) – earned London Metal Exchange (LME) certification for 'Adani Copper' Grade-A Cathodes
  - Warrants for eligible cathodes becoming eligible for issuance against LME Copper futures contracts from Jul 10, 2026
- It designates Adani Copper as an LME Good Delivery brand under 'Copper Grade A' contract category
- KCL operates $1.2 billion custom copper smelting facility at Mundra, Gujarat, with a capacity of 0.5 mn tonnes per annum
- HQs of Kutch Copper Limited – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | MD – Dr. Vinay Prakash | Incorporated in – 2021

News - 33

- Sirsa Kinnow (Haryana) – granted a GI tag by GI Registry, Chennai
  - It became Haryana's 1st fruit & 1st exclusive GI product to receive such recognition
- Kinnow – a hybrid citrus fruit, developed in 1915 by H.B. Frost at University of California Citrus Experimentation Station
  - From a cross between 'King' (Citrus nobilis) & 'Willow Leaf' mandarin (Citrus deliciosa) varieties
- Punjab – holds largest area under kinnow cultivation | Followed by – Rajasthan, Haryana, MP, HP & J&K
- India's GI framework operates under – Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999
- Darjeeling Tea – India's first registered GI, in 2004-05
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh

Join us

News - 34

- MHFW notified Navi Mumbai Airport in Maharashtra as an authorised port for import of drugs under Drugs Rules, 1945
  - Through an amendment to Rule 43A of Rules
- Now, number of notified ports of entry for import of drugs across air, sea, road & rail routes – increased to 42
- Navi Mumbai International Airport – inaugurated in Oct 2025
  - It is one of India's largest greenfield airport projects, developed under a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 35

- Govt – rolled out upgraded Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01) platform for EPFO
- This upgrade would enable crediting of provident fund interest for 2025-26 by July 15, 2026
- Interest at 8.25% for 2025-26 will be auto-processed for 34 crore member accounts & verified by field authorities
  - Amounting to estimated – ₹1.44 lakh Cr
- CITES 2.01 project – approved by Central Board of Trustees in 2021
- Under revised framework: Claim settlements will be processed through a centralised system
  - Interest on final settlements will now be computed up to date of payment authorisation
  - Members will be able to withdraw up to 75% of their provident fund balance
- Auto-settlement limit for eligible advance claims – raised to ₹5 lakh for fully KYC-compliant members (from ₹1 lakh)
- Aadhaar-linked Universal Account Number holders will benefit from automatic PF account transfers when changing jobs
- Under Centralised Pension Payment System (CPPS), EPS pensioners can now submit Life Certificates at any EPFO office & receive pensions in any bank account across India

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News - 36

- Kamarajar Port Limited (Tamil Nadu) – became India's 2nd major port to offer an operational draft of 18 metres
  - Following successful completion of its Capital Dredging Phase VI project | 1st – Visakhapatnam Port
- It can now accommodate fully laden Capesize vessels carrying cargo parcels of up to 1,70,000 Deadweight Tonnage
- Dredging project was undertaken at an investment of – ₹440 Cr

News - 37

- Bhupender Yadav inaugurated Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict at Wildlife Institute of India-Sálim Ali Centre for Ornithology & Natural History (WII-SACON), Coimbatore
- He also launched National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal
- National Workshop on Human-Wildlife Conflict – also held
- National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal – a digital platform to improve data management, knowledge sharing & decision-making for conflict mitigation across India

Join us

- 1st edition of a publication series titled 'Current Status of Human-Wildlife Conflict in India: An Overview' was also released during event
- Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Bhupender Yadav | Constituency – Alwar, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Kirtivardhan Singh

News - 38

- Gujarat launched "Viksit Gujarat - Data Centre Policy 2026-29" in Gandhinagar
  - It is India's 1st dedicated state-level data centre policy
- Aim: To attract investments in hyperscale data centres, AI infrastructure & digital services
- Gujarat's existing infrastructure includes 69 GW of installed power capacity (47 GW comes from renewable energy)
- India generates nearly 20% of world's data but accounts for only around 3% of global data centre capacity
  - US & China together hold about 70% of worldwide capacity
- Gujarat's target is to become a $3.5 trillion economy by 2047
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 39

- Andhra Pradesh – to electrify entire fleet of Andhra Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (APSRTC) by 2029
  - Under AP Sustainable Electric Mobility Policy 4.0 (SEMP 4.0)
- Centre separately sanctioned 1,050 electric buses for Andhra Pradesh under PM eBus Sewa Scheme
  - To be procured by – Convergence Energy Services Ltd (CESL) under Gross Cost Contract (GCC) model
- Andhra Pradesh – approved procurement of 1,450 further electric buses & 500 CNG buses through direct purchase
- Centre sanctioned ₹145.3 crore towards its 1,050-bus tranche
- APSRTC is introducing India's 1st 'Dry Lease' model for electric buses to utilise surplus drivers
- Under Centre's FAME-II scheme, APSRTC already rolled out 100 electric buses on Tirupati, Nellore & Kadapa routes
  - Operating at a cost of around ₹50 per km
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 40

- SEBI notified "SEBI (Custodian) (Amendment) Regulations, 2026"
  - It replaces existing annual fee mechanism for custodians with a monthly fee payment system, w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026
- Now, custodians will pay a monthly fee of ₹85,000, or 0.0000416% of their Assets Under Custody, whichever is higher
  - From ₹10 lakh, or 0.0005% of AUC, whichever is higher
- Monthly fee must be paid within 15 days from end of each month
- Custodians registered on or after Oct 1, 2026 will pay a proportionate monthly fee for month of registration
- SEBI received ~₹175.80 Cr in annual custodian fees for FY26
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 41

- JP Nadda – to lay foundation stone of ICMR Centre for High Altitude Medicine & Public Health Research at Keylong, HP
  - It marks India's 1st dedicated institution for high-altitude medicine & public health research
- It is being established by – Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- ICMR – established in 1911 as Indian Research Fund Association & renamed in 1949
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 42

- GoI approved establishment of a 'Street Food Hub' at Lakhanpur, in Kathua, J&K, under PM SVANidhi initiative
- Lakhanpur hub – to be developed across 2 clusters in Lakhanpur Market
  - One near Old Bus Stand | Other near Sales Tax Office
- Street Food Hub initiative follows a Whole-of-Government approach, with convergence between: MoHUA + MoT + FSSAI

News - 43

- Chitkara University – launched "Atal Incubation Centre - Chitkara Incubation Foundation (AIC-CIF)" & "AIC-PRIDE Labs" at its Punjab campus
- Combined investment: Up to ₹20 Cr over 5 years – by AIM, NITI Aayog & Chitkara University
- Location of Chitkara University – Chandigarh, Punjab | Chancellor – Dr. Ashok K. Chitkara

  Vice Chancellor – Dr. Sandhir Sharma | Established in – 1997

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News - 44

- Delhi made Pink Saheli smart card mandatory for women to avail free bus travel on DTC & cluster buses from Aug 1
- Delhi Govt established 50 authorised centres across city to facilitate issuance of smart cards, based on NCMC technology
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

News - 45

- CCI imposed a penalty of ₹126.87 Cr on HP India Sales Pvt Ltd
  - For cartelisation & bid rigging in sale & supply of personal system products
- Combined penalty of ~₹1.22 Cr imposed on 5 resellers found to have acted in collusion with HP India
  - Delphi Infosolutions, Digitech Computers, Orbit Techsol, Hind Technocare & Krishna Computer
- CCI imposed a penalty of ₹11.98 Cr on HP India & ~₹2.30 Cr combined on 16 resellers
  - For cartelisation in sale & supply of printer supplies
- HQs of CCI – New Delhi | Chairperson – Ravneet Kaur | DG – Rakesh Bhanot (acting) | Established in – October 2003

Join us

News - 46

- CPWD – celebrated its 172nd Annual Day at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
- Manohar Lal (Union Min.) – unveiled "SANKALP" framework as guiding vision
  - S – Speed | A – Accessibility | N – Nekneeyat (good intent) | K – Kartavyanishtha (dedication to duty)
  - A – Adoption of Technology | L – Lokhit (public welfare) | P – Pardarshita (transparency)
- He also released several publications, including: 'India's Urban Transformation: Reflections from Policy and Practice'
  - Nirman Bharati (department's annual in-house publication) | e-NIRMIT ERP Modules

News - 47

- Unjha Cumin (Jeera) & Unjha Fennel (Variyali) from Gujarat – received GI tags from GIR India
- Registration has been made in name of Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC), Unjha
  - Under Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 48

- Sarbananda Sonowal – launched a "Seafarer-First" initiative to safeguard Indian seafarers
- He also directed appointment of a dedicated liaison officer for every affected Indian seafarer
- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam
  - MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

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News - 49

- MeitY + DFI = launched 2nd "National Innovation Challenge for Drone Application & Research (NIDAR 2.0) 2026-27"
  - Under – SwaYaan initiative
- VEGA processor – a family of indigenous microprocessors designed by C-DAC
  - Under – MeitY's Microprocessor Development Programme
- NIDAR 2.0 offers a prize pool of over ₹65 lakh
- SwaYaan capacity-building initiative – approved by MeitY in Jul 2022 | Outlay – ~₹90 Cr over 5 years
- 1st edition of NIDAR – launched in Mar 2025, attracted 3,448 students from 22 states, 4 UTs & 109 cities
  - 93 teams reached grand finale & 24 teams won prizes worth ₹40 lakh in total
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  - MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 50

- Droupadi Murmu inaugurated 'Saushrutam 2026' at All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA), New Delhi
- She also inaugurated a state-of-the-art AI-enabled 3 Tesla High-Field MRI facility at AIIA | Cost – ₹14.5 Cr
- It is a 3-day international seminar on Ayurvedic surgery, hosted by AIIA, from Jul 15 to 17, 2026

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- President also witnessed release of a national research study titled 'Evaluation of Professional Career of Ayurveda Female Graduates – An Observational Exploratory Study'
  - Conducted by – National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM), Ministry of Ayush

News - 51

- Cabinet approved "Semicon 2.0" for long-term development of India's semiconductor design/manufacturing ecosystem
  - Outlay – ₹1,27,500 Cr
- It provides differentiated fiscal subsidies for manufacturing, including:
  - 40% support on eligible capital expenditure for silicon fabrication plants | 25% for conventional packaging units
  - 35% for compound semiconductor & display fabs | 35% for advanced packaging facilities
- It is expected to catalyse an additional ₹4 lakh Cr in private investment
- India's first semiconductor fabrication plant – scheduled to be commissioned in 2028
- Under 'Semicon 1.0', 12 manufacturing units have already been approved | Cumulative investment – ₹1.64 lakh Cr

News - 52

- CCEA approved 2 railway multi-tracking projects covering 4 districts across Odisha & Jharkhand | Cost – ₹3,907 Cr
  - It will increase existing Indian Railways network by about 145 km
- 2 projects are targeted for completion by FY31 & comprise: Doubling of Paradeep-Haridaspur line
  - Construction of a fourth line on Rajkharsawan-Dangoaposi route
- These projects are planned under PM-Gati Shakti National Master Plan

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News - 53

- CCEA approved National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 for Atmanirbhar Bharat (NIPU-2026)
  - To encourage new investments in Urea sector for setting up gas-based Urea manufacturing units in India
- NIPU-2026 replaces New Investment Policy (NIP)-2012, under which 6 new Urea units had been established, comprising:
  - 4 units – set up through JV Companies of nominated PSUs | 2 units – by private companies
- Key changes under NIPU-2026 include: Separation of fixed & variable costs for greater transparency
  - Introduction of a Return on Equity (RoE) band with a floor of 12% & a ceiling of 16%
  - Mitigation of foreign exchange risk through conversion of fixed costs into Indian rupees after 4 years based on prevailing exchange rates
- India currently has 33 operational Urea manufacturing units | Total reassessed installed capacity – 269.42 LMT
- 8-9 new Urea manufacturing plants are expected to be established under this new policy
  - Each with a production capacity of – about 12.7 lakh metric tonnes

Join us

News - 54

- Mera Yuva Bharat (MoYA&S) – to organise Viksit Bharat Yuva Connect Programme (VBYCP) across universities & colleges
  - From Jul 16 to Aug 15, 2026 | Theme – 'Nasha Mukt Yuva for Viksit Bharat'
  - To connect young citizens with vision of Viksit Bharat@2047
- MY Bharat – launched by PM Modi on Oct 31, 2023, to mark National Unity Day
  - It is a flagship youth engagement platform for citizens aged 15 to 29
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 55

- MoPSW accorded in-principle approval to 2 strategic maritime infrastructure projects in Gujarat
  - Under Shipbuilding Development Scheme (SbDS), as part of Government's Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047
- 1st project – a Greenfield Shipbuilding Cluster to be developed at Kuchhadi in Porbandar
  - Through – National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park-Gujarat (NSHIP-Gujarat)
  - NSHIP-Gujarat – an SPV jointly promoted by MoPSW & Gujarat Maritime Board
- 2nd project – a ₹1,570 Cr ship repair facility at Vadinar in Gulf of Kutch
  - To be jointly developed by – Cochin Shipyard Ltd & Deendayal Port Authority
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam

  MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

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News - 56

- Dr Jitendra Singh – launched Phase-III of Biomedical Research Career Programme (BRCP) | Outlay – ₹1,500 Cr
  - It comprises: ₹1,000 Cr – from DBT | ₹500 Cr – from Wellcome Trust, UK
- Phase-III will be implemented through DBT-Wellcome Trust India Alliance, a dedicated Special Purpose Vehicle
- BRCP – launched in 2008-2009 & expanded under Phase II in 2018-19
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 57

- Ashwini Vaishnaw – announced 8 more structural reforms under Centre's 'Reform Express' initiative
  - To modernise Indian Railways' freight ecosystem | Now, total number of reforms implemented so far – 17
- A key reform introduces containerised transportation of fly ash in ISO-standard closed containers
  - India generates ~340 million tonnes of fly ash annually (rail currently transports only ~13 million tonnes)
- Indian Railways also overhauled its Container Train Operator (CTO) licensing framework
- Other reforms include: Simplified, rationalised per-tonne-per-kilometre freight tariffs for fertiliser transportation
- Minister of Railways: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha

  MoS in Ministry of Railways: V. Somanna & Ravneet Singh

Join us

News - 58

- NIFTEM-T (MoFPI) – launched a pilot 'Short-Term Skill Training Programme (STSTP) on Assistant Baking Technician'
  - It is a National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF) Level 3 certificate course
  - In coordination with – ITC Ltd's Integrated Consumer Goods Manufacturing & Logistics (ICML) facility in Trichy
- NIFTEM-Thanjavur, TN – an NCVET-recognised Deemed Awarding Body
- NIFTEM-Thanjavur – established in 1967 & formerly known as 'Indian Institute of Food Processing Technology'
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 59

- C. Joseph Vijay (TN CM) – launched "Nalam TN", an integrated digital healthcare platform
  - To facilitate quick & remote outpatient registration & appointments at government medical facilities across TN
- NalamAI (chatbot) – operating under Tamil Nadu National Health Mission & is available in both English & Tamil
  - It is currently live on a pilot basis in 22 districts
- He also inaugurated healthcare infrastructure worth ₹139.47 Cr
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 60

- Submer Group (Spain) – announced an investment of $2 billion in Madhya Pradesh
  - Unveiled at MP Tech Growth Conclave 3.0: GCC - Data Centres & Semiconductors, held in Bhopal
- Submer Group – specialises in immersion cooling technology for data centres & high-performance computing systems
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

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News - 61

- Blackstone – launched its Asia-Pacific (APAC) infrastructure platform, "Blackstone Infrastructure Partners"
- Ami Momaya – appointed as MD & Head of Infrastructure for India (based in Mumbai)
- HQs of Blackstone – New York, USA | Chairman & CEO – Stephen A. Schwarzman | Established in – 1985

News - 62

- Arjun Ram Meghwal – launched "e-VSP Portal of Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan (VSP)" at an event held at Kartavya Bhawan-2, New Delhi
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Law & Justice: Arjun Ram Meghwal | Constituency – Bikaner, Rajasthan

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News - 63

- ICAR – celebrated its 98th Foundation Day at Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium, NASC Complex, New Delhi
- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – unveiled a roadmap for 'Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan' as a key pillar of Viksit Bharat 2047
  - He announced 7 goals to make Indian agriculture more climate-resilient, technology-driven & globally competitive
- 'One Institute-One Grand Innovation' programme – introduced establishing an ICAR Open Digital Knowledge Platform
  - Target – to generate ₹10,000 Cr in internal resources by 2029
- HQs of ICAR – New Delhi | DG – Mangi Lal Jat | Established in – 1929

News - 64

- Pralhad Joshi – inaugurated 'White Rabbit Technology'-based "IST Distribution Demonstration Network"
  - At – Regional Reference Standards Laboratory (RRSL), Jakkur, Bengaluru
  - Under Government's 'One Nation, One Time' initiative
  - To establish a uniform, highly precise & secure IST distribution system across country
- Demonstration network has been developed jointly by – Department of Consumer Affairs, CSIR-NPL & ISRO
  - Legal Metrology Division of Ministry of Consumer Affairs – serving as nodal agency for this project

News - 65

- PM Narendra Modi – inaugurated India's 1st indigenously built hydrogen fuel cell train "NaMo Green Rail" at Jind railway station, Haryana
- The 10-coach train comprises 2 hydrogen-powered driving cars & 8 passenger coaches
  - It will operate on the 89-km Jind-Sonipat section of Northern Railway, making 2 return trips daily
- It can carry a maximum of around 2,600 passengers at speeds of up to 75 km/h
  - Powered by – 3,200-horsepower propulsion system (that makes it among the longest & most powerful hydrogen-powered passenger trains in the world)
- Hydrogen fuel cell technology generates onboard electricity through hydrogen-oxygen chemical reaction, emitting only water vapour & heat
- Jind facility – India's largest railway hydrogen storage & refuelling facility with indigenous storage capacity of ~3,000 kg hydrogen produced through electrolysis
- The train was developed under 'Make in India' initiative by = ICF + RDSO
- With this, India joined hydrogen train operating countries including Germany, Japan, China & US

News - 66

- Ladakh LG V. K. Saxena – commissioned India's 1st & deepest geothermal wells at Puga Valley, Ladakh
  - Executed by – ONGC Energy Centre
- 2 wells drilled to 1,000m depth each at >14000 ft altitude under challenging geographical & climatic conditions
- The wells are critical for the implementation of the 1 MW pilot geothermal power project at Puga,

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- It will be India's first demonstration-scale geothermal power project

- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

News - 67

- DGFT (Ministry of Commerce & Industry) – amended 'Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023' to prohibit import of goods produced/manufactured wholly or partly through forced labour
- FTP 2023 inserted Paragraph 2.20B, empowering Central Govt to prohibit specific goods imports after DGFT enquiry or relevant material review
- 'Forced Labour' defined under new Paragraph 11.64 of FTP 2023 in accordance with ILO Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29)
- Implementation: Provisions effective 30 days after Official Gazette publication | no immediate product/country ban, future bans possible after DGFT investigations
- The move is linked with USTR Section 301 investigations against 60 economies including India over enforcement of forced labour import bans
- India had earlier banned forced labour domestically in 1976, through the 'Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act'
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal | Established in – 1991

News - 68

- UP – launched 2 digital platforms, 'Kaushal Setu' & 'Kaushal Sarathi', under UP Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)
  - At "World Youth Skills Day 2026" held at – Indira Gandhi Pratishthan, Lucknow, UP
- Inaugurated by – Kapil Dev Agarwal (MoS (I/C) for Vocational Education, Skill Development & Entrepreneurship)
- Kaushal Setu – serves as official digital portal of UPSDM
- Kaushal Sarathi – provides information on district-wise training centres, skill courses & training partners
- UPSDM – signed MoUs with KLK Pvt Ltd & Winsome Textile Industries Ltd
  - To support skill training & employment opportunities in emerging sectors
- He also released a coffee table book titled 'Skilling the Future Uttar Pradesh: Journey from Training to Transformation'
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 69

- Amit Shah – inaugurated 1st phase of 'Museum of Word', aka 'Shabdalok', at National Library campus in Kolkata
  - Developed by – National Library (under aegis of Union Culture Ministry)
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

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News - 70

- India – formally accepted WTO's Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies & became 123rd member to join this pact
- Rajesh Agrawal (Commerce Secretary) – deposited India's Instrument of Acceptance with WTO DG Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala
- Agreement – adopted by consensus at WTO's 12th Ministerial Conference in Geneva in Jun 2022
  - It is 1st multilateral WTO accord with an environmental sustainability objective & entered into force on Sep 15, 2025
- HQs of WTO – Geneva, Switzerland | 7th DG – Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala (Nigeria) | Members – 166 | Founded – 1995

News - 71

- India – approved 1st dengue vaccine, 'QDENGA', after DCGI granted authorisation to Takeda Biopharmaceuticals India
- It has been approved for individuals aged 4 to 60 years & can be administered regardless of prior dengue infection
- QDENGA – a live-attenuated tetravalent vaccine, designed to protect against all four dengue virus serotypes
  - DENV-1 | DENV-2 | DENV-3 | DENV-4
- HQs of DCGI – New Delhi | Drugs Controller General of India – Dr. Rajeev Singh Raghuvanshi | Established in – 1988

News - 72

- IAMAI – launched the "E-Commerce Council of India (ECCI)" in New Delhi
  - a first-of-its-kind national platform aimed at advancing India's digital commerce ecosystem
- India's digital commerce market – estimated at over $120 billion
- ECCI has so far onboarded 70 to 80 members – including major companies such as Amazon, Flipkart, IndiaMART, ixigo, Uber, Rapido, Shiprocket, eBay, Urban Company & Meesho
- HQs of IAMAI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – MN Srinivasu | President – Subho Ray | Established in – 2004

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News - 73

- NCVET – recognised National Institute of Rural Development & Panchayati Raj as an Awarding Body under Dual category
- NIRD&PR – an autonomous organisation under Ministry of Rural Development, established in 1958 & HQs in Hyderabad
- Dual category of recognition – available only to Government Awarding Bodies
- NCVET – notified in Dec 2018 as overarching regulator for India's technical & vocational education & training ecosystem
- HQs of NCVET – New Delhi | Chaiman – Debashree Mukherjee

News - 74

- Ministry of Coal – released "AAROH - Annual Report on Mine Closure" in New Delhi
  - a comprehensive account of coal mines scientifically closed in the country (with 42 such mines closed so far)
- Ministry of Coal + GIZ (Germany) = an Implementation Agreement to strengthen technical cooperation on closure of coal mines yet to be shut
- Coal NEER packaged drinking water plants – also inaugurated
  - Established by – Coal India Limited to provide safe & affordable drinking water to residents of coal-bearing regions

Join us

- Bharat Coking Coal Ltd + Hindalco Industries Ltd + Rajdhani Universal Fabrics Pvt Ltd = a tripartite MoU
  - To launch vocational training facilities under revised Jharia Master Plan
- Minister of Coal & Mines: G. Kishan Reddy | Constituency – Secunderabad, Telangana
  MoS in Ministry of Coal & Mines: Satish Chandra Dubey

News - 75

- Jyotiraditya M. Scindia + Conrad K. Sangma = launched 'Mission Golden Spice - Integrated Lakadong Turmeric Value Chain Enhancement Project' at Sanchar Bhavan, New Delhi
  - Outlay – ₹175.45 Cr
- Launched under Ministry's 'Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP)' initiative
- It will be implemented in two phases – Value Chain Strengthening | Expansion & Scale-up
  - It is anchored by – MDoNER & North Eastern Council
- Lakadong turmeric (a GI tagged product of Meghalaya) – world's highest naturally occurring curcumin content
- Aim: To nearly triple cultivation area & build a ₹100 Cr Lakadong Turmeric economy by FY29
- Meghalaya: Capital – Shillong | CM – Conrad Kongkal Sangma | Governor – CH Vijayashankar
- Minister of DoNER: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia | Constituency – Guna, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of DoNER: Sukanta Majumdar

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News - 76

- NeVA Sewa Kendras (aka 'e-Facilitation Centres') – established in 22 Legislative Houses across the country so far
- NeVA Public Portal (available in 23 languages) – provides citizens with online access to legislative business
- National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) Sewa Kendras – operate under Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs
- Minister of Parliamentary Affairs: Kiren Rijiju | Constituency – Arunachal West, Arunachal Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs: Arjun Ram Meghwal & L. Murugan

News - 77

- MIB – launched Pilot Phase of "Gems of India" Challenge
  - To identify, nurture & promote grassroots digital creators from across the country
- Under this Challenge, creators can submit original videos via MyWAVES section of WAVES OTT platform
  - Showcasing culture, heritage, tourism, traditions, history & distinctive achievements of their districts
  - Duration – 1 to 3 minutes
- Submission window – to remain open from Aug 1 to 31, 2026
- Awards will be presented at 3 levels, comprising: Up to 20 district-level awards – ₹50,000 each in every district
  - ₹2 lakh – at state level | ₹5 lakh – at national level
- Minister of Information & Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

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News - 78

- Rajnath Singh virtually flagged off "Samudra Pradakshina" from Gateway of India, Mumbai
  - It is a historic Tri-service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition (described as 1st of its kind in world)
- In 9 months, 10 women officers were to sail aboard indigenously built IASV Triveni, constructed in Puducherry
  - Easterly route of ~26,000 nautical miles, crossing Equator twice & rounding 3 great Capes, Leeuwin, Horn & Good Hope
- Earlier milestones in circumnavigation history include: Sir Robin Knox-Johnston of UK in 1969
  - Captain Dilip Donde (India's 1st solo circumnavigation in 2009-10)
  - Commander Abhilash Tomy (1st Indian to circumnavigate non-stop in 2012-13)
  - Indian Navy's Navika Sagar Parikrama (2017-18) & Navika Sagar Parikrama-II (2024-25) aboard INSV Tarini
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 79

- Government issued orders for removal of certain Battery Management System (BMS) mobile apps
  - that enabled unauthorised remote control of e-rickshaw batteries
- MeitY directed Google & Apple to take down several identified apps
- Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) – national agency for responding to cybersecurity incidents
  - Under Section 70B of Information Technology Act, 2000
- National Cyber Coordination Centre – monitors cyberspace to detect threats
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

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News - 80

- 'Let's Fix Our Food (LFOF) Consortium' (led by ICMR-NIN, Hyderabad) – released a policy document
  - "Priority Policy Actions to Promote Healthier Diets and Food Environments for Children and Adolescents in India"
- Launched by – Dr M. Srinivas (Member (Health), NITI Aayog)
  - During 'LFOF Dissemination and Consultation Workshop' – held at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
- LFOF Consortium – a multi-institutional platform led by ICMR-NIN

News - 81

- DIBD + Goa = organised "BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop" in Panaji
  - To advance multilingual AI & strengthen language-first DPI, with a special focus on Konkani language
- HQs of Bhashini – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag
- Goa: Capital – Panaji | CM – Pramod Sawant | Governor – Pusapati Ashok Gajapathi Raju

Join us

News - 82

- Microsoft India + FITT (IIT Delhi) = unveiled "UNNATI AI 2.0", aka "Unnati se Pragati", a flagship CSR initiative
- Aim: To strengthen India's AI innovation ecosystem at grassroots level
- 1st edition of Unnati AI initiative – launched in Apr 2025 & generated a portfolio valuation of around ₹1,690 Cr
- Director of IIT Delhi – Prof. Rangan Banerjee
- HQs of Microsoft – Washington, US | Chairman & CEO – Satya Nadella | Founded in – 1975
  President of Microsoft India – Puneet Chandok

News - 83

- Indian Railways – electrified 99.6% of its Broad Gauge (BG) network
- India – world's 2nd-most electrified major railway system (1st – Switzerland with 100% railway electrification)
- Indian Railways – also commissioned over 1,260 MW of solar & wind power capacity to support low-carbon operations
- 10 states, along with 15 railway zones – achieved 100% electrification
- Railway electrification in India began in 1925 | 1st electric train ran between Bombay Victoria Terminus & Kurla
- HQs of Indian Railways – New Delhi | Chairman & CEO – Satish Kumar

News – 84

- Killai (Tamil Nadu) – became state's 1st fully operational Climate Resilient Village, under TN Climate Change Mission
- Climate Resilient Villages (CRV) project – launched in 2023 under Tamil Nadu Climate Change Mission
  - To enhance adaptive capacity of rural areas to withstand climate change
  - Implemented in collaboration with – World Resources Institute (WRI)
  - Coordinated by – Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC), a Special Purpose Vehicle
  - It has been recognised as a model best practice in Economic Survey of India for 2025-26
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 85

- Govt aims to bring at least 5 indigenous Small Modular Reactors (SMRs) into operation by 2033
  - As part of Nuclear Energy Mission (announced in Union Budget 2025-26)
- Parliament enacted SHANTI Act, 2025, which opens nuclear energy sector to private participation
- Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC) undertook design & development of three SMR models (with target sites):
  - 220 MWe Bharat Small Modular Reactor (BSMR-200) – Tarapur, Maharashtra
  - 55 MWe Small Modular Reactor (SMR-55) – Tarapur, Maharashtra
  - An up to 5 MWth High Temperature Gas Cooled Reactor (HTGCR) – Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh
- India's current nuclear power capacity of 8.78 GW is expected to reach around 22 GW by 2031-32
- Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL) is planning to add a further 32 GW beyond 2032
  - Using indigenous Pressurised Heavy Water Reactor (PHWR) & Light Water Reactor (LWR) technology

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- Outlay of overall SMR programme – ~₹20,000 Cr
  - ₹5,960 Cr – proposed for design & development of BSMR-200
  - ₹7,000 Cr – earmarked for realising two units of SMR-55

News - 86

- Centre approved two Electronics Manufacturing Clusters (EMCs) in Tamil Nadu, at Manallur & Pillapaikkam
  - Combined investment – over ₹1,012 Cr
- Electronics production in India – rose to ₹13.11 lakh Cr in 2025-26 (from ₹1.9 lakh Cr in 2014-15)
  - Electronics exports of India (for same duration) – rose to ₹4.24 lakh Cr (from ₹38,000 Cr)
- Mobile phone production – rose to ₹6.27 lakh Cr | Exports – ₹2.59 lakh Cr
- 12 semiconductor manufacturing projects have been approved across 6 states under 'Semicon India Programme'
  - Investment commitments – ~₹1.64 lakh Cr
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 87

- Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Grp – to invest ₹600+ Cr to establish integrated superalloy manufacturing facility in Telangana
  - It is planned at – Hardware Park near Hyderabad International Airport
  - It will have an annual production capacity of around 5,000 tonnes
- HQs of Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Siva Arvinth

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News - 88

- Bihar + MSDE = to establish a permanent campus of National Skill Training Institute for Women (NSTI-W), Patna
  - To be developed at Bihta, Bihar | Investment – ₹99.97 Cr
- Bihar + MSDE = an MoU for establishment of Skill India International Centre in Bihar
  - Supported by a capital investment of – around ₹7 Cr from GoI
- NSTI-W Patna – currently only Central Government-operated skill training institute dedicated to women in Bihar
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship: Jayant Chaudhary | Constituency – Mathura, UP

News - 89

- GoI relaxed its FDI rules for e-commerce sector
  - It allowed foreign-funded e-commerce entities to operate inventory-based models for export of goods manufactured or produced in India
- Now, foreign-funded e-commerce companies can purchase products directly from Indian manufacturers, hold inventory & export goods to overseas customers through their own supply chains

Join us

News - 90

- Vizhinjam International Seaport (Thiruvananthapuram) – secured final approval from CBIC to commence EXIM cargo operations, w.e.f. Aug 18, 2026
- EXIM cargo handling – must be moved directly from port terminal to importer's premises within 48 hours of landing
  - No Less-than-Container Load cargo, loose cargo, or containers requiring de-stuffing or CFS examination will be permitted until a designated CFS becomes operational
- Developed by (under PPP model) – Kerala Govt + Adani Ports & Special Economic Zone

News - 91

- Piyush Goyal announced setting up of a task force to support India's toy sector
  - To identify interventions to help country achieve a 5% share of global toy market by 2032
- 'Team Up for Toys: Driving SCALE, Innovation and Exports' – organised by DPIIT, at Vanijya Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Toy Sector Playbook – also launched at the event
- Minister of Commerce & Industry: Piyush Goyal | Constituency – Mumbai (North), Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Commerce & Industry: Jitin Prasada

News - 92

- Bihar + Jharkhand = to sign an agreement to resolve dispute over sharing of Sone River waters
- Bihar – approved draft agreement in Jan 2026
- Bansagar Agreement – signed between MP, UP & Bihar (undivided), in 1973, for distribution of water of Sone River
  - Water allocation: 7.75 million acre-feet (MAF) of water to undivided Bihar (5.75 MAF to Bihar & 2 MAF to Jharkhand)
- Sone (a perennial river) – originates from Amarkantak hills in MP & a southern tributary of Ganga
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar

News - 93

- MoES celebrated its 20th Foundation Day at Prithvi Bhawan, New Delhi
- National Centre for Seismology (NCS) also released Compendium of Monthly Seismological Bulletins for 2023 & 2024
- MoS (I/C) in Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 94

- Rajiv Ranjan Singh – launched 'Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme' & 'SAMARTH Panchayat Portal'
- He also released 'Model Own Source of Revenue (OSR) Rules for Panchayati Raj Institutions'
  - At a function held at Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi
- He was presented with Trophy & Certificate for Gold Award conferred on Ministry under National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2026

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- For Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) - Data Driven Governance for Viksit Bharat

- 4 Panchayati Raj initiatives – won 3 Gold Awards & 1 Silver Award at 29th National Conference on e-Governance
- Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme – anchored under Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan (RGSA)
- It targets development of 350 projects over 4 years, comprising 50 projects in 1st year followed by 100 projects annually over next 3 years
- It is open, with a minimum annual OSR, to: Gram Panchayats – ₹50 lakh | Block Panchayats – ₹1 Cr
  - Each with at least 3 years of tenure remaining
- SAMARTH Panchayat Portal – a unified & configurable national digital platform
- Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying: Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh) | Constituency – Munger, Bihar
  MoS in Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying: S. P. Singh Baghel & George Kurian

News - 95

- Centre notified quality specifications for Anhydrous Ammonia Fertiliser, for an initial period of 3 years
  - Under Fertiliser (Inorganic, Organic or Mixed) (Control) Order, 1985
- Notification – issued by MoA&FW, under Clause 20A of Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985
  - It requires fertiliser to contain a minimum nitrogen content of 82% by weight
- Nitrogen content in: Urea – 46% | Ammonium sulphate – 21% | Calcium ammonium nitrate – 26%
- If this initiative proves successful, India would become 4th country in world to use ammonia directly in agriculture

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News - 96

- Harsh Sanghavi (Gujarat Dep. CM) – launched 'Cyber Financial Fraud e-Zero FIR' service, in Gandhinagar
  - To facilitate faster registration & investigation of cyber financial fraud cases
- Complaints lodged through national cybercrime helpline, 1930, will automatically generate an e-Zero FIR
- Implemented in coordination with – Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

Join us

International Affairs

News - 97

- India launched "Operation Amistad" in response to devastating earthquakes in Venezuela
- Indian Army dispatched a 41-member medical contingent from 60 Para Field Hospital
  - It departed from Hindon Air Force Station aboard 2 Indian Air Force C-17 Globemaster aircraft
- US pledged $150 million in emergency aid
- Venezuela – India's third-largest supplier of crude oil in May 2026
- Venezuela – Caracas – Venezuelan bolivar | President – Delcy Rodríguez

News - 98

- India – to chair "Ninth Session of Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy"
- Organised by – United Nations Trade & Development (UNCTAD), at Palais des Nations in Geneva, Switzerland
- India will be represented by – Nidhi Khare (Secretary, DCA)
- IGE – constituted under United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection (UNGCP)
  - It is principal intergovernmental platform for cooperation & dialogue on subject
- Key highlights of the session include:
  - Launch of 'United Nations Principles for Consumer Product Safety', adopted by UNGA in Dec 2025
  - A high-level fireside chat titled 'Why the Principles Matter'
  - A voluntary peer review of Argentina's consumer protection law

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News - 99

- India + Mali = launched inaugural 'India-Mali Forum for the Promotion of Exports' in Bamako
  - Theme – "Reinforcing Trade and Strategic Partnerships"
  - Jointly organised by = Ministry of Industry & Trade (Mali), Embassy of India in Bamako & Malian Agency for Promotion of Exports (APEX-Mali)
- Indian delegation – led by Amit Kumar, Joint Secretary (FT-Africa), Department of Commerce
- Bilateral trade between India & Mali – surpassed $326.61 million in FY26
- Mali announced it will host a dedicated Investment Forum in Dec 2026
- Mali – Bamako – West African CFA Franc | Interim PM – Abdoulaye Maiga

News - 100

- 'AI for Good Global Commission' – launched jointly by Rwanda President Paul Kagame (as Co-Chair), Salesforce Chair & CEO Marc Benioff (as Co-Chair) & ITU SG Doreen Bogdan-Martin (as Vice-Chair)
  - It is a high-level international initiative of 44 founding members
- 3 prominent Indian business leaders are founding members:

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- Mukesh Dhirubhai Ambani (CMD of Reliance Industries Limited)
- Sunil Bharti Mittal (Founder & Chairman of Bharti Enterprises)
- Lakshmi N. Mittal (Executive Chairman of ArcelorMittal)

- 4th Indian-linked founding member – Vishal Talwar (FedEx Corporation)
- Commission builds on work of 'ITU-UNESCO Broadband Commission for Sustainable Development'
- Its inaugural meeting is scheduled during 'AI for Good Global Summit 2026' in Geneva (from Jul 7-10, 2026)

News - 101

- PM Modi + Anthony Albanese (Australian PM) = announced Australia-India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies & Supply Chains (PACTS) in Melbourne
  - Succeeding & replacing – 2020 Framework Arrangement on Cyber & Cyber Enabled Critical Technology Cooperation
- PACTS is structured around five pillars: Supply Chain Resilience & Diversification | Critical Technology
  - Cybersecurity | Digital Resilience | Defence Research Collaboration
- India + Australia = an MoU for Australia-Canada-India Technology & Innovation Partnership (ACITI)
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

News - 102

- India + Kyrgyzstan = inaugurated International Centre for Civilizational Studies 'Manas and Mahabharata' in Bishkek
  - Established by – Manas National Academy in collab with CSIR (New Delhi)
- 1st Hindi translation of Kyrgyz national epic 'Manas' – also presented at the event
  - Translated by – Prof Hem Chandra Pande & Prof Ramakant Dwivedi
  - Chief Guest at the event – Sunil Ambekar
- Kyrgyzstan – Bishkek – Som | President – Sadyr Nurgojoevich Japarov

News - 103

- 10 countries announced formation of an "Anti-Ballistic Missile Coalition" in Paris, France
  - Ukraine, Denmark, France, Germany, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Spain, Sweden & UK
- Aim: To build a shared ballistic missile defence capability for Europe

News - 104

- India – officially launched its campaign for election as a non-permanent member of UNSC for 2028-29 term
  - At an event held at UN Headquarters in New York
- India previously served 8 terms as a non-permanent member of UNSC (most recently in 2021-22)
- Election for non-permanent seat – to be held during 81st session of UN General Assembly, in Jun 2027
- HQs of UNSC – New York, US | Presidency in July 2026 – DR Congo (June'26 - Colombia | Aug'26 - Denmark)
  The UNSC has 10 non-permanent members & 5 permanent members (China, France, Russia, UK, US)

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News - 105

- A team of Chinese geologists identified an active fault line, namely “Paizhen Fault”
  - Directly beneath a major hydropower project being constructed on Yarlung Tsangpo (Brahmaputra) in Tibet
- This hydropower project has an installed capacity of – 60,000 MW | It is being built in – Medog county
  - It is projected to generate more than 300 billion kilowatt-hours of electricity annually
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 106

- 29 countries signed agreement in Shanghai – establishing ‘World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization’
  - It is an independent intergovernmental international organisation headquartered in Shanghai
- Founding countries include Kazakhstan, Laos, Pakistan, Russia, Indonesia, Brazil, South Africa, Malaysia & Senegal
- WAICO – 1st proposed by China at 2025 WAIC
- Reiterated by President Xi Jinping at 32nd APEC Economic Leaders’ Meeting in Gyeongju, South Korea, in Oct-Nov 2025
- Annual ‘World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) 2026’ – held from Jul 17 to 20, 2026

News - 107

- France – passed a bill banning social media use for children under age of 15
  - It became 1st country in European Union to introduce a blanket age limit on such platforms
  - National Assembly passed bill, also banning use of mobile phones in French high schools
- Australia – 1st country to ban social media for children under 16 in Dec 2025
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu

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News - 108

- India + Romania = signed 3 agreements during President Droupadi Murmu’s State Visit
  - 1st visit by an Indian Head of State to Romania in over 3 decades
- 1st agreement related to Science & Technology – joint projects in natural sciences, engineering & technology, medical & health sciences, and agricultural sciences
- 2nd agreement related to ICCR Chair – established at University of Bucharest to strengthen academic cooperation and promote Indian language & culture
- 3rd agreement related to Sports – signed between Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports (India) & National Sport Agency (Romania) to enhance cooperation in gymnastics, swimming & other areas
- India + Romania = to celebrate 2028 as ‘India-Romania Year of Innovation’ marking 80 years of diplomatic relations
- Romania – Bucharest – Romanian Leu | President – Nicușor Dan | PM – Ilie Bolojan

Join us

News - 109

- US House of Representatives – passed fiscal "2027 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA)"
  - It authorized a record $1.15 trillion in military spending
- NDAA allocates: $1+ trillion – to Department of Defense | $40 billion – to Department of Energy
  - $10+ billion – for other military-related matters
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 110

- Donald Trump announced a new phased tariff policy on generic pharmaceutical drug imports
- All generic drugs brought into US will continue to face a zero-percent tariff for 2 years, w.e.f. Aug 1, 2026
  - After which tariff rate will be raised to 100% for 1-year (from Aug 2028) & then to 200% thereafter (from Aug 2029)
- Indian pharmaceutical exports – around $10.5 billion in 2024-25
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

Banking, Digital/Finance, Economic & Insurance Affairs

(Note: This chapter includes Digital/Financial Awareness and RBI Circulars & Notifications too.)

News - 111

- Central Board of Trustees (CBT) of EPFO – recommended an annual rate of interest of 8.25% to be credited on EPF accumulations in members' accounts for FY26
- EPF interest earned is tax-free on employee contributions up to ₹2.5 lakh per annum
- At 239th CBT meeting, Board also:
  - Approved notification of new social security schemes – EPF Scheme 2026, EPS 2026 & EDLI Scheme 2026
  - Approved a one-time 'Amnesty Scheme' for exempted establishments to resolve compliance issues
  - Approved 'Revised Estimates for FY26' & 'Budget Estimates for FY27' for EPFO
  - Approved 'EPFO's Annual Report for FY 2024-25' for tabling before Parliament
- EPFO was established under the 'Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions (EPF & MP) Act, 1952'
- HQs of EPFO – New Delhi | CEO – Ramesh Krishnamurthi | Established in – 1952

News - 112

- Mintage World – launched 200-page coffee table book "Stamps, Coins, and Banknotes Issued During the Premiership of Shri Narendra Modi" documenting commemorative stamps, coins & currency notes issued during 2014-2019
- Mintage World – world's 1st online museum for coins, stamps & banknotes
- The project is the brainchild of – Sushilkumar Agrawal (Founder & CEO of Mintage World)
- Next volume – planned around Sept 17, 2026
- Coins are minted at SPMCIL mints – Mumbai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Noida
  - Currency notes are printed at – Nasik, Dewas (GoI-SPMCIL) & Mysuru, Salboni (RBI-BRBNMPL)

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News - 113

- As per RBI, India's external debt – $762.8 billion at end-Mar 2026 (increase of $26.3 billion over end-Mar 2025)
  - External debt-to-GDP ratio – rose to 20.8% (from 19.8% in 2025)
- Valuation effects arising from appreciation of US dollar against Indian rupee & other major currencies – $24.6 billion
- Long-term debt (original maturity above 1 year) – $613.5 billion (up $11.6 billion from 2025)
- The share of short-term debt (original maturity up to 1 year) in total external debt rose to 19.6% from 18.3%, with the short-term debt-to-foreign-exchange-reserves ratio rising to 21.6% from 20.1%
- Debt service (principal repayments plus interest payments) – declined to 5.8% of current receipts (from 6.6% in 2025)
- Largest currency component in debt – US dollar (55.5%) | Followed by – Indian rupee (29.4%), Japanese yen (6.4%), Special Drawing Rights/SDR (4.3%) & euro (3.7%)
- Largest share of external debt – Non-financial corporations (36.4%)
  - Followed by – deposit-taking corporations excluding central bank (26.5%), general government (22%) & other financial corporations (10.2%)
- Largest component by instrument – Loans (34.7%) | Followed by – currency & deposits (22.3%), trade credit & advances (19.0%) and debt securities (16.1%)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 114

- RBI – extended its pilot Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) for State Government Securities/State Development Loans (SDLs) to 10 more jurisdictions (9 additional states & Delhi)
  - Now, total number of states & UTs under BIS framework – 18 plus Delhi
- BIS – originally introduced on a pilot basis for Q1 of FY27 with 9 states
  - Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Kerala, MP, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Telangana & UP
- It involves issuing SDLs in pre-announced standardised benchmark maturity tenor buckets as per a structured borrowing calendar
- RBI indicated states & UTs are expected to raise ~₹3.19 trillion through market borrowings during Q2 of FY27
  - Market expectations – ₹3.4-3.5 trillion
- RBI released separate indicative borrowing calendars:
  - One for 18 states plus Delhi under BIS framework
  - A separate calendar for remaining states & UTs expected to adopt BIS going forward
- SDLs are managed by RBI under Section 21A of RBI Act, 1934
- Gross amount raised by states through State Government Securities – rose to ₹12.76 trillion in FY26 (from ₹10.73 trillion in FY25)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

Join us

News - 115

- Rajiv Kumar – appointed as Additional (Independent) Director of HDFC Bank for 4 years (succeeding – Keki M. Mistry)
  - He is former Finance Secretary & India's 25th Chief Election Commissioner
- Rajiv Kumar – also appointed as Part-time (Non-Executive) Chairman of HDFC Bank for 3 years
- HQs of HDFC Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sashidhar Jagdishan | Tagline – "We understand your World"

News - 116

- IFSCA issued a consultation paper proposing a draft circular on integration of all regulated entities at GIFT-IFSC with KYC Registration Agencies (KRAs)
  - It will be achieved by establishing a unified "One KYC" framework
- Regulated entities at GIFT-IFSC will be required to integrate with at least 1 KRA for uploading, storing, retrieving & updating client KYC records
- All new clients onboarded on or after Sep 1, 2026, must have their KYC details uploaded to KRA system within 3 working days of KYC completion
  - For clients onboarded prior to that date, existing KYC records must be uploaded by Oct 30, 2026
- IFSCA – established on Apr 27, 2020 under International Financial Services Centres Authority Act, 2019
  - It is unified regulator for GIFT-IFSC, India's only International Financial Services Centre, located in Gandhinagar
- HQs of IFSCA – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Chairman – K. Rajaraman | Ex. Director – Dipesh Shah | Established – 2020

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News - 117

- PayGlocal (Bengaluru) – launched Google Pay Card Payments on its International Payment Gateway
- Outside India, Google Pay functions as a card-linked Near-Field Communication (NFC) & online checkout wallet
- HQs of PayGlocal – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-founder & CEO – Prachi Dharani

News - 118

- Interest rates on India's popular small savings schemes for Q1 FY27 (Apr 1, 2026 to Jun 30, 2026):
  - Public Provident Fund (PPF) – 7.1% per annum
  - Senior Citizen Savings Scheme (SCSS) – 8.2% per annum (quarterly payouts)
  - Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) – 8.2% per annum (tax-free)
  - National Savings Certificate (NSC) – 7.7% per annum (5-year lock-in)
  - Post Office Monthly Income Scheme (POMIS) – 7.4% per annum
  - Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP) – 7.5% per annum (matures in 115 months)
  - 5-Year Post Office Time Deposit – 7.5% per annum
  - Post Office Savings Account – 4% per annum
- GoI reviews Small Savings Scheme interest rates on a quarterly basis as per Shyamala Gopinath Committee formula

Join us

News - 119

- Punjab & Sind Bank (PSB) – celebrated its 119th Foundation Day in New Delhi
- PSB launched 4 new products & initiatives:
  - 'Navjyoti' mobile application for Human Resources management
  - Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) services
  - A Digital Gold Loan facility for paperless, instant gold-backed credit
  - 'PSB Bharat Connect' account
- HQs of Punjab & Sind Bank – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Swarup Kumar Saha

News - 120

- SEBI constituted an Expert Working Group to undertake a comprehensive review of regulatory framework governing Debenture Trusteeship activities in India
- Chaired by – Ananta Barua (former member of SEBI) | Co-Chairperson – Rajnish Kumar (former Chairman of SBI)
- Group's Terms of Reference:

  (1) Comprehensive review of existing SEBI (Debenture Trustees) Regulations, 1993

  (2) Examining representations & suggestions from market participants

  (3) Recommending measures to strengthen role & effectiveness of Debenture Trustees

  (4) Reviewing net-worth requirements applicable to Debenture Trustees & suggesting changes

  (5) Examining any other relevant matters related to Debenture Trusteeship activities
- Debenture Trustee – a SEBI-registered entity responsible for monitoring issuer compliance with trust deed obligations, protecting debenture holders' interests & overseeing issuer's financial obligations
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 121

- SBI Life Insurance + IIT Bombay = an MoU to establish "Bharat's AI and Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance"
  - To develop indigenous Artificial Intelligence-powered cyber defence technologies for India's insurance sector
- SBI Life Insurance – incorporated in Oct 2000 as a JV between SBI & BNP Paribas Cardif
- Bharat Innovation Hub will develop scalable, indigenous deep-tech solutions across 4 domains:
  - Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, Quantum Technologies & Digital Insurance Systems
- India's insurance industry – to grow at 6.9% annually through 2030 (fastest among major global insurance markets)
- HQs of SBI Life Insurance – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Amit Jhingran | Founded in – 2001
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare

Join us

News - 122

- Eurobank (Greece) + NIPL (India) = partnered to make India's UPI live in Greece
- Greece – became 10th country where UPI is accepted
  - Following Singapore, UAE, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, France, Mauritius, Qatar & Cambodia
- UPI processes over 22-23 billion transactions per month (23.2 billion in May 2026) domestically & is operated by NPCI
- HQs of Eurobank – Athens, Greece | Chairperson – George Zanias | CEO – Fokion Karavias | Established in – 1924
- HQs of NPCI Int. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Ritesh Shukla

News - 123

- IRDAI granted a certificate of registration to Prudential HCL Health Ins. Ltd. to carry on health insurance business in India
- Prudential HCL Health Insurance – a JV between Prudential Group Holdings (UK) & Vama Sundari Investments (Delhi)
  - Prudential plc & HCL Group – announced 70:30 JV in Mar 2025 to launch this health insurance business in India
- Star Health & Allied Insurance – India's first & largest standalone health insurer by premium
- HQs of Prudential HCL Health Ins. Ltd. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amit Dave | Established in – 2025
- HQs of IRDAI – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Ajay Seth | Established in – 1999

News - 124

- Razorpay + NBBL = partnered to join 'Banking Connect', a mobile-first NetBanking solution for businesses & consumers across India
- 'Banking Connect' – originally launched by NBBL during 'Global Fintech Festival 2025'
- HQs of Razorpay – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Harshil Mathur | Co-founders – Harshil Mathur & Shashank Kumar
- HQs of NBBL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Noopur Chaturvedi

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News - 125

- Paytm Europe Payments S.A. – received a payment institution (PI) licence from Luxembourg's financial regulator, Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier (CSSF), w.e.f. July 2, 2026
- PI licence – EU's authorisation permitting a non-bank entity to provide regulated payment services across all EU member states under a single licence
- Paytm Europe Payments – incorporated in Luxembourg on Jan 12, 2026
- Paytm Cloud Technologies – invested an additional €9 million in Paytm Europe Payments while retaining full ownership
- Besides Europe, Paytm currently operates in UAE, Singapore & Saudi Arabia
- One 97 Communications reported its first full-year profit of ₹552 Cr in FY26 (from a loss of ₹663 Cr in FY25)
- HQs of Paytm Europe Payments S.A. – Luxembourg | CEO – Nasir Zubairi | Incorporated in – 2026
- HQs of Paytm – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | MD & CEO – Vijay Sekhar Sharma | Founded in – 2010

Join us

News - 126

- RBI imposed monetary penalties of:
  - ₹63.6 lakh – on BoB for non-compliance with certain provisions of 'Fair Practices Code for Lenders' & 'KYC' norms
  - ₹3.1 lakh – on GIC Housing Finance Ltd for non-compliance with KYC guidelines
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"
- HQs of GIC Housing Finance Limited – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sachindra Salvi | Established in – 1989

News – 127

- Central Government notified "Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Scheme, 2026" in Official Gazette on Jun 29, 2026
  - Under 'Code on Social Security, 2020'
- Other schemes notified – "Employees' Pension Scheme (EPS), 2026" & "Employees' Deposit Linked Insurance (EDLI) Scheme, 2026"
  - Together, they replace 3 legacy schemes operating under "Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions (EPF&MP) Act, 1952"
- All 3 new schemes apply to establishments covered under Chapter III of Code on Social Security, 2020
- It retains core contribution structure: employees & employers each contribute 12% of wages towards Provident Fund
  - Existing 10% rate – to apply to establishments specifically notified by Central Government
- 3 special measures introduced: 'Employees' Enrolment Campaign, 2026', 'VISHWAS, 2026' & 'AMNESTY, 2026'

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News - 128

- BoB + Mizuho Bank = partnered to enhance collaboration across mergers & acquisitions (M&A) financing, structured lending, cross-border financing solutions & broader corporate & investment banking opportunities
- 5 areas of collaboration under this partnership: Acquisition Finance | M&A Advisory | Risk Distribution
  - Ancillary Banking Services | Capacity Building
- Mizuho Financial Group – currently operates 5 branches in India & 1 unit in GIFT City, Gandhinagar
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"

News - 129

- NPCI + HSBC India + JPMorgan Payments = partnered to introduce real-time foreign exchange (FX) conversion & settlement for cross-border UPI transactions
- Each bank will support real-time FX rates via direct Application Programming Interface (API) integration
- UPI's overseas transaction volume – crossed 1 million for 1st time in FY26, reaching 1.48 million transactions
  - Total value – reached ₹330.43 Cr
- UPI is now accepted in 10 countries – Singapore, UAE, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, France, Mauritius, Qatar, Cambodia & Greece
- 'Integrated Ombudsman Scheme' – revamped by RBI & effective Jul 1, 2026

Join us

- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008
- HQs of HSBC India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Hitendra Dave
- HQs of JPMorgan Payments – New York, USA | Co-Heads – Umar Farooq & Max Neukirchen

News - 130

- ICICI Prudential Life Ins Com Ltd approved a proposal to rename company ICICI Life Insurance Ltd
  - To reclassify Prudential Corporation Holdings from a 'promoter' to an 'investor' in company
- Prudential proposed an acquisition of 75% stake in Bharti Life Insurance from Bharti Enterprises for ₹3,500 Cr
- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance – a JV between ICICI Bank Ltd & Prudential Corporation Holdings Ltd established in 2000
  - It was 1st Indian insurance company to be listed on National Stock Exchange & Bombay Stock Exchange, in 2016
- HQs of ICICI Prudential Life Ins. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Anup Bagchi

News - 131

- Ravi Shankar – appointed as Executive Director (ED) of RBI, w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026
  - He previously served as – Adviser-In-Charge of Department of Statistics & Information Management at RBI
- Department of Statistics & Information Management – responsible for economic data collection, statistical analysis, surveys & reporting within RBI framework
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 132

- Visa – launched "Visa Payment Passkey (VPP)" in India with IDFC FIRST Bank as 1st banking partner in India
  - It is an OTP-less online card payment authentication solution built on globally accepted FIDO standards
- It is compliant with RBI's 'Framework on Alternative Authentication Mechanisms for Digital Payment Transactions'
  - It encourages adoption of secure authentication methods beyond OTPs for digital transactions
- HQs of Visa – Foster City, California | CEO – Ryan McInerney | Founded in – 1958

News - 133

- RBI will conduct an overnight Variable Rate Repo (VRR) auction for a notified amount of ₹25,000 Cr on Jul 8
  - To manage short-term liquidity in banking system, with auction window open between 9:30-10:00 am under LAF
- Funds borrowed by banks through the auction will need to be repaid on Jul 9, 2026
- Surplus liquidity in banking system – estimated at ₹1.19 lakh Cr (as of Jul 6, 2026)
- Previous overnight VRR auction (held on Jul 7) – banks bid for only ₹1,135 Cr against a notified amount of ₹50,000 Cr
- Since June, RBI infused more than ₹6 lakh Cr into banking system through overnight & seven-day VRR auctions
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

Join us

News - 134

- Dilip Asbe (MD & CEO of NPCI) – inducted into Global Supervisory Board of Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT)
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008
- HQs of SWIFT Global Supervisory Board – La Hulpe, Belgium | Chair – Graeme Munro | Established in – 1973

News - 135

- N. S. Vishwanathan – reappointed as Non-Executive (Part-time) Chairman of Axis Bank for 3 years till Oct 26, 2029
- P.N. Prasad – reappointed as an Independent Director of Axis Bank till Oct 19, 2030
- HQs of Axis Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amitabh Chaudhry | Tagline – "Badhti ka Naam Zindagi"

News - 136

- GIFT City + Vietnam International Financial Center - Da Nang = an MoU to share institutional knowledge & best practices & pave way for cross-border investment between India & Vietnam
- 2 other strategic MoUs recently signed by GIFT City:
  - With Tata Communications – to position GIFT City as a preferred destination for Global Capability Centres (GCCs)
  - With CEPT University – for collaboration on research, knowledge exchange, executive education, sustainability studies & urban planning
- GIFT City – currently hosts more than 1,500 entities
- Vietnam – Hanoi – Vietnamese dong | PM – Le Minh Hung | President – To Lam

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News - 137

- Mahesh Muralidhar Pai – appointed as MD & CEO of South Indian Bank for 3 years, w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026
- He currently serves as – Chief General Manager at Canara Bank
- HQs of SIB – Thrissur, Kerala | Chairman – Jose Joseph Kattoor | MD & CEO – P. R. Seshadri (from Oct 1 - Mahesh Muralidhar Pai)

News - 138

- Sourav Ganguly – appointed as brand ambassador of InsuranceDekho, an Indian insurtech platform
- InsuranceDekho – launched a new campaign titled 'Khul Kar Khelo'
- HQs of InsuranceDekho – Gurugram, Haryana | Founder & CEO – Ankit Agrawal | Established in – 2016

News - 139

- SEBI notified amendments to FPI Regulations, replacing USD-denominated fee structure with a rupee-denominated payment mechanism for Foreign Portfolio Investors & Foreign Venture Capital Investors (FVCIs)
- Under amendment to Regulation 43B(2): Fee – ₹90,000 in eligible foreign exchange equivalent (from $1,000)

Join us

- Registration fee for Category-I FPIs & FVCIs – revised to ₹2.3 lakh (from $2,500)
- Designated Depository Participants will now be required to remit fees collected from FPIs & FVCIs to SEBI within 5 working days of granting registration
- SEBI collected a total of $12.98 million in FY26 from registration, continuation & other fees paid by FPIs & FVCIs
- Fee payment mechanism for custodians – annual payment of ₹10 lakh with a monthly payment of ₹85,000
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 140

- CSIR-IICT (Hyderabad) – developed India's 1st indigenous process technology for manufacturing hydrofluoroolefins
  - It is a new class of refrigerants expected to replace high-global-warming HFCs in ACs, refrigerators & automobile air-conditioning systems
- Advanced R&D Facility for Fluorochemicals – inaugurated at CSIR-IICT by Dr Jitendra Singh
- HFOs – a next-generation class of refrigerants with significantly lower global warming potential
- Location of CSIR-IICT – Hyderabad, Telangana | Director – Dr D. Srinivasa Reddy

News - 141

- Swift (Brussels, Belgium) announced that its blockchain-based shared ledger is ready for initial use
  - It enables early-adopter financial institutions to support 24/7 cross-border payments using tokenised deposits
- 17 banks from 6 continents are preparing to pilot live transactions using this new system
- Tokenised deposits – bank-issued digital instruments backed one-to-one by customer deposits
  - Carry same regulated, credit-backed standing as conventional account balances
  - It can be transferred over blockchain rails
- Swift developed it in partnership with Consensys with contributions from 30+ financial institutions
- HQs of SWIFT – La Hulpe, Belgium | CEO – Javier Pérez-Tasso | Established in – 1973

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News - 142

- Standard Chartered Bank – became 1st bank in India to process a cross-border remittance under Swift's new retail payments scheme
- HQs of SCB India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – P. D. Singh

News - 143

- SEBI imposed a financial disincentive of ₹1 Cr on National Stock Exchange for 2 separate technical glitches
  - A partial failure in transmitting cash market data to clearing corporation during market hours in Mar 2022
  - A technical glitch rendering exchange's website inaccessible over internet during market hours in Dec 2023
- NSE has to submit an Action Taken Report & deposit penalty amount with Investor Protection Fund (IPF) within 30 days
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan | Established in – 1992
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

Join us

News - 144

- RBI launched 3 nationwide household surveys to gather crucial inputs for monetary policy formulation ahead of next Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting (Aug 3 to 5, 2026)
  - 'Inflation Expectations Survey of Households'
  - 'Rural Consumer Confidence Survey'
  - 'Urban Consumer Confidence Survey'
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 145

- AU SFB + Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Ltd = launched AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card
  - It is available on both Visa & RuPay networks
- HQs of AU SFB – Jaipur, Rajasthan | MD & CEO – Sanjay Agarwal | Executive Director & Deputy CEO – Uttam Tibrewal
- HQs of Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder & Executive Chairman – Raj Phani Narayanam | CEO – Avinash Godkhindi | Incorporated in – 2011

News - 146

- As per data released by NSO, India's retail inflation (measured by CPI) – rose to 4.38% in Jun 2026 (from 3.93% in May)
  - Food inflation – rose to 5.32% (from 4.78%) | Rural food inflation – 5.45% | Urban food inflation – 5.09%
- Among individual items, increase recorded: Silver jewellery – 133.21%
  - Followed by – ginger (50.41%), gold, diamond & platinum jewellery (36.82%), tomato (31.92%) * personal care items (16.72%)
- RBI's inflation-targeting framework mandates keeping CPI inflation at 4%, with a tolerance band of plus or minus 2%

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News - 147

- Bank of Maharashtra – launched "FinSpark'26", a national-level cybersecurity hackathon, in Pune, Maharashtra
- Aim: To encourage students & dropouts to develop solutions for real-world cybersecurity challenges in banking sector
  - Under theme – "Securing the Future of Banking"
- It carries a prize pool of over ₹10 lakh
- HQs of BoM – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Nidhu Saxena | Tagline – "One Family One Bank"

News - 148

- Moody's Ratings – affirmed the 'Baa3' long-term deposit ratings, along with the 'baa3' Baseline Credit Assessment (BCA) and Adjusted BCA, of SBI & HDFC Bank
- The agency expects SBI's asset quality to remain broadly stable
  - supported by resilient domestic demand & strong credit growth

Join us

- SBI's liquidity coverage ratio stood at 124.3% as of the quarter ended March 2026 (well above the regulatory minimum)
- HDFC Bank's asset quality is also expected to remain broadly stable
  - with some moderation possible in the agriculture and MSME segments
- HQs of Moody's Ratings – New York, USA | CEO – Michael West | Established in – 1909

News - 149

- Kevin Warsh (US Federal Reserve Chairman) – announced leadership of 5 task forces constituted to examine central bank's approach to monetary policy & propose transformational changes
- 3 people of Indian origin are among appointed leaders:
  - Raghuram Rajan (former RBI Governor) | Raj Chetty (Harvard University economics professor)
  - Asha Sharma (Microsoft Xbox CEO)
- Raghuram Rajan – to co-lead Balance Sheet Policy task force (alongside Karen Dynan & Jeremy Stein)
- Raj Chetty – to co-lead Data task force (alongwith Doug McMillon & Kevin Murphy)
- Asha Sharma – to co-lead Productivity & Jobs task force (alongside Marc Andreessen & Charles 'Chad' Jones)

News - 150

- India's total exports of merchandise & services – rose 11.37% y-o-y to $232.73 billion in Q1 FY27
  - From $208.98 billion in Q1 FY26
- Exports: Merchandise exports – rose 15.92% to $129.32 billion (from $111.57 billion)
  - Services exports – rose to $103.41 billion (from $97.41 billion)
  - Non-petroleum exports – rose by 12.44% to $106.30 billion
  - Services trade surplus – rose to $49.43 billion (from $47.90 billion)
- Imports: Merchandise imports – rose to $216.18 billion (from $180.31 billion)
  - Merchandise trade deficit – rose to $86.86 billion (from $68.75 billion)
  - Total imports of goods & services – rose 17.55% to $270.15 billion
  - Combined goods-and-services trade deficit – rose to $37.42 billion (from $20.85 billion)
- For June 2026: India's total exports – stood at $73.45 billion (up 9.48% y-o-y)
  - Merchandise exports – $40.41 billion | Services exports – $33.03 billion
- India's fastest-growing export destinations in June 2026 – South Africa, Singapore, China, Oman & Malaysia
- India's fastest-growing sources of imports in June 2026 – Russia, China, US, UAE, & Taiwan

News - 151

- NABARD – launched "Gramodyam", an entrepreneurship development programme, to foster rural entrepreneurship
- Launched by – Dr Shaji K V (Chairman, NABARD), in collaboration with NSDC
  - With implementation being carried out through – Institute for Industrial Development (IID)
- Gramodyam – a 3-year pilot programme to create ~4,000 rural entrepreneurs across all States & UTs
- HQs of NABARD – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shaji K. V. | Founded in – 1982

Join us

News - 152

- Axis Max Life Ins Ltd – launched "Smart Retirement Income with Sustained Earnings Plan (Smart RISE)"
  - It is a Non-Linked Non-Participating Individual/Group General Annuity Savings Plan
- HQs of Axis Max Life Insurance – Gurugram, Haryana | MD & CEO – Sumit Madan | Chairman – Subrat Mohanty

News - 153

- CBDT notified Cost Inflation Index (CII) for FY27 at 384 (increase of 2.3% from 376 in FY26)
- Revised index notified under Income-tax Act, 2025, will apply to Tax Year 2026-27, from Apr 1, 2026
- Cost Inflation Index – a government tool used to adjust purchase price of eligible capital assets for inflation while calculating long-term capital gains tax assigned an index value of 100
  - Current benchmark year – set at 2001-02
- CII rose steadily in recent years to 376 for FY26 & now 384 for FY27 (from 363 for FY25)
- Capital gains tax regime introduced in Union Budget 2024 allowing:
  - Eligible individuals to choose between a 12.5% tax rate without indexation or a 20% rate with indexation for certain long-held assets
- CBDT reported that India's net direct tax collections grew 16.4% y-o-y to ₹6.51 lakh Cr as of Jul 13, 2026
  - Net corporate tax collections – rose 22% to ~₹2.40 lakh Cr
  - Net non-corporate tax collections – rose ~12% to ₹3.85 lakh Cr
- HQs of CBDT – New Delhi | Chairman – Ravi Agrawal | Formed in – 1944

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News - 154

- Government is evaluating a proposal to reintroduce a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) of below 0.5% on UPI payments made to large merchants, for transactions above ₹2,000
- Under this proposal, fee may be limited to businesses with an annual turnover of – ₹1-1.5 Cr
- Turnover limit, transaction threshold & fee structure are subject to change before formal approval
- MDR on person-to-merchant UPI transactions – removed w.e.f. Jan 2020
- UPI transaction volumes – grown to nearly 242 billion in 2025-26 (from around 20 million in 2016-17)
  - UPI transaction values – grown to nearly ₹314 lakh Cr (from about ₹0.07 lakh Cr)

News - 155

- MoSPI released Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Monthly Bulletin for June 2026, 15th such bulletin:
- Overall Unemployment Rate (UR) & rural UR – remained stable | Urban UR – declined to 6.6% (from 7.1%)
- Overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) – rose by 0.2 percentage points (compared to June 2025)
  - Female LFPR in: Rural areas – reached 36.6% | Urban areas – declined slightly
- Overall Worker Population Ratio (WPR) – remained stable at 51.4%
- PLFS – conducted by National Statistical Office (NSO) under MoSPI
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

Join us

News - 156

- DIBD (Digital India Corporation, MeitY) + PNB = an MoU under 'BHASHINI for Seva' initiative to advance multilingual AI solutions for inclusive banking & citizen-centric financial services
- The collaboration integrates BHASHINI's indigenous multilingual AI ecosystem (Udyat, Mitra, AppMitra, Pravakta & Bhashadaan) into PNB digital platforms
- HQs of PNB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Ashok Chandra | Tagline – "The Name You Can Bank Upon"
- HQs of Digital India BHASHINI Division – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag | Established in – 2022

News - 157

- SEBI – adopted new Code of Conduct for board members to enhance transparency, accountability & public confidence in capital markets
- Code applicability – Whole-Time Members (WTMs) including Chairperson & Part-Time Members (PTMs)
- Framework – based on recommendations of high-level committee constituted in March 2025 to review conflict-of-interest provisions
- WTMs – barred from fresh investments in equities, equity-linked instruments & equity/commodity derivatives
  - existing holdings to be sold, frozen or disposed through approved trading plan
  - WTMs cannot use existing equity holdings for voting rights during tenure
- WTMs must report financial asset transactions exceeding 2x monthly basic pay, family detail changes, rental agreements & immovable property transactions to Oversight & Ethics Committee
- Personal gifts above ₹50,000 from friends on social occasions require disclosure
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 158

- RBI's Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index) rose from 67 in FY25 – to 70 for FY26 (4.48% growth)
- The improvement is driven mainly by Usage parameter, reflecting increased use of banking, digital payments, insurance, pension & credit facilities
- FI-Index – introduced by RBI in Aug 2021 for FY21 in consultation with Central Govt & sectoral regulators
  - Index scale – 0 to 100 (No base year)
  - Parameters – Access (35% weight), Usage (45%), Quality (20%)
  - Calculated using 97 indicators across banking, investments, insurance, postal services & pension sectors
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 159

- Centre revised Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on export of petroleum products, w.e.f. Jul 16, 2026
  - Now, export duty: Diesel – to ₹15.50 per litre (from ₹8.50) | Aviation Turbine Fuel – ₹14.50 per litre (from ₹7.50)
  - Export duty on petrol – reduced to ₹2.50 per litre (from ₹4)

Join us

News - 160

- India's outward FDI – declined 47.9% y-o-y to $3 billion in Jun 2026 (from $5.74 bn in Jun 2025 & $4.5 bn in May 2026)
- Outbound FDI comprises 3 components – equity, debt (loans) & guarantees
  - Equity – fell to $738 million in Jun 2026 (from $2.2 billion in Jun 2025 & $1.25 billion in May 2026)
  - Debt – fell to $469.87 million in Jun 2026 (from $568.54 million in Jun 2025 & $645.75 million in May 2026)
- For FY26, India's outward FDI commitments – stood at $48.6 billion (from $43.7 billion in FY25)
- Forex inflows under RBI's concessional swap scheme – reached $20.72 billion (as of Jul 17, 2026)

News - 161

- India's agriculture credit – increased nearly 4x to ₹32.50 lakh Cr over 11 years
  - with rural credit ecosystem growing at 13% annually during FY2014-15 to FY2023-24
- According to 'NABARD's Rural Economic Conditions & Sentiments Survey (May 2026)':
  - 77.2% rural households reported higher consumption levels
  - ~51% relied exclusively on formal credit, 27% accessed both institutional & non-institutional credit
- Cooperative banking network: 1,458 Urban Cooperative Banks, 34 State Cooperative Banks & 352 District Central Cooperative Banks
- DAY-NRLM – operational across India except Delhi & Chandigarh | 19.83 lakh+ SHGs as of July 10, 2026 with ₹13.28 lakh crore loan disbursements since inception
- Bank Sakhis – 50,548 members supporting SHGs in accessing ₹12.18 lakh crore+ bank credit since 2013-14
- Kisan Credit Card (KCC) applications (July 8, 2026) – Commercial Banks: ~739 lakh | RRBs: >365 lakh | Cooperative Banks: >1,178 lakh (highest among lender categories)

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News - 162

- CBDT notified "10-Year Zero Coupon Bond" of NaBFID, under Section 2(112) of 'Income-tax Act, 2025'
- NaBFID received approval to raise funds with a maturity value of ₹20,000 Cr through issuance of 20 lakh bonds
  - At a discounted issue price of – around ₹10,296.12 Cr
- Zero coupon bond – a debt instrument that does not pay periodic interest during its tenure & is instead issued at a discount & redeemed at face value upon maturity
- HQs of CBDT – New Delhi | Chairman – Ravi Agrawal | Formed in – 1944

Join us

News - 163

- EbixCash World Money Ltd – became 1st non-bank entity in India to receive a perpetual Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) licence from RBI
- It allows company to process trade remittances of up to ₹25 lakh per transaction, facilitate family maintenance transfers & hold Nostro accounts for direct international settlements without relying on correspondent banks
- 'Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) framework' – revised in May 2026
  - Under which RBI opened trade remittances of up to ₹25 lakh &v family maintenance remittances to AD-II entities
- EbixCash World Money – India's largest AD-II network with 27 years of experience in cross-border payments
  - It accounts for more than 75% of India's cash-to-cash inward remittances
- HQs of EbixCash World Money – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – T.C. Guruprasad | Established in – 1998

News - 164

- EnKash – launched India's 1st meal card with UPI-based payment capability, in Mumbai
  - It allows employees to make payments directly from their meal card balance by scanning eligible UPI QR codes
- EnKash – became 1st provider in India to enable UPI payments directly from a meal benefit balance
- Income Tax Rules – revised increasing tax-free meal allowance limit to ₹8,800 per month, or ₹200 per meal
  - It allows employees to receive up to ₹1,05,600 annually tax-free
- EnKash – India's 1st full-stack payments & spend management platform
  - It holds Payment Aggregator, Prepaid Payment Instrument & Bharat Connect (BBPOU) licences
- HQs of EnKash – Mumbai | Co-founder & CEO – Yadvendra Tyagi

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News - 165

- Federal Bank – received its inaugural international issuer credit rating from S&P Global Ratings
  - It assigns a long-term issuer credit rating of "BBB-" with a Stable outlook, along with a short-term rating of "A-3"
  - It marks 1st time S&P Global Ratings has assigned an international issuer credit rating to bank
- According to S&P's rating scale, BBB- represents lowest level within investment-grade category
- HQs of Federal Bank – Aluva, Kerala | MD & CEO – Krishnan Venkat Subramanian | Tagline – "Your Perfect Banking Partner"

News - 166

- Glomo – became 1st GIFT IFSC-licensed payment service provider & 1st non-bank acquirer in India to receive Visa's Principal Member status, in GIFT City, Gujarat
- HQs of Glomo – GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Founder & CEO – Akash Arun | Established in – 2024

Join us

News - 167

- Andhra Pradesh + PNB = an MoU to establish PNB Quantum Finance Hub at Amaravati Quantum Valley
  - India's 1st bank-led Quantum Finance Hub
- PNB – became 1st bank in India to partner with a state government to establish a dedicated hub for banking sector
- HQs of PNB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Ashok Chandra | Tagline – "The Name You Can Bank Upon"
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 168

- DBS Bank (Singapore) – named 'World's Best Corporate Bank' at 2026 Global Bank Awards by Global Finance
  - It became 1st bank from Southeast Asia to win award since category was introduced in 2005
- DBS Bank – also named 'Asia's Best Bank' & 'Singapore's Best Bank' at same awards
- DBS Bank also named: Best Bank for Corporate Banking in Asia – by Coalition Greenwich
  - Best Bank for Financial Institutions in Asia-Pacific – by Global Finance (for 2nd consecutive year)
  - Best Transaction Bank in Asia-Pacific by Global Finance for 3 years running
  - Best Bank for SMEs in Asia & Singapore – by Euromoney
- HQs of DBS Bank – Singapore | CEO – Tan Su Shan

News - 169

- NSE – launched India's 1st exchange-traded energy derivative linked to a domestic benchmark, with introduction of "Indian Natural Gas Futures"
- Trading unit – fixed at 250 mmBtu
  - Final settlement price based on monthly weighted average price of actual deliveries on Indian Gas Exchange during contract month
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan | Established in – 1992

News - 170

- NSE Indices – launched "Nifty 500 Ahimsa Index" | Developed jointly by – NSE Indices & Ahimsagain Foundation
  - India's 1st thematic stock market index tracking companies whose business practices are aligned with Ahimsa
- Ahimsa Investment Movement (AIM) framework – classifies firms into 3 bands, Green, Orange & Red
- Nifty 500 Ahimsa Index currently comprises 326 stocks across diverse sectors
  - It carries a base date of Apr 1, 2016, with a base value of 1,000, & is rebalanced semi-annually
- Since inception, it has delivered a CAGR of 15.11%
  - Its largest weightings are in – Bharti Airtel, Infosys, Mahindra & Mahindra, TCS & Maruti Suzuki India
- BSE – introduced its "Saatvik 100 Index" in June 2026
- HQs of NSE Indices Limited – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Aniruddha Chatterjee | Established in – 1998

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News - 171

- Government approved a proposal by RBI to issue 1 billion pieces each of ₹10 & ₹20 polymer banknotes
- 1st country to issue polymer banknotes – Australia (in 1988)
  - Followed by – Singapore, Indonesia, Thailand & Malaysia
- 1st European country to issue polymer banknotes – Romania (in 1999)
- Expenditure incurred on securely printing paper currency notes during FY25 – ₹6,372.8 Cr (from ₹5,101.4 crore in FY24)

News - 172

- Axis Finance Ltd (AFL) – launched a configurable digital platform, "Axis Finance Drishti"
- Aim: boosting credit-decisioning and strengthening risk oversight across its retail & MSME lending operations
- Axis Finance Ltd – a non-deposit accepting NBFC, regulated by RBI
- HQs of Axis Finance Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Amitabh Chaudhry | MD & CEO – Sai Giridhar

News - 173

- OmniCard (Eroute Technologies Pvt Ltd) – launched India's 1st Flexi Benefits Basket on UPI
- OmniCard's Flexi Benefits Basket extends this principle across full range of eligible benefit categories
  - Typical structures including: Telecom allowances – ₹36,000 | Books & periodicals allowances – ₹50,000
- HQs of OmniCard – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | Co-Founder & CEO – Abhishek Saxena | Established in – 2018

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News - 174

- Edelweiss MF – launched "Edelweiss Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund", India's 1st REITs-oriented index mutual fund
- New Fund Offer (NFO) will remain open for public subscription from Aug 5 to 19, 2026
- Index currently maintains a minimum 60% allocation to REITs
- Minimum initial application amount – ₹100, and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter | Riskometer – 'Very High' risk
- India's 6 listed REITs together own around ₹3.1 lakh Cr of commercial assets
  - They carry a combined market capitalisation of – over ₹2.1 lakh Cr
- HQs of Edelweiss Mutual Fund – Mumbai | MD & CEO – Radhika Gupta

News - 175

- SBI – became 1st bank to tap market for perpetual bonds in 2026, with plans to raise ₹50 billion within next two weeks
- It will issue Basel III-compliant Additional Tier I (AT1) perpetual bonds, with a 5-year call option
- Canara Bank – last lender to tap market, raising ₹35 billion through similar Basel III-compliant AT1 perpetual bonds
  - At a coupon of – 7.55%
- SBI last issued perpetual bonds in Oct 2024, raising ₹50 billion at a coupon of 7.98%, with a 10-year call option
- SBI, in Jun 2026, approved raising up to ₹600 billion through debt during FY27
  - Including long-term infrastructure bonds, Basel III-compliant AT1 securities & Tier II instruments

Join us

- Perpetual bonds: Fixed-income securities without a fixed maturity date
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

Defence Affairs

News - 176

- ICGS "Akshay" – commissioned into Bharatiya Tatrakshak Fleet at Goa
- Commissioned by – Parama Sen, Additional Secretary (Personnel) of Department of Expenditure, MoF
- Designed & constructed by – Goa Shipyard Limited
- HQs of ICG – New Delhi | DG – S Paramesh | Founded in – 1977

News - 177

- DRDO – handed over Final Operational Clearance (FOC) certificate of indigenous "Netra" Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) system to Indian Air Force at a ceremony in Bengaluru, Karnataka
- FOC – formally declared by Air Marshal Awadhesh Kumar Bharti (Deputy Chief of Air Staff)
- Netra AEW&C – mounted on 2 Embraer ERJ-145 aircraft platforms
- It was developed indigenously through collaboration between DRDO's Centre for Airborne Systems (CABS), Bangalore as nodal laboratory
- With FOC, IAF can now fully operationally exploit Netra AEW&C system, complementing Israeli 'Phalcon' AWACS systems already in service
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 178

- MoD formalised a 'Whole-of-Nation' proposal to establish 7 thematic regional defence manufacturing clusters across India
- 6 confirmed clusters:
  (1) Karnataka (lead) + Rajasthan (co-lead) – Testing, Certification, Quality Assurance & Standardisation (supported by IIT Kanpur, IIT Roorkee & IIT Jammu)
  (2) UP (lead) + Jharkhand (co-lead) – Policy Reforms & Overall Defence Manufacturing Ecosystem Strengthening (with Uttarakhand and J&K as participants)
  (3) Maharashtra/Western cluster (Goa & Puducherry as participants) – Indigenisation, Private Sector Participation, Innovation, Startups & MSME Integration (supported by IIT Bombay)
  (4) Punjab + Haryana (lead) – Market Access, Defence Exports & Demand Visibility for Indian Manufacturers

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(5) Tamil Nadu + Andhra Pradesh (southern cluster) – Defence Industrial Infrastructure, Common Manufacturing Facilities & Integrated Production Systems (supported by IIT Madras)

(6) Assam (lead) – Dedicated North-Eastern Region Cluster (supported by IIT Guwahati)

- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 179

- PM Modi commissioned 3 indigenously designed & built naval ships into Indian Navy at Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port, Kolkata
  - Advanced stealth frigate INS Dunagiri | Survey Vessel (Large) INS Sanshodhak
  - Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) INS Agray
- Designed by – Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau (WDB) | Constructed by – GRSE Ltd, Kolkata
- INS Dunagiri – 7th & final ship in Project 17A guided-missile stealth frigate programme
  - With 4 being built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders (MDL), Mumbai & 3 by GRSE
- INS Sanshodhak – 4th & final vessel under Survey Vessel (Large) programme
- This is also GRSE's 1st commissioning ceremony after being granted Navratna status on Jun 19, 2026

News - 180

- 30th "Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) 2026", world's largest international maritime exercise – being held in & around Hawaiian Islands (Jun 24 to Jul 31, 2026)
  - Total participating nations – 30
- Opening ceremony – held at Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam, Hawaii
- Theme of RIMPAC 2026 – "Partners: Integrated and Prepared"
- RIMPAC – biennial exercise held during Jun-Jul of even-numbered years, hosted & administered by US Indo-Pacific Command
- India first participated in RIMPAC as an observer in 2006, 2010 & 2012 editions

News - 181

- Rajnath Singh released 'Delegation of Financial Powers to DRDO (DFP-2026)' in New Delhi
- It is a comprehensive reform to enhance efficiency, accountability & timely execution of strategic R&D projects within DRDO ecosystem
- Revised framework: Provides dedicated financial provisions for trial campaigns, testing & evaluation activities
  - Authorises sanctioning of pre-project R&D initiatives
  - Introduces segregation of financial powers for grants-in-aid pertaining to EMR Projects, DIA-CoEs & TDF projects
  - It is operationalised at DRDO Headquarters
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

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News - 182

- 23rd 'Khaan Quest 2026' (multinational peacekeeping exercise) – concluded at Five Hills Training Area, Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia
- Indian contingent comprised 40 personnel from a battalion of Jat Regiment
- 22nd edition of exercise – held in Mongolia (from Jun 14 to 28, 2025)
- Mongolia – Ulaanbaatar – Mongolian Togrog | President – Ukhnaa Khurelsukh | PM – Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

News - 183

- Indian Navy – to commission INS Mahendragiri (F38) at Visakhapatnam on Jul 11, 2026
  - It is the 6th Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate | Designed by – Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau (WDB)
  - Built by – Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai
- It is powered by – Combined Diesel or Gas (CODOG) propulsion system
- The frigate's motto – 'Mighty, Majestic, Matchless'
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 184

- India + Japan = signed 1st bilateral agreement for joint development of defence equipment
  - During 16th 'India-Japan Annual Summit'
- Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) – to manufacture system in India in collaboration with Japanese partners
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

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News - 185

- Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) – accorded Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)
  - To capital acquisition proposals worth about ₹52,000 Cr to strengthen Army, Navy & Air Force
- For Army, DAC cleared 6 systems, including:
  - Anti-UAV electronic warfare system 'Akash Tarang' | Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) systems
  - Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM) weapon system | An Active Protection System
  - Very Short Range Air Defence System (V-SHORADS) | A jet-based Kamikaze Drone system
- For Navy, 3 proposals were approved: Multi Influence Ground Mine (MIGM)
  - Naval Shipborne Unmanned Aerial System (NSUAS) | A Land-Based Testing Facility (LBTF)
- For Air Force, approval accorded for: Fixed-Wing Based High Altitude Pseudo Satellite (FW-HAPS)
- DAC – established in 2001 | It approved 55 proposals worth ₹6.73 lakh Cr in FY26
  - Capital procurement contracts worth ₹2.28 lakh Cr have been signed for 503 proposals in FY27

Join us

News - 186

- MoCA & AAI will provide complete support to India's 5th-generation fighter aircraft programme, 'Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA)'
- 1st AMCA prototype rollout – expected by late 2027, with 1st flight by 2028-29, certification by 2032 & induction into IAF service from 2034-35
  - IAF is expected to induct approximately 126-140 AMCA aircraft across 7 squadrons in its 1st phase
- Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) – developed by Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA) under DRDO
  - It is India's indigenous twin-engine, single-seat, all-weather, 5th-generation stealth multirole combat aircraft
- This programme received Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) clearance in Mar 2024 at an outlay of ₹15,803 Cr
- In May 2026, MoD issued a Request for Proposal (RFP) to 3 shortlisted private sector industry consortia: L&T with BEL, Tata Advanced Systems & Bharat Forge with BEML
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar
- Minister of Civil Aviation: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu | Constituency – Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Civil Aviation: Murlidhar Mohol

News - 187

- INS Udaygiri, INS Shakti & INS Kavaratti – arrived at Changi Naval Base, Singapore
  - Under command of Rear Admiral Alok Ananda, Flag Officer Commanding Eastern Fleet (FOCEF)
- INS Udaygiri – a Project 17A (Nilgiri-class) stealth guided missile frigate
  - INS Kavaratti – an anti-submarine warfare corvette
  - INS Shakti – a fleet tanker (replenishment vessel)
- Prior to Singapore, these 3 ships visited Sattahip, Thailand, & conducted a 'PASSEX (Passing Exercise)' with HTMS Chao Phraya of Royal Thai Navy

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News - 188

- BrahMos Aerospace (India) + Defence Ministry (Indonesia) = agreements for additional procurement of BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles & Astra Mk-1 beyond-visual-range air-to-air missiles
- BDL (India) + Republikorp (Indonesia) = a cooperation pact for procurement of Astra Mk-1 missiles
  - To equip Indonesia's fleet of 16 Su-30 fighter aircraft
- Astra Mk-1 – a solid rocket motor-powered missile with an engagement range of about 80-110 kms
- Indonesia – Jakarta – Indonesian Rupiah | President – Prabowo Subianto

News - 189

- DRDO – conducted a flight-test of Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) at ITR, Chandipur, Odisha
  - For a user-defined minimum range of 60 km
- Pinaka LRGR – designed by ARDE, in association with HEMRL, with support from DRDL & RCI

Join us

- Flight trial coordinated by – ITR and Proof & Experimental Establishment (PXE)

- Maiden trial of Pinaka Extended Range Rocket – held at Pokhran Field Firing Range, Rajasthan, in Mar 2026
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 190

- Rajnath Singh – commissioned INS Mahendragiri, 6th Project 17A stealth frigate, into Indian Navy's Eastern Fleet
  - At a ceremony held at naval dockyard in Visakhapatnam
- Designed by – Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau | Built by – Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai
  - Full-load displacement – 6,670 tonnes | Top speed – 28 knots
- Mahendragiri – 6th Project 17A frigate inducted into Indian Navy within a span of just 1.5 years
  - Following – INS Nilgiri (Jan'25), INS Udaygiri & INS Himgiri (Aug'25), INS Taragiri (Apr'26) & INS Dunagiri (Jun'25)
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 191

- Indian Navy – to host "Operation Southern Readiness 26-2", a four-day multinational maritime training engagement
  - At Southern Naval Command, Kochi (from 20 to 23, 2026)
  - Conducted in partnership with – Combined Maritime Forces (CMF) under aegis of Combined Task Force 154
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

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News - 192

- "Exercise Pitch Black 2026" (Jul 20 to Aug 7) – to be held at Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF) Base Darwin, Australia
- IAF contingent comprises – 4 Rafale multirole fighter aircraft, 2 C-17 Globemaster III transport aircraft & an IL-78 Air-to-Air Refuelling aircraft, supported by over 120 Air Warriors
- IAF previously participated in 2018, 2022 & 2024 editions of this exercise
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 193

- Indian Navy – commissioned INS Malvan, 2nd Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)
  - Built by – Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi | Under – 'Make in India' initiative
- 1st Mahe-class ASW-SWC – INS Mahe, commissioned at Naval Dockyard, Mumbai, in Nov 2025
- ASW-SWC – a naval vessel purpose-built to detect, track & counter submarines operating in coastal & shallow waters
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

Join us

News - 194

- Indian Navy – received another 'MH-60R Seahawk' naval helicopter, delivered at Kochi
  - Manufactured by – Lockheed Martin (US)
- Now, total number of these helicopters delivered to Navy – 21 (out of 24 units ordered)
- India + US = a Foreign Military Sales agreement, in Feb 2020, to procure 24 'MH-60R' helicopters
- India + US = a 5-year sustainment package, in Dec 2025, to support fleet's operational readiness | Worth – ₹7,995 Cr
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 195

- DRDO signed two contracts, in New Delhi, for 'Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) Mk-II' programme
  - It was approved by Cabinet Committee on Security in Jul 2025 | Outlay – ₹19,000 Cr
- 1st – with AI Engineering Services Ltd (New Delhi) to undertake conversion of 6 commercial Airbus A321 aircraft
- 2nd – with Adani Defence Systems & Technologies Ltd (Ahmedabad)
  - ADSTL – selected as Development-cum-Production Partner for mission systems of 'AEW&C Mk-II' programme
- Centre for Air Borne Systems (a DRDO laboratory) – serving as nodal agency for programme
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

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News - 196

- DRDO conducted maiden flight test of indigenous 'Kusha' Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile (LR-SAM)
  - From – APJ Abdul Kalam Island, off the coast of Odisha
- Project Kusha – aims to provide a multi-layered shield comparable to global systems
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 197

- GTRE (DRDO) – developed India's 1st indigenous Expendable Turbo Jet Engine in 350 kg thrust class
- Engine was handed over to – Dr K Rajalakshmi Menon & Dr SV Ramanamurty
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

Join us

Sports & Games

News - 198

- Joe Root (England) – became 2nd batter in history of Test cricket to reach 14,000 runs during 4th innings of 2nd Test between England & New Zealand at The Oval, London
  - 1st – Sachin Tendulkar (India)
- Root's career statistics at milestone: 165 Tests, 302 innings, 14,073 runs, average 50.98, 41 centuries, 67 fifties, best score 262
- Sachin Tendulkar achieved this landmark during India's 2010 Bengaluru Test against Australia
- It also made Root 1st player in Test cricket to score over 2,000 Test runs against New Zealand

News - 199

- Ethan Vaz (Goa) – became India's 96th Chess Grandmaster by securing his 3rd & final GM norm at "Chess Summer in Sarajevo - GM Mix" international tournament in Sarajevo, Bosnia & Herzegovina
- He became youngest active Grandmaster in India & 2nd youngest in world
- He is also 3rd Grandmaster from Goa (after GM Anurag Mhamal & GM Leon Mendonca)
- Ethan is youngest Indian to fulfil all GM title requirements since those rules came into force
- Ethan has been coached by – Prakash Vikram Singh, GM Swayams Mishra & GM Srinath Narayanan
  - He had received 'FTX Pragg Scholarship' from R. Praggnanandhaa

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News - 200

- 5th "ISSF Junior World Championship 2026" (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun) – held in Suhl, Germany
- India – finished with 24 medals (7 gold, 8 silver & 9 bronze)
- India's 7 gold medalists: Sejal Kamble (10m Air Pistol Women Junior individual) and team of Sejal Kamble
  - Vanshika Choudhary & Navya Bishnoi (10m Air Pistol Women Junior Team)
  - Sameer (25m Rapid Fire Pistol Men Junior) | Rohit Kanyan (50m Rifle 3 Positions Men Junior)
  - Pritam Kendre (10m Air Rifle Men Junior) | Abhinav Deshwal (25m Standard Pistol Men Junior)
  - Mixed team of Shambhavi Shravan Kshirsagar & Abhinav Shaw (10m Air Rifle Mixed Team Junior)
- Notable silver & bronze winners included:
  - Shiva Narwal (silver, 10m Air Pistol Men Junior, plus team silvers in Men & Mixed Team events)
  - Prachi Gaikwad (silver, 50m Rifle 3 Positions Women Junior)
  - Aishwarya Ravichandra Balehosur (silver, 50m Pistol Women Junior)
  - Anvii Rathod (bronze, 10m Air Rifle Women Junior)

Join us

News - 201

- Harshavardhan G.B. (Chennai) – became India's 97th Chess Grandmaster
- He secured his 3rd & final Grandmaster (GM) norm at 2nd "Chola Chess GM Norm Round Robin Tournament", in Chennai
  - Draw against – GM Mihail Nikitenko
- He won his: 1st GM norm – in 2022 | 2nd GM norm – in 2025

News - 202

- Ben Stokes (England) – announced his retirement from international cricket & as England Test captain mid-match
- He will conclude his international career at end of Trent Bridge Test
- At time of announcement, Stokes was playing his 122nd Test, alongside 114 ODIs & 43 T20 internationals for England

News - 203

- FIFA's Bureau of Council suspended All Nepal Football Association (ANFA), with immediate effect, in accordance with Article 14, paragraphs 1(i) & 3 of FIFA Statutes
  - Citing 'flagrant violations of FIFA Statutes linked to interference by a third party'
- Nepal's national teams & club sides are barred from participating in any competitions organised by FIFA or AFC
- HQs of FIFA – Zurich, Switzerland | President – Gianni Infantino

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News - 204

- "YONEX US Open 2026", a BWF World Tour Super 300 tournament – held in Fullerton, California
- Kidambi Srikanth (India) – finished runner-up in men's singles final | Lost to – Su Li Yang (Chinese Taipei)
- It was Srikanth's 1st appearance in a BWF World Tour final since Syed Modi International tournament in 2025

News - 205

- "Global Skills Challenge (GSC) Australia 2026" – organised by WorldSkills Australia
  - 48th WorldSkills Competition – to be held in Shanghai, China, later in 2026
- India – won 5 medals (3 gold, 1 silver & 1 bronze)
- India's gold medal winners: Pavan Bhadravati Suresha (Karnataka) – in Additive Manufacturing
  - Mausam Kumar Giri (Bihar) – in Cloud Computing | Vishnupriya Sunil (Delhi) – in Health & Social Care
- India's silver medal winner: Harsh Ramesh Pawar (Maharashtra) – in 3D Digital Game Art
- India's bronze medal winner: Muskan (Haryana) – in Painting & Decorating

Join us

News - 206

- "ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026" – held at Lord's Cricket Ground, London
- Australia – clinched 7th Women's T20 World Cup title & 14th Women's World Cup crown overall | Defeated – England
  - Australia (captained by - Sophie Molineux) – claimed her maiden ICC title as skipper
- Australia completed highest successful run chase in a Women's T20 World Cup final
- Beth Mooney – recorded her 3rd half-century in a T20 World Cup final
  - She also became 1st player to win both 'Player of the Final' & 'Player of the Tournament' awards twice
- Danni Wyatt-Hodge (England) – became 1st player to score 300 runs in a single Women's T20 World Cup edition

News - 207

- '2026 Under-15 & Under-20 Asian Wrestling Championships' – held in Pattaya, Thailand (Jun 27 to Jul 5, 2026)
- India concluded its campaign with 41 medals across both age categories
- 21 medals at Under-15 Championships & 20 medals at Under-20 Championships
  - It comprises 4 gold, 7 silver & 9 bronze
- In Under-20 competition: Women's wrestling team – finished 2nd in overall team standings
  - 1st – China | 3rd – Japan
- Men's freestyle team – finished 3rd overall | 1st – Kazakhstan | 2nd – Iran
- Leading India's gold-medal charge in Under-20 women's category – Parveen (50 kg), Muskan (53 kg) & Kajal (76 kg)
- Sumit Kumar Laxman Bharaskar – won India's sole men's freestyle gold (70 kg)

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News - 208

- Leander Paes (India) – appointed as Player Ambassador of Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)
- Paes – only Indian tennis player to have won an Olympic medal, having claimed bronze in men's singles at 1996 Atlanta Olympics & represented India at 7 consecutive Olympic Games
- He became world's number 1 doubles player in 1999 & spent around 462 weeks inside ATP top 10, winning 18 Grand Slam titles, comprising 8 men's doubles & 10 mixed doubles titles & completing a career Grand Slam in both disciplines
- At Asian Games, he won 8 medals, including 5 gold, between 1990 Beijing & 2006 Doha editions
- He was inducted into International Tennis Hall of Fame in 2024 (becoming 1st Asian male inducted as a player)
- He also holds record for most doubles wins in history of Davis Cup
- HQs of ATF – New Delhi, India | President – Yuriy Polskiy | Vice-President – Eziz Dovletov | Established in – 1958

Join us

News - 209

- S. Aswath (Tamil Nadu) – became India's 98th Grandmaster (GM) | Defeated – Kannan Vaidyanathan (US)
  - After securing his 3rd & final GM norm at 2026 Pune International Grandmaster Round Robin tournament
- Tournament was won by GM Abhijeet Gupta | Defeated – LMST De Silva (Sri Lanka)
  - Cash prize – ₹1 lakh | Aswath received runner-up trophy along with ₹75,000
  - 3rd – Kushagra Mohan
- Advik Agarwal (Pune) – earned his 2nd International Master norm & a special cash prize of ₹25,000
- Grandmaster title – awarded by International Chess Federation (FIDE) to players who secure three GM norms & cross a FIDE rating of 2500
- Aswath earned his: 1st GM norm – at Grenke Open in 2025
  - 2nd GM norm – at First Saturday GM Round Robin in Budapest in Dec 2025
- India's tally of chess Grandmasters – rose to 98
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 210

- Telangana – to host 8th edition of Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG), expected to be held in Nov 2026
  - It will make Telangana second southern Indian state to host Games (after Tamil Nadu hosted 2024 edition)
- 7th edition of Games – hosted by Bihar in May 2025
  - Winner – Maharashtra | Followed by – Haryana & Rajasthan
- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla

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News - 211

- "Wimbledon 2026" (139th Championships) – held at All England Club, London (in July 2026)
- Jannik Sinner – won Wimbledon men's singles title | Defeated – Alexander Zverev (Germany)
  - Jannik claimed his 5th Grand Slam title & extend his winning streak against Zverev to 10 consecutive matches
- Linda Nosková (Czech) – won Wimbledon women's singles title | Defeated – Karolina Muchova (Czech)
  - She became 10th consecutive different women's champion at Wimbledon & guarantee 7th consecutive different Grand Slam winner in women's tennis
- Tournament's total prize money – increased to £64.2 million
  - Winners of men's & women's singles titles – each received £3.6 million (from £3 million in 2025)
  - Runners-up received – £1.8 million | Players eliminated in first round – received £80,000

Join us

News - 212

- India's Women's cricket team – won Women's Test at Lord's Cricket Ground, London | Defeated – England
  - It became 1st side to win a women's Test at historic venue (142 years after Lord's hosted its first men's Test in 1884)
- Captains: India – Harmanpreet Kaur | England – Nat Sciver-Brunt

News - 213

- 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026 – held in Bucaramanga, Colombia (Jul 4-12, 2026)
- India secured joint World No. 1 rank alongside China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea & Taiwan
- Indian gold medallists – Kanishk Jain (Pune), Riddhesh Anant Bendale (Indore), Rishit Garg (New Delhi), Shresth Suraiya (Mumbai) & Svarit Joshi (Ahmedabad)
- Every Indian participant secured a podium finish over past decade
- Team was trained & mentored by – Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education (HBCSE)
- Team was led by – Prof Anwesh Mazumdar (HBCSE-TIFR) & Dr Leena Joshi (St Xavier's College, Mumbai)

News - 214

- 1st "Asian U23 Athletics Championships 2026" – held in Ordos, China (July 9-12, 2026)
- India – finished 4th overall with 16 medals (3 gold, 4 silver & 9 bronze)
  - 1st – China (23 gold, 17 silver, 12 bronze) | 2nd – Japan | 3rd – Uzbekistan
- India's relay teams – won 4 medals
  - 2 gold medals – mixed & women's 4x400m relays | 2 silvers medals – men's 4x400m & women's 4x100m teams
- Mixed 4x400m relay quartet – clocked 3:18.64 seconds to win gold | Defeated – China
  - Astik Pradhan, Sandramol Sabu, Setu Mishra & Shravani Sachin Sangle
- Anand Singh – won gold in men's javelin throw with a personal best of 80.57 metres
  - Shivam Lohakare – won bronze in same event
- Shravani Sachin Sangle – India's most successful athlete, winning 3 medals in total
  - Including gold in both mixed & women's 4x400m relays & bronze in 400m hurdles
- Shivaji Parashuram Madappagoudra – won silver in men's 5000m
  - Vinod Singh – won bronze in same event

News - 215

- Indian Deaf Women's Cricket Team – won its first-ever international T20 series | Defeated – Sri Lanka
  - During maiden overseas tour held at De Soysa International Cricket Stadium in Moratuwa, Sri Lanka (Jul 7 to 13)
- Indian squad was led by – Kajal Dhawan | Vice-captain – Needa Zabi Shaikh
- Player of the Final Match – Shraddha Vaishnav | Player of the Series – Reddy Jyoshna
  - Best Bowler – Chandani Khan | Best Batter – Needa Zabi Shaikh
- Serum Institute of India & Cyrus Poonawalla Group – served as principal sponsors of tour

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- Women's Deaf T20I Tri-Series – to be held in Mar 2027 (involving India, Sri Lanka and Trinidad & Tobago)
- DICC Women's T20 World Cup – to be hosted in Delhi in Feb 2028

News - 216

- Rekha Gupta – unveiled "Mayur", official mascot of 22nd "Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026"
  - At an event held at – The Lalit, New Delhi
- Championship was jointly organised by – Delhi Government & Table Tennis Federation of India
- Unveiling ceremony was attended by – Ashish Sood (Delhi Education & Sports Minister) & Vivek Kohli (Commonwealth Table Tennis Federation President)
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

News - 217

- MoYAS – granted conditional recognition to interim Executive Committee of Judo Federation of India (JFI)
- Ministry directed JFI: To conduct elections for its final Executive Committee (as mandated by court)
  - To mandatorily amend its constitution to bring it into consonance with National Sports Governance Act, 2025
- JFI (established in 1965) – National Sports Federation governing judo in India
  - It has been affiliated with International Judo Federation since 1965
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

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News - 218

- Asian U-19 & U-23 Boxing Championships 2026 – held in Jakarta (Jul 5 to 16, 2026)
- Uzbekistan – topped women's team standings in both age categories | 2nd – Kazakhstan | 3rd – India
- In U-23 women's category: Uzbekistan – finished with 6 gold, 1 silver & 2 bronze
  - Kazakhstan – 3 gold, 3 silver & 2 bronze | India – 1 gold, 4 silver & 4 bronze
  - India's 1 gold: Winner – Nisha (54kg) | Defeated – Koiin Kokufu (Japan)
- In U-19 women's finals: Chandrika Bhoresh Pujari (51kg) – gold | Defeated – Nazokat Mardonova (Uzbekistan)
  - Prachi – gold | Defeated – Dira Artika (Indonesia)
- In men's competition, India secured two gold medals in U-23 category:
  - Vishvanath Suresh (50kg) | Defeated – Daichi Iwai (Japan)
  - Ganga (55kg) | Defeated – Bexulatn Boranbek (Kazakhstan)
- Vanshaj (65kg) – silver | Lost to – Ilkhomjon Ergashev (Uzbekistan)
- In U-19 men's finals: Aditya (55kg) & Shubham Rajput (90kg) – finished with silver medals

Join us

News - 219

- ICC Board – approved sweeping changes to formats of Men's Cricket World Cup (ODI) & Men's T20 World Cup
  - To enhance competitiveness & create more meaningful contests throughout both tournaments
- Men's T20 World Cup – to retain its 20-team format but undergo significant structural changes
  - Opening group phase reduced to – 5 groups of 4 teams (from 4 groups of 5 teams)
  - Number of group-stage matches – reduced to 30 (from 40)
  - Top 2 teams from each group will continue to progress to 2nd stage
- Previous 'Super 8' stage – to be replaced by an expanded 'Super 10' phase (comprising 2 groups of 5 teams)
- Revised T20 World Cup format – influenced by strong performances of emerging teams at 2026 edition of tournament
- Men's Cricket World Cup – to move to a new 3-stage format ahead of knockout rounds
- Board also approved qualification pathway for ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2028
  - Scotland will enter directly into Europe Regional Final
- Other teams that featured in 2026 without securing automatic qualification will advance directly into a 16-team Global Qualifier tournament
- Remaining 8 places filled through regional qualification, comprising: 2 teams each from Africa, Asia & Europe
  - 1 team each from Americas & East Asia-Pacific
- HQs of ICC – Dubai, UAE | Chairman – Jay Shah | CEO – Sanjog Gupta | Members – 108 countries

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News - 220

- Dr Mansukh Mandaviya + Himanta Biswa Sarma = unveiled 'Peacko', official mascot for BWF World Championships 2026
  - scheduled to be held from Aug 17 to 23, 2026, at Indira Gandhi Stadium, New Delhi
- They also launched official championship anthem for BWF World Championships 2026
  - Official anthem Was sung by – rapper Spectra
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 221

- "Japan Open 2026" – held at Tokyo Metropolitan Gymnasium
- Winner of Women's Singles – PV Sindhu (India) | Defeated – Akane Yamaguchi (Japan)
  - She became 1st Indian to win Japan Open title & claim her maiden BWF Super 750 crown
  - She marked her 1st title outside India since winning Singapore Open in 2022
  - Her overall tally – 6 titles on BWF World Tour
- Winner of Men's Singles: Christo Popov (France) | Defeated – Koki Watanabe (Japan)

Join us

News - 222

- 23rd edition "2026 FIFA World Cup" – held at New York New Jersey Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey, US
  - Jointly hosted – by US, Mexico & Canada | Coach – Luis de la Fuente | Captain – Rodri
- Winner – Spain ('La Furia Roja') | Defeated – Argentina | It marked Spain's 2nd World Cup title, since 2010
- Individual Awards (2026):
  - Golden Ball (Best Player) – Rodri (Spain)
  - Golden Boot (Top Scorer) – Kylian Mbappé (France)
  - Golden Glove (Best Goalkeeper): Unai Simón (Spain)
  - Best Young Player: Pau Cubarsí (Spain) (19 years)
  - FIFA Fair Play Award: Netherlands
- 2026 Mascots (3): Maple the Moose (Canada), Zayu the Jaguar (Mexico), Clutch the Bald Eagle (USA)
- The official match ball used in the final of 2026 FIFA World Cup – 'Adidas Trionda'
- Previous edition: 2022 Qatar – Argentina beat France
- Next edition: 2030 (centenary edition) – to be hosted by Spain, Portugal & Morocco
  - with opening matches in Uruguay, Argentina & Paraguay
- Spain had also won 'European Championship 2024'
- HQs of FIFA – Zurich, Switzerland | President – Gianni Infantino

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News - 223

- 58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026 – held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan (from Jul 10 to 19, 2026)
- All 4 members of India's team – won gold medals for 1st time
- In country-wise medal tally: 1st – India (with China, Vietnam & an Individual Participant from Russia)
- Indian gold medallists: Debadatta Priyadarshi (Odisha); Harshit Singla (Punjab); Kabeer Chhillar (Delhi) & Sandeep Kuchi (Telangana)
- Indian delegation was led by – Prof. Subhajit Bandyopadhyay & Dr Indrani Das Sen
  - Scientific Observers – Dr Anubendu Adhikary & Dr Jayasree Gopalakrishnan
- Indian team was selected & trained by – HBCSE (an institute of Tata Institute of Fundamental Research)

News - 224

- 37th "International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026" – held in Vilnius, Lithuania (from Jul 12 to 19, 2026)
- India – secured 1 gold & 3 silver medals
- India's medal winners: Gold –Bhavyaa Gunwal (Haryana)
  - Silver (each) – Soumil Maity (WB), Nishit Kalani (Rajasthan) & Anmol Kumar (Punjab)
- Indian delegation was led by – Prof. Rekha Vartak & Dr Anupama Ronad
- Total medals awarded at the event – 31 gold, 61 silver & 91 bronze

Join us

News - 225

- FIFA distributed $871 million in total prize money at 2026 World Cup, largest financial pool till now
  - It marks a 65% increase over $440 million distributed at 2022 Qatar edition
- Of this: $655 million – to performance-based prize money | Remaining – qualification & preparation funding
- Performance-based payouts – rose at each stage of competition to $19 million for a quarter-final exit (from $9 million)
  - Runners-up Argentina earn $33 million | Champions Spain earn $50 million
- Lionel Messi – became player with most career World Cup appearances (34) & most assists (12)
- HQs of FIFA – Zurich, Switzerland | President – Gianni Infantino

News - 226

- Inaugural "Menuires International Chess Open - Masters Tournament 2026" – held in Les Ménuires, France
- Rohith Krishna S (India) – won gold | Raja Rithvik R (India) – won silver | Artem Omelja (Ukraine) – won bronze
- It carried a total prize fund of – €20,000 | Top 3 finishers awarded – €3,000, €2,000 & €1,500 (respectively)
- Rohith Krishna S (Chennai) – became India's 89th Grandmaster in Aug 2025

News - 227

- Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) + Cerebral Palsy Sports Federation of India (CPSFI) = an MoU to pursue India's bid to host "2029 World Abilitysport Games"
  - Chennai & Bhubaneswar – under consideration as potential host cities
- HQs of PCI – New Delhi | President – Devendra Jhajharia | Secretary General – Jayawant Gundu Hamanawar
- HQs of CPSFI – New Delhi | President – Rajesh Tomar | General Secretary & CEO – Kavita Suresh | Founded in – 2016

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News - 228

- Lionel Messi – became 1st player in FIFA World Cup to start in 3 World Cup finals
  - After being named in Argentina's starting line-up for 2026 final against Spain
  - Held at – MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey
- Messi previously started in 2014 final & 2022 final
- Cafu (Brazil) – also featured in 3 World Cup finals, in 1994, 1998 & 2002
- Messi – also became 1st captain in tournament's history to lead his country in 3 separate World Cup finals
- At 39 years old, Messi was 2nd-oldest starter to feature in a World Cup final
  - 1st – Dino Zoff (Italy), who was 40 years & 133 days old when he started 1982 final

Join us

News - 229

- SBI Life Insurance – became 'Principal Partner' of Indian Contingent for 2026 para sports season
- It will act as 'Official Life Insurance Partner' for Indian Paralympic Contingent heading to upcoming 'Commonwealth Para Games 2026', in Glasgow & 'Asian Para Games 2026', in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
- HQs of SBI Life Insurance – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Amit Jhingran | Founded in – 2001
- HQs of PCI – Bangalore, Karnataka | President – Devendra Jhajharia | Established in – 1992

News - 230

- "Commonwealth Games 2026" – held at SEC Armadillo, Glasgow
- Mirabai Chanu (India) – won India's 1st gold medal in women's 48kg weightlifting category
  - With a combined lift of – 190kg (comprising 85kg in snatch & 105kg in clean & jerk)
- Silver – Ruth Asuquo Nyong (Nigeria) with 168kg | Bronze – Irene Jane Henry (Malaysia) with 167kg
- She set new Commonwealth & Commonwealth Games records across all 3 categories, snatch, clean & jerk, and total
- It is her 3rd consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medal
  - Previous medals: Gold Coast 2018 (she won 48kg title with a Games-record total of 196kg)
  - Birmingham 2022 (she won gold in 49kg category with a total of 201kg)
- Now, her overall Commonwealth Games medal tally – 4 (along with a silver in 48kg category at Glasgow 2014)
- Chanambam Rishikanta Singh (India) – won silver medal in men's 60kg category
- Muthupandi Raja (India) – won silver medal in men's 65kg category

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News - 231

- Indian shooters won 4 medals (1 gold, 1 silver & 2 bronze) at "ISSF World Cup Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun" in Hangzhou, China
- Esha Singh + Manu Bhaker = secured double podium finish in Women's 25m Pistol event
  - Gold – Esha Singh | Silver – Zhang Yueyue (China) | Bronze – Manu Bhaker
- Esha Singh - won 2nd ISSF World Cup title of 2026 season after 25m Pistol gold at Munich World Cup in May 2026
- Manu Bhaker – won first individual medal of the season at Hangzhou World Cup with bronze in 25m Pistol event
- Sonam Uttam Maskar + Himanshu Dhillon = won bronze in 10m Air Rifle Mixed Team event

News - 232

- "Commonwealth Games 2026" – held in Glasgow, Scotland
- India's medal tally – reached 12 (2 gold, 7 silver & 3 bronze)
- Gulveer Singh – won silver (India's 1st-ever Commonwealth Games medal) in men's 10,000m, clocking 27:49.78
  - Gold – Ky Robinson (Australia)
- Harjinder Kaur – won silver in women's 69kg category, lifting a personal-best total of 227kg
  - Gold – Charlotte Simoneau (Canada)
- Harjinder Kaur – secured her 2nd successive Commonwealth Games medal

Join us

- 1st – bronze in women's 71kg category at Birmingham 2022

- Silver medal winners in weightlifting: Gyaneshwari Yadav (women's 53kg) | Rishikanta Singh (men's 60kg)
  - Muthupandi Raja (men's 65kg) & Valluri Ajaya Babu (men's 79kg)
- Bronze medal in weightlifting: Bindyarani Devi (women's 58kg)
- India's other medallists at Games so far include: Sarvesh Kushare – silver in men's high jump
  - Sharmila Dhankar – won gold in women's shot put F57 in para athletics | Shilpa K. Shyla – won bronze

Persons in News

News - 233

- Tshering Choden (Sikkim) – successfully scaled "Mount Elbrus" (5,642 metres), highest peak in Europe
  - It is located in Caucasus mountain range in southern Russia near Georgian border
- This ascent marks Choden's 2nd successful summit in her pursuit of Seven Summits challenge
  - She had earlier scaled Mount Kilimanjaro (5,895 metres), Africa's highest peak, in Aug 2025
- Now, 5 peaks remain in her quest: Mount Everest in Asia, Denali in North America, Aconcagua in South America, Mount Vinson in Antarctica & either Mount Kosciuszko or Puncak Jaya in Oceania

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News - 234

- Iya Krish (Thrissur) – scaled Mount Toubkal (4,167 m), highest peak in North Africa, located in Morocco's Atlas Mountains
  - She became one of youngest climbers from India & possibly from Asia to achieve this feat (at 8 yrs of age)

Science & Technology

News - 235

- IIT Delhi + Sorbonne University (France) = launched a joint master's programme in Biological Science & a joint PhD course for students & researchers from 2026
- Aim: To improve their innovation, advanced research, academic programmes & student mobility
- Director of IIT Delhi – Prof. Rangan Banerjee

News - 236

- GBU + Space Kidz India + IN-SPACe = joined to support "Mission ShakthiSAT", world's 1st all-girls international satellite mission to Moon
- GBU will support mission activities & GNIDA will provide institutional support to mission
- This mission is conceptualised & led by – Space Kidz India (an Aerospace Org. dedicated to inspiring young minds)
- HQs of IN-SPACe – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Dr. Pawan Goenka | Works under – Department of Space

Join us

- HQs of Space Kidz India – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Founder & CEO – Dr. Srimathy Kesan | Established in – 2012
- HQs of GBU – Greater Noida, UP | Vice Chancellor – Prof. R.K. Sinha | Chancellor – Yogi Adityanath

News - 237

- IIT Madras + Herbalife International India Pvt Ltd = inaugurated "Herbalife-IIT Madras Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology" at IIT Madras Research Park, Chennai
- Inaugural programme also featured a panel discussion titled 'Commercial Plant Cell Fermentation: Global Opportunities and Outlook in the Next Decade'
- Director of IIT Madras – Prof. V. Kamakoti
- HQs Herbalife International India Pvt Ltd – Bengaluru, Karnataka | MD (India) – Ajay Khanna

News - 238

- Office of Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to GoI + DSCI = launched "TRL Compass" platform
  - At a ceremony chaired by Prof. Ajay Kumar Sood (PSA to GoI)
- Office of PSA to GoI + DSCI = an MoU to formalise ongoing collaboration on technology readiness assessment, capability mapping & development of a Technology Radar methodology for India's deep-tech ecosystem
- TRL Compass – India's 1st unified national framework for standardising Technology Readiness Level (TRL) assessments
  - It is publicly accessible at trlcompass.in
- It is designed to directly support effective implementation of two major national initiatives:
  - Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) | Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund
- DSCI – a not-for-profit industry body established by NASSCOM
- HQs of DSCI – Noida, UP | Chairperson – Neelam Dhawan | CEO – Vinayak Godse | Established in – 2008

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News - 239

- DGCA supervised India's 1st "Satellite-Based Landing System (SLS)" approach trial by a commercial jet aircraft
  - An IndiGo Airbus A320 completed a successful GAGAN-aided Localiser Performance with Vertical Guidance (LPV) approach & landing at Maharana Pratap Airport, Udaipur, Rajasthan
- GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation) – India's Satellite-Based Augmentation System (SBAS)
  - Jointly developed by = ISRO + AAI
- GAGAN received global certification from ICAO in 2015 & is 4th SBAS programme in world
  - Alongside US FAA's WAAS, European EGNOS & Japanese MSAS
- HQs of DGCA – New Delhi | Director General – Vir Vikram Yadav

Join us

News - 240

- IIT Delhi + DRDO = demonstrated an indigenous tactical aerostat for surveillance & communication applications
  - Developed under – DRDO Industry Academia Centre of Excellence (DIA-CoE) at IIT Delhi
- Director of IIT Delhi – Prof. Rangan Banerjee
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 241

- ISRO – conducted 1st ground test of its "Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE)"
  - At Static Test Facility of Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh
- Aim: To validate parachute-based deceleration & recovery system that will bring Gaganyaan Crew Module back to Earth
- SOLVE – developed to conduct Integrated Parachute Tests (IPTs) for Gaganyaan programme
  - Its solid stage is derived from Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) strap-on motor
- SOLVE will carry a dummy Crew Module to an altitude of 10 to 17 kms
- Gaganyaan aims to send 3 astronauts into a Low Earth Orbit of around 400 kms for a mission lasting about 3 days
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 242

- China launched a new marine satellite, "Haiyang-2E (HY-2E)", into orbit aboard a Long March-4B rocket
  - From Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center in northwest China
  - Developed by – China Academy of Space Technology (CAST)
- HY-2E – 1st of three planned replacement satellites which China intends to deploy by 2027
  - Alongside HY-2F & HY-2G
- China launched its first marine observation satellite, HY-1A, in May 2002
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 243

- ISRO successfully conducted flight acceptance hot test of its CE20 cryogenic engine, earmarked for LVM3-M7 mission
  - At Main Engine & Stage Test facility of ISRO Propulsion Complex, Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu, on Jul 6, 2026
  - It is 7th operational mission of LVM3 launch vehicle
- CE20 – an indigenously developed cryogenic engine that powers upper stage of LVM3, ISRO's heaviest rocket
- In latest test, CE20 engine was examined using a Nozzle Protection System (NPS), newly developed & validated by ISRO
- Following this successful test, it will be refurbished & assembled into C32 flight stage, currently being integrated for LVM3-M7 vehicle
- LVM3 – ISRO's heavy-lift launch vehicle, capable of placing a 4,000 kg spacecraft into Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

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News - 244

- Adani Defence & Aerospace – laid foundation stone for a ₹2,500 Cr missile manufacturing complex at Shivpuri, MP
  - To be built over next three years
- HQs of Adani Defence & Aerospace – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Ashish Rajvanshi
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

News - 245

- ISRO – conducted 5th Integrated Main Parachute Airdrop Test (IMAT-05) for Gaganyaan Mission
  - At Aerial Delivery Research & Development Establishment (ADRDE) drop zone in Sheopur, MP
- Gaganyaan Crew Module's deceleration system comprises a total of 10 parachutes across 4 types:
  - 2 Apex Cover Separation parachutes | 2 Drogue Parachutes | 3 Pilot Parachutes | 3 Main Parachutes
- Gaganyaan programme – comprises 3 uncrewed missions & 1 crewed mission
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 246

- IBS Group – launched Naviq Technology, a new vertical AI company purpose-built for global travel industry
  - To invest $500 million over next 5 years
  - Launch was announced by – V K Mathews (Founder & Executive Chairman of IBS Group)
- Naviq's new campus at Infopark, Kochi – scheduled to be inaugurated by Kerala's CM on Jul 23, 2026
- HQs of IBS Software – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala | Founder & Executive Chairman – V K Mathews | CEO – Rajiv Shah | Established in – 1997

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News - 247

- JAXA completed 1st flight test of its Reusable Vehicle eXperiment (RV-X) prototype rocket
  - At Noshiro Rocket Testing Center in Akita Prefecture, Japan
- Data from programme is intended to feed into Cooperative Action Leading to Launcher Innovation for Stage Toss-back Operation (CALLISTO)
  - It is a larger reusable-stage demonstrator being jointly developed by JAXA with France & Germany
- HQs of JAXA – Tokyo, Japan | President – Yamakawa Hiroshi | Founded in – 2003

News - 248

- ISRO successfully carried out 3 major qualification tests of Gaganyaan Crew Module systems
  - 1st test validated 'Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)'
  - 2nd test focused on 'Crew Module-Service Module Connect Disconnect System (CS-CDS)'
  - 3rd test validated structural integrity of 'Crew Module during separation of the Apex Cover'
- Gaganyaan aims to make India 4th nation to independently send astronauts into space & safely return them to Earth
  - After US, Russia & China
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

Join us

News - 249

- China – achieved 1st controlled recovery of an orbital-class rocket booster, using its new Long March-10B rocket
  - It became 2nd nation to accomplish such a feat (after United States)
- Rocket lifted off from – Hainan Commercial Space Launch Site, Hainan
- Built by – China Academy of Launch Vehicle Technology
- Its first stage, common to Long March-10A, is powered by 7 YF-100K kerosene-liquid oxygen
- Long March-10 rocket family is being developed to launch China's new Mengzhou crew spacecraft
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 250

- Russia's "Soyuz MS-29" spacecraft – launched from Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan
  - It carried NASA astronaut Anil Menon & Roscosmos cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov & Anna Kikina to ISS
- It docked with ISS's Prichal module after just 2 orbits & about 3 hours in flight
- Expedition 75 – to formally begin on Jul 26
  - Chris Williams, Sergey Kud-Sverchkov & Sergei Mikaev – will depart station aboard Soyuz MS-28
- MS-29 crew itself will spend around 8 months, or about 261 days, aboard ISS, before returning to Earth in Apr 2027
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

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News - 251

- A study conducted under ICMR's flagship 'i-DRONE' initiative – found that drone-assisted transport of TB sputum samples reduced diagnosis time & patient expenses in remote & underserved parts of Yadadri-Bhuvanagiri, Telangana
- Study was conducted in collab with AIIMS Bibinagar & District TB Office under National TB Elimination Programme
- Median turnaround time for TB diagnosis – fell to 5 days (from 15 days)
- Patients' average out-of-pocket expenditure – declined to around ₹91 (from ₹9,451)
- Findings have been published in International Journal of Tuberculosis & Lung Disease Open & in journal Digital Health
- HQs of ICMR – New Delhi, India | Director General – Rajiv Bahl | Established in – 1911

News - 252

- TCS launched 'TCS Autonomous Engineering Lab Powered by NVIDIA' at its Global Axis campus in Bengaluru
  - It will serve as a physical AI hub to accelerate development & real-world deployment of AI-led solutions
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968

News - 253

- HEX20 (Thiruvananthapuram) – launched its second satellite, "KOYO (Kinetic Optical Yaw Observer)"
  - Aboard – SpaceX's Transporter-17 rideshare mission (developed for Taiwan's National Central University)
  - Falcon 9 rocket (carrying 81 payloads in total) – lifted off from Vandenberg Space Force Base, California

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- KOYO carries: A Fibre-Optic Gyroscope – developed by Taiwan's Aegiverse
  - A Configurable Power System – built by Amplified Space (US)
  - A digipeater – for amateur radio community from Taiwan
  - ET Space Power solar cells (Taiwan) – qualified within a HEX20-built solar panel
- Nila (HEX20's first satellite) – launched in 2025 in partnership with SpaceX as India's 1st private-sector rideshare satellite
  - It was also Kerala's 1st privately built satellite
- HQs of HEX20 – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala | CEO – Amal Chandran | Established in – 2020

News - 254

- VISTAS (Chennai) – inaugurated its Thiruvanmiyur Campus in Chennai, India's 1st AI-integrated vertical university campus
  - Inaugurated by – Padma Shri Sridhar Vembu (Chief Scientist & Co-Founder of Zoho Corporation)
  - Presided over by – Dr Ishari K. Ganesh (Founder-Chancellor of VISTAS)

News - 255

- Skyroot Aerospace – launched Vikram-1, India's 1st privately developed orbital rocket, on a test flight 'Mission Aagaman'
  - From – Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota | Rocket lifted off at – 0635 GMT
- It makes India 3rd country to achieve orbital launch capability through a private company
- Skyroot – became 1st Indian space-sector company to achieve a $1 billion valuation earlier in 2026
  - Founded in 2018 by former ISRO scientists Pawan Kumar Chandana & Naga Bharath Daka
- HQs of Skyroot Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Pawan Kumar Chandana

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News - 256

- Capt Aman Johri (India) – completed microgravity research flight under "Project Astra Farm" focusing on Maharashtra-grown onions & potatoes
  - flown aboard passive microgravity payload – developed with Canada's National Research Council (NRC-CNRC)
- Project Astra Farm – explored plant tissue & cellular biology response under reduced-gravity conditions, linking space agriculture, food technology & crop resilience
- Project Astra Farm – envisioned to establish Maharashtra as global hub for space agriculture, advanced food technology & future space-food supply chains

News - 257

- Reliance Jio – received IN-SPACe approval for deploying ~1,600 Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites after technical evaluation with ISRO & WPC, enabling ITU orbital slot filings
- Jio satellite constellation – planned capacity 4.5-5 Tbps over India, higher than Starlink's approved 600 Gbps & Amazon Kuiper's proposed 3 Tbps

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- Services planned – fixed satellite services (broadband, cellular backhaul) & mobile satellite services (direct-to-device connectivity) | 20-22 ground stations planned across India
- It could pave the way for India's first large-scale, home-grown satellite broadband constellation
- LEO satellite market – dominated by Starlink with 10,397 operational satellites as of June 1, 2026
- HQs of Reliance Jio Infocomm Ltd – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Akash Ambani

News - 258

- Telangana Govt + Microsoft + 1M1B Foundation + MeitY Startup Hub = announced India's 1st Green Skills & Applied AI Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Hyderabad with specialised Green Pharma track
- It aims to equip youth, especially women & first-generation learners, with AI and sustainable manufacturing skills
  - Expected to become operational by – August 2026
- It supports Telangana's Next-Generation Life Sciences Policy 2026-30 & Green Pharma City strategy
- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla
- HQs of Microsoft – Washington, US | Chairman & CEO – Satya Nadella | Founded in – 1975
- HQs of 1M1B Foundation – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Manav Subodh | Incorporated in – 2012
- HQs of MeitY Startup Hub – New Delhi | CEO – Dr. Panneerselvam Madanagopal | Established in – 2016

News - 259

- NIELIT – establishing 2 Centres of Excellence (CoE) for semiconductor skilling in Ahmedabad & Guwahati
  - To provide specialised training in Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) & Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP) processes
- Semicon 2.0 – approved by Cabinet with an outlay of ~₹1.28 lakh Cr
- NIELIT – signed MoUs with Tata Electronics & Infineon to support Guwahati & Ahmedabad facilities
- NIELIT – also collaborating with other semiconductor manufacturing plants across India
- NIELIT is launching specialised BTech, MTech & diploma programmes focused on semiconductors & its manufacturing
- NIELIT – also partnered with Semiconductor Complex Limited (SCL) in Mohali
- HQs of NIELIT – New Delhi | Director-General – Dr. Madan Mohan Tripathi | Established in – 1994

News - 260

- Astronomers discovered a new giant exoplanet, "Beta Pictoris d", hidden within Beta Pictoris planetary system
  - Using NASA's James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)
- It marks 1st time a directly imaged planet has been found primarily through moderate-resolution spectroscopy
- Beta Pictoris – became 2nd known planetary system to contain at least 3 directly imaged planets | 1st – Beta Pictoris b
  - Beta Pictoris has a mass of around 1.8 times that of the Sun & is roughly 20 million years old
- Discovery was independently corroborated using ERIS instrument on European Southern Observatory's Very Large Telescope

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- Findings have been published in journal – The Astrophysical Journal Letters
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

News - 261

- IIT Kanpur – to establish a Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Green Hydrogen under UP Green Hydrogen Policy 2024
  - Name – 'Centre of Excellence on Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN)'
- Proposal was approved by – Government of UP | Sanctioned by – UP New & Renewable Energy Development Agency
- Green Hydrogen Centre of Excellence – approved by UP government in Dec 2025 under same policy framework
  - It is being jointly established by – IIT Kanpur & Harcourt Butler Technical University (HBTU), Kanpur
- Director of IIT Kanpur – Prof. Manindra Agrawal
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 262

- Paninian India Pvt Ltd (Hyderabad) – unveiled "Yantur 4.5 kN Turbofan Engine Programme"
  - India's first privately developed turbofan engine in its class
- Aim: To establish indigenous pvt-sector capability in compact aerospace propulsion for next-gen autonomous systems
- It is being developed to power Svayatt L1, Paninian's long-range autonomous cruise missile platform
- HQs of Paninian India Pvt Ltd – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Raghavendra Adla | Established in – 2018

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News - 263

- Orienspace (China) – launched its "Gravity-1" carrier rocket, carrying 9 satellites, from a launch service ship in waters off coast of Shanghai, in East China Sea
- Gravity-1 – developed by Orienspace with a Low Earth Orbit (LEO) payload capacity of up to 6.5 tonnes
  - It has ability to deliver a 4.2-tonne payload to a 500-km sun-synchronous orbit

News - 264

- CSIR – organised a Technology Transfer Event in New Delhi
  - Organised by – CSIR-Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh
- Among technologies transferred:
  - Pump Academy Pvt Ltd, Bengaluru – licensed to produce Induction Motor Stethoscope (MSCOPE); Portable & Universal Motor-cum-Pump Performance Monitor (PU-MPPM); & i-Power Quality Analyser (IPQA)
  - Optical Module & Beam Combiner Assembly – transferred to Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL), Panchkula
- Affordable IoT-enabled Water Service Delivery, Measurement & Monitoring Sensing System for Rural Deployment – commercially launched through M/s Biometry Technologies Pvt Ltd, New Delhi
- It also recognised royalty earnings of ₹1.67 Cr received from BEL (Panchkula) during FY26
  - For licensed production of indigenous military avionics technologies

Join us

News - 265

- ICAR-CMFRI (Kochi) – launched "DeepDATA", a mobile application
  - It enables users to explore scientifically verified information on deep-sea fish species
- Developed under – 'Deep Ocean Mission' project | Funding support from – Ministry of Earth Sciences
- HQs of CMFRI – Kochi, Kerala | Director – Grinson George | Founded in – 1947

News - 266

- NASA – revealed a new mission concept, "PRAXIS (Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling)"
  - To achieve first-ever direct sampling of planetary ring particles, using an AI-enabled autonomous robotic spacecraft
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

Appointments & Resignations

News - 267

- Mahesh Dixit (Special Director, IB) – appointed as Director of IB for 2 years (succeeding - Tapan Kumar Deka)
- Intelligence Bureau – established in 1887 as Central Special Branch, functioning under Ministry of Home Affairs
- HQs of IB – New Delhi | Director – Mahesh Dixit

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News - 268

- Abelardo de la Espriella (Defensores de la Patria movement) – appointed as President of Colombia
  - Succeeding – Gustavo Petro | Defeated – Iván Cepeda (Pacto Histórico party)
- Colombia – Bogota – Colombian Peso | President – Abelardo de la Espriella

News - 269

- Dr. U.P. Rajeev – appointed as new Director of Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC), Thiruvananthapuram
  - Succeeding – Dr. A. Rajarajan
- He was previously serving as – Associate Director (Research & Development) at VSSC
- HQs of VSSC – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala | Director – Dr. U.P. Rajeev

News - 270

- Sanjay Jaju – appointed as Chief Secretary of Telangana (succeeding - K. Ramakrishna Rao)
- On assumption of charge, he will additionally hold:
  - Full Additional Charge (FAC) as Special Chief Secretary to Government, Industries & Commerce and ITE&C (Information Technology, Electronics & Communications) Departments

Join us

- Special Chief Secretary & CEO of Industry & Investment Cell in CMO & Smart Proactive Efficient and Effective Delivery (SPEED) initiative

- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla

News - 271

- Prabhjeet Singh (former President of Uber India & South Asia) – appointed as MD for India of OpenAI, w.e.f. Sep 2026
- HQs of OpenAI – San Francisco, USA | Chairman – Bret Taylor | CEO – Sam Altman | Established in – 2015

News - 272

- Vikram Misri (India's 35th Foreign Secretary) – tenure extended as Foreign Secretary for 1 year, until July 14, 2027

News - 273

- Ravi Agrawal – reappointed as Chairman of Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) on a contract basis for 6 months
  - With effect from Jul 1, 2026 to Dec 31, 2026
- CBDT – established under Central Board of Revenue Act, 1963
  - It is apex policy-making & administrative body for direct taxation in India, functioning under Department of Revenue
  - It is headed by a Chairman & may have up to 6 Members in rank of Special Secretary to GoI
- HQs of CBDT – New Delhi | Chairman – Ravi Agrawal | Formed in – 1944

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News - 274

- Keiko Fujimori – to be sworn in as Peru's President on Jul 28, 2026, for a 5-year term | Defeated – Roberto Sánchez
- 1st vice-president – Luis Fernando Galarreta | 2nd vice-president – Miguel Ángel Torres Morales
- Peru – Lima – Sol | PM – Luis Enrique Arroyo Sanchez | President – Jose Jeri (from July 28, 2026 - Keiko Fujimori)

News - 275

- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit – assumed charge as 51st Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS) of Indian Air Force, on Jul 1, 2026
  - Succeeding – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor
- He previously served as – Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (CISC) at Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff
- He has been awarded Ati Vishisht Seva Medal, Vayu Sena Medal & Vishisht Seva Medal
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 276

- Dr Bijay Kumar Mohanty – assumed additional charge as CMD of IREDA (succeeding - Pradip Kumar Das)
- He currently serves as – Director (Finance) & Chief Financial Officer of IREDA
- IREDA – a Navratna CPSE under MNRE
- HQs of IREDA – New Delhi | CMD – Dr Bijay Kumar Mohanty | Motto – "Energy for Ever" | Founded – 1987

Join us

News - 277

- Air Marshal Tejinder Singh – took over as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) at Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS), New Delhi
  - Succeeding – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit
- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit – elevated to Vice Chief of Air Staff
- He is a Category 'A' Qualified Flying Instructor
- He has been awarded Vayu Sena Medal (2007), Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (2022) & Param Vishisht Seva Medal (2026)

News - 278

- Somnath Ghosh – appointed as next High Commissioner of India to Malaysia
- He is currently serving as – Consul General of India at Consulate General of India, Chicago, USA
- Bilateral trade between India & Malaysia – ~$23 billion in FY25
- Malaysia – Kuala Lumpur – Ringgit | PM – Anwar Ibrahim | King – Sultan Ibrahim Iskandar

News - 279

- Lt. General Sandeep Jain – assumed the charge as the Vice Chief of the Army Staff (succeeding - Gen Dhiraj Seth)
- Most recently, he served as General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Southern Command
  - Lt Gen Rajesh Pushkar – took over as the new GOC-in-C of the Southern Command
- Gen Dhiraj Seth – assumed charge as 31st Chief of Army Staff (COAS) (succeeding - Gen Upendra Dwivedi)
- He unveiled a five-pillar transformation roadmap called "VIJAY"
  - Aim: To build a technology-enabled, future-ready Army capable of operating across multiple domains
- 'VIJAY' stands for: 'V' – Vigilance & Readiness | 'I' – Innovation & Transformation
  - 'J' – Jointness & Integration among three armed services | 'A' – Aatmanirbharta | 'Y' – Yoddha First
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 280

- Chandrasekharan Raghuram – assumed charge as CMD of Hindustan Shipyard Ltd (succeeding - Ganti Venkateswarlu)
- Previously, he is serving as – Assistant Chief of Materiel at Naval Headquarters
- He was awarded Vishisht Seva Medal in 2017
- HSL – founded in 1941 & nationalised in 1952 & holds Miniratna Category-I status under Ministry of Defence
- HSL + GRSE = an MoU, in Feb 2026, to form a consortium for a national shipbuilding programme
- HQs of Hindustan Shipyard Ltd – Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh | CMD – Chandrasekharan Raghuram

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News - 281

- Biswanath Sinha (Bihar) – assumed charge as Chief Secretary of Government of Kerala on Jul 1, 2026
  - Succeeding – Dr. A. Jayathilak
- Currently, he is serving as – Additional Chief Secretary, Home & Vigilance Department of Kerala
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 282

- Alok Kumar Mittal – appointed as Director General of Bureau of Police Research & Development till Jun 20, 2029
- Amit Garg (Director, SVPNPA) – appointed as Director of National Crime Records Bureau (succeeding - Alok Ranjan)
- Sujeet Pandey – appointed as Director of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (succeeding - Amit Garg)

News - 283

- Prathit Bhobe – resigned as MD & CEO of Tata Asset Management Pvt Ltd (w.e.f. Jul 7)
- Anand Vardarajan – appointed as new CEO & MD of TAMPL (w.e.f. Jul 10)
- Hemant Kumar – appointed as Chief Business Officer of TAMPL
- HQs of TAMPL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Rajiv Sabharwal | CEO & MD – Anand Vardarajan

News - 284

- Pankaj Mohan Pawar – appointed as CEO of Jio Platforms, w.e.f. Mar 24, 2026 (succeeding - Kiran Mathew Thomas)
- He continues to serve as – MD of Reliance Jio Infocomm
- HQs of Jio Platforms – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Group CEO – Pankaj Mohan Pawar

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News - 285

- Serhii Koretskyi – appointed as Ukraine's new Prime Minister (succeeding - Yulia Svyrydenko)
- Koretskyi previously served as – CEO of Naftogaz of Ukraine (state-owned oil & gas company)
- Ukraine – Kyiv – Ukrainian Hryvnia | President – Volodymyr Zelenskyy | PM – Serhii Koretskyi

News - 286

- Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala – appointed as Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences (succeeding - Dr. M. Ravichandran)
  - He previously served as – Director of Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS), Hyderabad
- He has been conferred with – 'National Geosciences Award' in 2010 from Ministry of Mines
  - 'Indian National Geospatial Award' in 2008 from Indian Society of Remote Sensing
- MoS (I/C) in Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

Join us

News - 287

- Mindaugas Sinkevičius (Lithuanian Social Democratic Party) – appointed as Lithuania's new Prime Minister
  - He became 3rd Social Democrat to hold this post | Replacing – Inga Ruginienė
- Lithuania – Vilnius – Euro | President – Gitanas Nausėda | PM – Mindaugas Sinkevičius

News - 288

- Rahul Himalian (Director (Tourism & Marketing), IRCTC) – given additional charge of CMD of IRCTC for 3 months
  - Succeeding – Sanjay Kumar Jain
- He has been serving as a Whole-Time Functional Director on Board of IRCTC, a Schedule 'A' Navratna CPSE
- HQs of IRCTC – New Delhi | CMD – Rahul Himalian

News - 289

- Andy Burnham – became new PM in UK, 7th in a decade (replacing - Keir Starmer)
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – Andy Burnham | New King – King Charles lll

News - 290

- Bassirou Diomaye Faye (Senegal's President) – elected as new Chairman of Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)
  - Succeeding – Julius Maada Bio (Sierra Leonean President)
  - During 69th Ordinary Session of Authority of Heads of State & Government – held in Sierra Leone
- General Birame Diop – elected as President of ECOWAS Commission for 2026-2030 term (succeeding - Omar Touray)
- HQs of ECOWAS Commission – Abuja, Nigeria | Commission President (Incoming) – General Birame Diop | Authority Chair (Rotating) – Bassirou Diomaye Faye (Senegal) | Established in – 1975

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News - 291

- Harjit Singh Grewal – assumed charge as Chairman of National Commission for Minorities (succeeding - Iqbal Singh Lalpura)
  - Notified by MoMA under Sections 3 & 4 of 'National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992'
- S. Munawari Begum (representing Muslim community) – assumed office as Vice-Chairperson
- Glenn E. Souza Ticlo (representing Christian community) – appointed as a Member
- Berjis Desai (representing Parsi community) – earlier joined Commission as a Member
- Grewal, Begum & Ticlo – each will serve a 3-year term
- NCM – a statutory body established under National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992
- HQs of NCM – New Delhi | Chairperson – Harjit Singh Grewal | Vice-Chairperson – S. Munawari Begum | Established in – 1993

Join us

News - 292

- Anurag Jain – appointed as CEO of NITI Aayog for 2 years (succeeding - Nidhi Chibber)
- Ashok Barnwal – appointed as officiating Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh (succeeding - Anurag Jain)
- 11th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog – held at Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi
  - Theme – "Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat@2047"
- Ashok Kumar Lahiri – appointed as Vice Chairperson of NITI Aayog in Apr 2026 (succeeding - Suman K Bery)
- Rajiv Gauba, Prof. K.V. Raju, Prof. Gobardhan Das, Dr M. Srinivas & Prof. Abhay Karandikar – appointed as full-time Members of NITI Aayog in Apr 2026
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News – 293

- Pralhad Joshi – appointed as India's new Education Minister (succeeding - Dharmendra Pradhan)
- He is already serving as – Union Minister of New & Renewable Energy, and Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution
- PM Modi announced the formation of a High-Powered Task Force on Examination Reforms to strengthen the anti-paper leak law
  - Headed by – Nandan Nilekani (Infosys co-founder)
- Minister of Education: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad-Hubballi, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Education: Jayant Chaudhary & Sukanta Majumdar

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News - 294

- Arkady Dvorkovich – resigned from the post of President of FIDE, with immediate effect
- Viswanathan Anand (Deputy President of FIDE) – assumed role of Interim President
- Anand – elected as FIDE Deputy President in Aug 2022
- HQs of FIDE – Lausanne, Switzerland | Interim President – Viswanathan Anand | Founded on – July 20, 1924

News - 295

- Ashiss Kumar Dash – appointed as CEO Designate of Infosys for 5 years, w.e.f. Apr 1, 2027 (to succeed - Salil Parekh)
- He became 2nd highest-paid CEO among India's top IT companies (1st – HCLTech's C Vijayakumar)
- HQs of Infosys – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Chairman – Nandan Nilekani | CEO & MD – Salil Parekh | CEO Designate (Incoming) – Ashiss Kumar Dash | Established in – 1981

Join us

Awards, Rewards, Recognition & Prizes

News - 296

- Parveen Shaikh & Barkha Subba (Indian Women Conservationists) = received "Whitley Award" for 2026 ('Green Oscar')
  - In recognition of their exemplary work in protecting Endangered species
- They received their awards from UK's Princess Anne, at a ceremony in London at Royal Geographical Society
- Parveen Shaikh (BNHS) – conferred for her ongoing work on Indian skimmers
- Barkha Subba (FSEP) – conferred for studying Himalayan salamander in Darjeeling Himalaya in West Bengal
- Other Whitley award winners this year – Marina Kameni (Cameroon), Moreangels Mbizah (Zimbabwe), Paola Sangolqui (Ecuador) & Issah Seidu (Ghana)
- Other Indian conservationists who have won this award in past – Sanjay Gubbi (2017) & Purnima Barman (2024)
- Annual Whitley Award – instituted by UK charity Whitley Fund for Nature
  - It will provide winners with funding amounting to £50,000 for 1 year, training & profile boosts

News - 297

- 7 Indian schools have been named in top 10 shortlist for "World's Best School Prizes 2026" in London

  (i) PCMC Chhatrapati Shahuji Maharaj English Medium School, Pune – in 'Innovation' category

  (ii) Army Goodwill School Wuzur, Anantnag, J&K – in 'Innovation' category

  (iii) Healthy Planet TGA Early Years School, Noida – in 'Community Collaboration' category

  (iv) Inventure Academy, Bengaluru – in 'Community Collaboration' category

  (v) Seth M.R. Jaipuria School, Lucknow – in 'Community Collaboration' category

  (vi) EuroSchool Bannerghatta, Bengaluru – in 'Environmental Action' category

  (vii) Seth Anandram Jaipuria School, Lucknow – in 'Supporting Healthy Lives' category
- India set a new record with highest number of schools shortlisted in a single year by any country
- World's Best School Prizes – founded by T4 Education (UK)
- Winners & shortlisted schools – to be invited to 'World Schools Summit' in London in Jan 2027

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News - 298

- Viswanathan Anand – conferred "Sports Journalists' Federation of India (SJFI) Medal"
  - At a ceremony held at Madras Cricket Club (MCC), Chennai
  - Organised by = SJFI + Tamil Nadu Sports Journalists' Association (TNSJA)
- Presented by – V. Baskaran, Indian hockey player who won an Olympic gold medal at 1980 Moscow Olympics
- Chief Guest – K. Srikkanth (Former India cricket captain) | Citation was read by – R. Mohan
- SJFI Medal – an annual recognition by Sports Journalists' Federation of India
- Viswanathan Anand – 15th undisputed World Chess Champion & a 5-time FIDE World Chess Champion
  - 2000, 2007, 2008, 2010 & 2012
- He is also a 2-time World Rapid Chess Champion (2003, 2017) & World Blitz Chess Cup winner (2000)

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- He became India's 1st International Grandmaster in 1988 & was 1st Asian to win FIDE World Junior Championship in 1987
- He was 1st recipient of Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award (1991-92)
- He received Padma Vibhushan in 2007, becoming 1st sportsperson in India to receive that distinction
- FIDE designated Anand 'Father of the Indian Chess Boom' for his transformative role in popularising chess across India
- He holds 8th-highest peak FIDE rating of all time (2817) & was elected Deputy President of FIDE in 2022

News - 299

- "International Meteorological Organization (IMO) Prize" – awarded to Dr. Florence Rabier (France)
- She will formally collect IMO Prize & deliver traditional IMO Prize Lecture during World Meteorological Congress in 2027
- 2025 IMO laureate, Prof. Xu Jianmin (China) – delivered his IMO Prize lecture at WMO Executive Council on Jun 24, 2026
- HQs of WMO – Geneva, Switzerland | SG – Celeste Saulo | President – Dr Abdulla Al Mandous

News - 300

- Sunil Bharti Mittal (Founder & Chairman of Bharti Enterprises) – presented with '2026 Leadership Award' by USISPF
  - Award was conferred during – 'IX USISPF Leadership Summit' held in Washington, D.C.
- Other global business leaders also honoured with '2026 Leadership Award':
  - V Prem Watsa (Chairman & CEO of Fairfax Financial Holdings)
  - Christopher T Calio (Chairman & CEO of RTX Corporation)
- USISPF – a non-profit organisation working to strengthen India-US strategic & commercial partnership
- HQs of USISPF – Washington, US | President & CEO – Mukesh Aghi | Formed in – 2017

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News - 301

- Nita Ambani – conferred 'AAPI Humanitarian Award' by American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)
  - During its annual convention in Tampa, Florida (Jul 2 to 5, 2026)
  - Presented by – Dr Amit Chakrabarty (AAPI President)
- Jane Castor (Tampa Mayor) also presented Ambani with 'Key to the City of Tampa'
  - He also declared 2nd July & remainder of July 4th weekend as 'AAPI Day' for city
- AAPI – established in 1982, represents physicians of Indian origin practising in US
- It was Ambani's 2nd major honour of 2026
  - 1st – Honorary Doctorate from Kalinga Institute of Industrial Technology University, Bhubaneswar (March)

News - 302

- 'ICMR-MINDS' (a National Health Research Priority project) – conferred Gold Award under Category 2, 'Innovation by Use of AI and Other New Age Technologies for Providing Citizen-Centric Services'
  - At "National Awards for e-Governance 2026" – instituted by DARPG, MoPPG&P
- Award was presented during 29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026, held in Jaipur, Rajasthan

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- ICMR-MINDS – an implementation research study on integrating screening & management of mental & substance use disorders with other non-communicable diseases
- This initiative is currently implemented across 7 states, through collaborating institutions
  - AIIMS Guwahati, AIIMS New Delhi, AIIMS Bhopal, AIIMS Bhubaneswar, Gujarat Institute of Mental Health
  - St. John's Medical College Bengaluru & PGIMER Chandigarh
- HQs of ICMR – New Delhi, India | Director General – Rajiv Bahl | Established in – 1911

News - 303

- Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA) selected 15 early-career researchers (including two from India)
  - For inaugural cohort of its Global Biofuel Champion Fellowship (GBCF)
  - At an award ceremony held on Jun 30 at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
- Indian selected are: Ruchi Agrawal (TERI) & Abhisek Sahoo (IIT Delhi)
- Each fellow will receive a $15,000 research grant & will serve as a GBA Ambassador for next two years
- GBA – comprises 34 countries & 14 international Org. | Interim Director General – Dr. Neeraj Mittal

News - 304

- Jestha Varna Mahavihar – received "2025 UNESCO Asia-Pacific Award of Merit" at a ceremony held in Lalitpur
  - Under UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation
  - It is a 17th-century Buddhist monastery in Lalitpur, Nepal
- It was damaged in 2015 Gorkha earthquake & was restored under GoI's post-earthquake reconstruction grant
  - At a cost of – NPR 13.78 Cr
  - Indian National Trust for Art & Cultural Heritage (INTACH) – appointed as Project Management Consultant
  - It works alongside Central Level Project Implementation Unit (CLPIU) of Government of Nepal
- GoI committed $1 billion in assistance for Nepal's post-earthquake reconstruction
- Nepal – Kathmandu – Nepalese Rupee | President – Ram Chandra Poudel | PM – Balendra Shah

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News - 305

- India + Indonesia = comprises 14 MoUs & agreements along with 6 major announcements
  - Key defence outcomes included: Cooperation on BrahMos missile system
  - An Air-to-Air Missile Cooperation Agreement
  - An extension of MoU & Implementation Arrangement on Maritime Safety & Security Cooperation
- India + Indonesia = an MoU on cooperation in minerals & steel supply chain technology
- ONDC (India) + ION (Indonesia) = to cooperate on digital public infrastructure
- ECI (India) + General Elections Commission (Indonesia) = an MoU for knowledge-sharing on administrative practices
- CDSCO (India) + BPOM (Indonesia) = an MoU to strengthen healthcare cooperation
- IIM Bangalore – to establish an overseas campus at Singhasari Special Economic Zone in Indonesia

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- India + Indonesia = extended Framework Agreement on Exploration & Uses of Outer Space for Peaceful Purposes
- 2026-27 – to be observed as 'Tagore-Dewantara Year'
- PM Modi – conferred "Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia", Indonesia's highest civilian & military honour
  - By – Prabowo Subianto (Indonesian President) at Istana Merdeka, Presidential Palace, in Jakarta
  - This award was instituted in – 1959
- Indonesia – Jakarta – Indonesian Rupiah | President – Prabowo Subianto

News - 306

- Nita Ambani – ranked No. 1 in "Fortune India's Most Powerful Women (MPW) 2026" list
- She was conferred 'AAPI Humanitarian Award' by American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin in Tampa, Florida

News - 307

- 'Egmont Group Plenary' – held in Baku, Azerbaijan
- FIU-IND – Runner-up at "Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026"
  - Top award – Taiwan's Anti-Money Laundering Division
- Based on FIU-IND's 'Operational Analysis Report', ED conducted searches at 13 locations
  - It seized ₹47 lakh in cash & cryptocurrency (worth ~₹13.6 Cr), attached assets valued at ₹8.67 Cr & filed 2 Prosecution Complaints under PMLA, 2002
- Best Egmont Case Award – established in 2011
- FIU-IND – established in Nov 2004 under Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance
- HQs of FIU-IND – New Delhi | Director – Amit Mohan Govil

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News - 308

- "Samriddh Gram: Integrated Phygital Service Delivery Model Enabled by BharatNet" (DoT) – won 'World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026' under Action Line C6, Enabling Environment
  - Presented during 'WSIS Forum 2026' in Geneva, Switzerland
- WSIS Prizes – instituted under WSIS process led by ITU
- Samriddh Gram – built on BharatNet network

News - 309

- Sourav Ganguly, Anjum Chopra & Kevin Pietersen – inducted into ICC Hall of Fame as Class of 2026
  - At a ceremony held in Edinburgh
- Now, total number of ICC Hall of Fame members – 125
- Anjum Chopra – lone woman inductee this year & 3rd Indian woman to enter ICC Hall of Fame
  - After – Diana Edulji (2023) & Neetu David (2024)
- ICC Hall of Fame – launched in Jan 2009 as part of ICC's centenary celebrations
- HQs of ICC – Dubai, UAE | Chairman – Jay Shah | CEO – Sanjog Gupta | Members – 108 countries

Join us

News - 310

- Dr Nandini Azad – conferred 'Bharat Samman 2026'
  - Presented by – International Institute of Education & Management with Economic Growth Foundation (New Delhi)
- She is President of Working Women's Forum (India) & Indian Cooperative Network for Women (ICNW)
- She is also a long-standing member of Board of Directors of Internationale Raiffeisen Union (IRU)

News - 311

- Gujarat – conferred "Agriculture Leadership Award 2026" at 17th Agriculture Leadership Conclave held in New Delhi
  - Award was presented by – Rajnath Singh (Defence Minister)
  - Received by – Jitu Vaghani (Gujarat Agriculture Minister)
- Agriculture Leadership Award – instituted in 2008 by Agriculture Today Group (established in 1998)
  - On advice of renowned agricultural scientist Dr M.S. Swaminathan
  - Award selection committee is headed by – Justice P. Sathasivam (former Chief Justice of India)
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 312

- 72nd National Film Awards (2024) – announced by Ministry of Information & Broadcasting (in July 2026)
- Jury: Feature Film jury headed by – Jayaraj | Non-Feature Film jury headed by – Aseem Sinha
  - Best Writing on Cinema jury headed by – A. Chandrasekhar
- **Feature Films Section (some important awardees):**
  - Best Feature Film – 'Article 370' (directed by Aditya Suhas Jambhale)
  - Best Actor in a Leading Role – Kartik Aaryan (for 'Chandu Champion') & Mammootty (for 'Bramayugam')
  - Best Actress in a Leading Role – Yami Gautam (for 'Article 370')
  - Best Director – Rajkumar Periasamy (for 'Amaran')
  - Best Film Promoting National, Social, and Environmental Values – 'Captain Miller'
  - Best Debut Film of a Director – Randeep Hooda (for 'Swatantrya Veer Savarkar')
  - Best Children's Film – '35 Chinna Katha Kaadu'
  - Best Cinematography – Shehnad Jalal (for 'Bramayugam')
  - Best Music Direction – Shashwat Sachdev (for 'Article 370')
  - Best Background Music – GV Prakash (for 'Amaran')
  - Best Lyrics – Manoj Muntashir (for 'Maidaan')
  - Best Male Playback Singer – Abhay Jodhpurkar (for "Gharat Ganpati" from 'Navasachi Gauri Mazi')
  - Best Female Playback Singer – Vaikom Vijayalakshmi (for "Angu Vaana Konilu" from 'ARM')
  - Best Choreography – Vijay Ganguly (for 'Stree 2')
  - Special Mention – Dhanush (for 'Captain Miller') & Suren G (for 'Meiyazhagan')
- **Non-Feature Films Section (some important awardees):**

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- Best Non-Feature Film – 'Bhangaar' (directed by Sumira Roy)
- Best Debut Film of a Director – 'Angen'
- Best Animation Film – 'Touched as Water'
- Best Non-Feature Film Promoting Social and Environmental Values – 'Piplantri: A Tale of Eco Feminism'
- Best Documentary – 'Ram-Nami'
- Best Short Film (Up to 30 Minutes) – 'Hamsafar'
- Best Direction – Aanand L Rai (for 'Statue of Unity – Ekta ka Prateek')
- Best Cinematography – Edmond Ranson (for 'Life in Loom')
- Best Film Critic – Sanjeev Shrivastava
- Special Mention – 'Bhadra-Kali Natakam' & 'Chola Dora aur Sui'

News - 313

- Ajit Doval (India's longest-serving NSA) – selected for "Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026" (44th edition)
  - It will be presented by – Amit Shah (Union Home Minister) | At a ceremony in Pune on Aug 1, 2026
  - It comprises – a memento, a citation & a cash prize of ₹1 lakh
- Lokmanya Tilak National Award – Instituted in 1983 by Lokmanya Tilak Smarak Trust & is presented annually
  - S.M. Joshi (socialist leader) – its 1st recipient
  - Past recipients: Narendra Modi (2023), former PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Manmohan Singh, Indira Gandhi, and former President Pranab Mukherjee

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News - 314

- R. Vairamuthu – conferred with 60th Jnanpith Award, for 2025 | Presented by – Dr Karan Singh
  - At a ceremony held at Chinmaya Mission Auditorium, New Delhi
- He became 3rd Tamil writer to receive this award (after Akilan in 1975 & D. Jayakanthan in 2002)
- He has been selected by Bharatiya Jnanpith Selection Committee (chaired by Pratibha Ray)
- He received – a cash prize of ₹11 lakh, a bronze statue of Vagdevi, Goddess Saraswati & a citation
- He previously won 'Sahitya Akademi Award' in 2003 for his novel Kallikattu Ithikasam
- He has been also honoured with Padma Shri in 2003 & Padma Bhushan in 2014
- Jnanpith Award – instituted in 1961 by Bharatiya Jnanpith (a cultural organisation established in 1944)
  - It was first presented in 1965 to Malayalam poet G. Sankara Kurup

News - 315

- Prem K. Vora – conferred with "Rashtriya Ashok Samman", at National Leadership Conclave held in New Delhi
  - He is President for 2025-2026 of Electric Merchants Association (EMA), Mumbai
- He is the youngest President in history of Electric Merchants Association
- He has previously been honoured with: 'Global Youth Ambassador Award' – in 2025 & 2026
  - 'Iconic Emerging Leader in the Electrical Industry' award – in 2025

Join us

News - 316

- Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath (UP) – inscribed on "UNESCO World Heritage List" in July 2026
  - During 48th session of UNESCO World Heritage Committee – held in Busan, South Korea
- It is India's 45th World Heritage Site & Uttar Pradesh's 4th (after Taj Mahal, Agra Fort & Fatehpur Sikri)
- Now, India ranks 6th in world & 2nd in Asia-Pacific region, with a total of 45 World Heritage sites
  - It comprises: 37 cultural, 7 natural & 1 mixed property
- Sarnath has its legacy preserved today across 2 protected archaeological sites:
  - Chaukhandi Stupa | Archaeological Remains of Sarnath (including Dhamek Stupa & Dharmarajika Stupa)
- Sarnath – 1st included on UNESCO's Tentative List in July 1998
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel
- HQs of UNESCO – Paris, France | DG – Khaled El-Enany | Founded in – 1945 | Members – 194 Countries

News - 317

- President Droupadi Murmu – conferred with an 'Honorary Doctorate' by Bucharest University of Economic Studies
  - At a ceremony in Bucharest, Romania
- Bucharest University of Economic Studies – founded in 1913
- India + Romania = signed 3 agreements in Science & Technology, Education and Sports (in July 2026)
- Romania – Bucharest – Romanian Leu | President – Nicușor Dan | PM – Ilie Bolojan

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Schemes & Initiatives

News - 318

- MCA – signed a multi-party MoU to roll out "Corporate Mitra Scheme"
  - Among IIT Madras, IIT Pravartak, SWAYAM Plus, ICAI, ICSI & ICMAI
- Corporate Mitra Scheme – announced in Union Budget 2026-27
  - It is open to Indian nationals up to 30 years of age who are graduates or are in final year of graduation
- It runs for 12 months comprising ~150 hours of online expert-led academic learning through SWAYAM Plus portal
  - Followed by 6 months of on-the-job training with professional firms
- SWAYAM Plus – India's digital learning platform under Ministry of Education
- IIT Pravartak – IIT Madras's technology innovation hub
- Minister of Corporate Affairs: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Corporate Affairs: Harsh Malhotra

Join us

News - 319

- "Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)" – launched on Jul 1, 2015
  - Since 2016-17, its central assistance exceed – ₹64,407 Cr
- PMKSY operates through 4 components
  - 'Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme (AIBP)' – received ₹21,023 Cr in central assistance since 2016-17
  - Under 'Har Khet Ko Pani', 3,462 Surface Minor Irrigation & Repair, Renovation & Restoration schemes have completed
  - 'Watershed Development' – received ₹12,432.09 Cr since 2016-17
  - 'Per Drop More Crop (PDMC)'
- GoI approved PMKSY's continuation for 2021-26 with an overall outlay of ₹93,068.56 Cr
  - Union Budget 2026-27 allocated ₹6,587 Cr to this scheme
- In 2025-26, 'Modernization of Command Area Development and Water Management (M-CADWM)' – approved as a sub-scheme of PMKSY-AIBP with an initial outlay of ₹1,600 Cr

News - 320

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan reviewed implementation of 'Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin)'
  - He released 1st installment, 'Mother Sanction', of ₹25,863 Cr to states for implementing this scheme (VB-G-RAM-G)
- VB-G RAM G Act (replacing MGNREGA) – came into force nationwide from Jul 1, 2026
  - It provides a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment per year | Total budget – ₹1,51,282 Cr
  - Wage rates – increased by around 10% on average | It ensures no state now has a wage rate below ₹300 per day
- 1st installment is released to ensure states have adequate funds to pay wages within 15 days
  - Earlier interim allocation – ₹95,692.31 Cr
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 321

- Suvendu Adhikari announced a special assistance package of ₹313.30 Cr for tea garden workers
  - Concentrated across plains & hills of North Bengal, under "Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY)"
- It comprises 3 main components: 'Cha Shramik Shiksha Yojana' – largest allocation of ₹177 Cr
  - 'Cha Shramik Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (CSSSY)' – with ₹72 Cr
  - 'Cha Shramik Aashray Yojana (CSAY)' – with ₹63 Cr
- North Bengal Development Department (NBDD) – to serve as nodal agency
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

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News - 322

- Govt approved pan-India rollout of ₹60,000 Cr "Pradhan Mantri Skilling & Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU)" scheme across 200 ITI clusters
  - At 4th meeting of National Steering Committee (NSC) on PM-SETU
  - Chaired by – Debashree Mukherjee (Secretary, MSDE)
- Committee cleared 5 Strategic Investment Plans (SIPs), recommended by respective State Steering Committees
  - Combined outlay – ₹1,237.58 Cr | To upgrade ITI clusters across Odisha, Gujarat & Telangana

News - 323

- Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 – issued 4,11,497 guarantees since its launch
  - Total guaranteed amount – reached ₹1,55,229 Cr
- It was approved by Union Cabinet on May 5, with an outlay of ₹18,100 Cr
- All loans sanctioned until end of FY27 are eligible under this scheme
- It offers a 100% govt guarantee on additional loans to MSMEs & a 90% guarantee for other eligible business segments
- Under this scheme, businesses can avail additional credit of up to 20% of peak working capital utilised during Jan-Mar
  - Subject to a cap of – ₹100 Cr
- Airlines can access credit of up to 100% of their working capital, capped at ₹1,500 Cr per borrower
- MSMEs have accounted for 98% of total number of guarantees issued & 82% of total guaranteed amount under scheme
- DFS led a nationwide outreach campaign in collaboration with SLBCs, NCGTC, PSB Alliance, banks & industry associations
- ECLGS – launched in 2020 to provide a 100% guarantee cover to support businesses during COVID-19 pandemic

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News - 324

- Yogi Adityanath (UP) – formally launched "Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Yojana" in Varanasi
  - It will provide cashless medical treatment of up to ₹5 lakh per year at government & empanelled private hospitals
  - To teachers, non-teaching staff & their dependent family members under Basic & Secondary Education Departments
- It was formally approved by State Cabinet on Jan 29, 2026
- Annual financial outlay – ₹448 Cr (₹358.61 Cr for basic education & ₹89.25 Cr for secondary education)
- Beneficiaries are required to complete their Health Card registration by Jun 6, 2026
- Basic Education Department + SBI = MoU to provide social security cover to ~10 lakh teachers & contractual employees
  - It makes Uttar Pradesh first state to implement such a scheme for its teaching workforce
- CM also transferred ₹1,320 Cr through DBT to bank accounts of parents of ~1.10 crore students under Basic Education Council, at rate of ₹1,200 per student
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

Join us

News - 325

- N Chandrababu Naidu (AP CM) – launched "Pillale Sampada" (Children are Wealth) initiative
  - While addressing a World Population Day programme in Vijayawada
  - To encourage balanced population growth to secure state's demographic future
- Families will receive financial assistance of ₹30,000 for birth of a 3rd child & ₹40,000 for birth of a 4th child
- Andhra Pradesh aims to achieve a per capita income of ₹55 lakh by 2047
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 326

- Cabinet approved Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) | Outlay – ₹62,500 Cr
  - To scale up domestic mobile phone production, deepen domestic value addition, strengthen supply chain resilience
  - It will run for 5 years (from FY27 to FY31)
- Production Linked Incentive Scheme for Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing (PLI-LSEM) – concluded on Mar 31, 2026
- India is now world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume
- Smartphones – India's single largest exported product category in 2025

News - 327

- MoHUA approved operational guidelines for "PARIVARTAN Scheme"
  - PARIVARTAN – Programme for Accelerated Renewal & Incentivization of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air Pollution & Network Emissions
  - To facilitate replacement of highly polluting trucks & buses operating in NCR with cleaner BS-VI compliant or EVs
- Total outlay – ₹9,585 Cr | It includes budgetary support of ₹5,041 Cr from Centre
- Ministry of Road Transport & Highways – to serve as implementing Ministry
- It offers a comprehensive package of incentives, including: Motor Vehicle Tax concessions | Registration fee waivers
  - 5% interest subvention – on vehicle loans | Minimum 8% OEM discount on eligible new vehicles
  - Monthly fuel voucher support – for eligible diesel & CNG replacement vehicles
  - One-time financial assistance – for electric replacement vehicles, along with Certificate of Deposit (CoD) trading
- 11 major OEMs – signed MoUs to provide discounts under this scheme
- Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs: Manohar Lal Khattar | Constituency – Karnal, Haryana
  MoS in Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs: Tokhan Sahu

News - 328

- EPFO – launched "VISHWAS, 2026", a one-time dispute resolution scheme for settlement of penalty/damages disputes
  - under Section 14B of 'EPF & MP Act, 1952' & Section 128 of 'Code on Social Security, 2020'
- It is effective immediately for 6 months to promote voluntary compliance, reduce litigation & enable speedy resolution of pending penalty/damages disputes

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- Coverage: 4 categories – Cases pending before judicial forums; recovery pending/partly completed; notices issued but final orders pending; notices not yet issued
- Defaults before June 14, 2024 eligible for reduced damages: 0.25%/month (up to 2 months), 0.50%/month (2 to <4 months), 1%/month (>4 months)
- Employers must pay entire applicable interest before applying through EPFO Employer Portal using DSC/e-Sign
- HQs of EPFO – New Delhi | CEO – Ramesh Krishnamurthi | Established in – 1952

News – 329

- As per data presented by Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI) in Lok Sabha:
- Maharashtra – leading state in terms of manufacturing units established under Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme
  - For automobile & auto component industry, with 66 units
- 2nd – Tamil Nadu (38 units) | 3rd – Haryana (35 units) | 4th – Karnataka (28 units)
- Units of some other state: UP – 13 | Gujarat – 10 | Uttarakhand – 9 | Rajasthan – 7 | MP – 6 | Telangana – 5
- In total, 225 manufacturing units have been established across India under PLI-Auto scheme
- PLI-Auto scheme – approved in Sep 2021 | Outlay – ₹25,938 Cr
- As of Jul 16, 2026, 18 applicants received Domestic Value Addition certificates covering 154 products or variants

News - 330

- "Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP)" initiative – launched by PM on Jan 22, 2015, at Panipat, Haryana
  - To address declining Child Sex Ratio (CSR) in India & related issues of empowerment of girls & women
  - Jointly implemented by – Ministries of Women & Child Development, Health & Family Welfare, and Education
- Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB) at national level – increased to 929 in 2024-25 (from 918 in 2014-15)
- Gross enrolment ratio of girls in schools at secondary level – rose to 80.2% in 2024-25 (from 75.51% in 2014-15)

News - 331

- Cabinet approved "Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana Rasayan (or BHAVYA Rasayan) Scheme"
  - To establish 3 dedicated Chemical Parks in country | Total outlay – ₹3,030 Cr
- It will run for 5 years (from FY27 to FY31) | Total outlay – ₹3,000 Cr | It was announced in Union Budget for FY27
- Centre will provide a grant of up to ₹1,000 Cr per park, subject to a minimum contribution of ₹500 Cr by State Govt
- India currently ranks 6th globally & 3rd in Asia in chemical production, with sector contributing around 7% to India's GDP
- Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) initiative – approved earlier in Mar 2026
  - Aim: To develop 100 general-purpose, plug-and-play industrial parks across India | Total outlay – ₹33,660 Cr

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News - 332

- Union Govt approved restructured 'Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice (DISHA) 2.0' scheme
  - It is a Central Sector Scheme under Department of Justice | Total outlay – ₹255 Cr (from 2026-27 to 2030-31)
- Aim: To leverage technology to develop & enhance outreach of citizen-friendly legal service platforms
- It integrates 4 components:
  - 'Tele-Law, Reaching the Unreached' – provides free pre-litigation legal advice (toll-free number 14454)
  - 'Nyaya Bandhu Pro Bono Legal Services Programme' – promotes pro-bono legal services
  - 'Legal Literacy and Legal Awareness Programme' – spreads legal awareness
  - 'VIDHI (Vision for Integrated Delivery of Harmonized Legal Initiatives)-Sanjeevani' platform
- VIDHI-Sanjeevani will also integrate with Nyaya Setu chatbot (launched in Mar 2026)
- DISHA scheme – implemented from 2021 to 2026 with an outlay of ₹250 Cr

News - 333

- Centre extended 'Fast Track Special Courts (FTSC) Scheme' till Sep 30, 2026, with 775 FTSCs
  - It includes 398 exclusive POCSO (e-POCSO) courts, as of Apr 30, 2026
- Centrally Sponsored Scheme to set up FTSCs – launched in Oct 2019
- Funds under FTSC Scheme are released with a Central-State funding share of 60:40 or 90:10 (for certain categories)
- Department released a total of ₹1,259.51 Cr to States & UTs since scheme's inception

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News - 334

- Maharashtra – became 1st state in India to qualify for 2nd installment under Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)
- Union Government earlier released ₹335 Cr as 1st installment under RKVY to Maharashtra
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

News - 335

- Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (HP CM) – launched a welfare scheme, "Mukhyamantri Machhuara Samman Nidhi Yojana"
  - To provide financial assistance & social security to fishermen engaged in reservoir fisheries across state
  - Total annual expenditure – ₹1.20 Cr
- Eligible beneficiaries will receive financial assistance of ₹3,500 annually during fishing ban period
  - Eligibility is limited to active fishermen engaged in reservoir fisheries through registered Fisheries Cooperative Societies who possess valid licences
- In state's 2026-27 Budget, govt introduced its 1st-ever MSP for reservoir fish, fixed at ₹100 per kilogram
- With a subsidy of up to ₹20 per kilogram if auction prices fall below this level
- HP: Capital – Shimla & Dharamshala | CM – Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu | Governor – Kavinder Gupta

Join us

News - 336

- PM-Vidyalaxmi Scheme – sanctioned 1,12,817 collateral-free & guarantor-free education loans | Worth – ₹15,634 Cr
- It provides an interest subvention benefit for students from families with an annual income of up to ₹8 lakh
  - Offering a 3% interest subvention on education loans of up to ₹10 lakh
- DHE implements PM Uchchatar Shiksha Protsahan Credit Guarantee Fund Scheme for Education Loans (PM-USP CGFSEL)
  - Under which Center provides a credit guarantee, by default covering up to 75% of loan amount
  - For education loans of up to ₹7.5 lakh taken by students without collateral security or a third-party guarantor
- PM-USP CGFSEL scheme – issued 14,65,880 credit guarantees since its launch in 2015 | Worth – ₹59,843.74 Cr
- PM-Vidyalaxmi scheme – approved by Cabinet in Nov 2024

News - 337

- ESIC extended "Atal Beemit Vyakti Kalyan Yojana (ABVKY)", its unemployment allowance scheme, till Jun 30, 2027
  - During 198th meeting of ESIC – chaired by Mansukh Mandaviya (Labour and Employment Minister)
- ABVKY is an unemployment relief scheme for workers covered under 'Employees' State Insurance (ESI) Act, 1948'
- Eligible insured persons can receive cash compensation equal to 50% of their average per day earnings
  - Paid for a maximum of 90 days of unemployment, available only once in a lifetime
  - Subject to employee having completed 2 years of insurable employment & contributed for not less than 78 days in each of 3 consecutive contribution periods immediately preceding claim
- HQs of ESIC – New Delhi | DG – Ashok Kumar Singh

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News - 338

- Delhi – to roll out "Delhi Lakshmi Yojana" with 1st instalment of ₹2,500 to be paid to eligible women on Aug 28
  - Online registration for this scheme – to open on Aug 1, 2026
- Eligibility: Women (21 to 60 years), a resident of Delhi for at least 10 years & eldest eligible woman in their family
  - Eligible households required to use 2,400 units or less of electricity annually & an annual income of ₹2.5 lakh or less
- Women with more than 3 living children will not be eligible for this scheme
- Portal for this scheme would open from Aug 1, 2026
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

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Meetings, Conferences and Summits

News - 339

- Amit Shah chaired 10th "Apex-Level Meeting of the Narco-Coordination Centre (NCORD)" at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Organised by – Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)
- He released "Vision Document on Narcotics Control (2026-2029)" & "NCB Annual Report 2025"
- He also inaugurated newly built NCB Zonal Offices in Jammu & Guwahati
- He also launched "Online Drug Disposal Fortnight Campaign"
- June 26 – 'International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking', a UN International Day observed since 1989
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 340

- JP Nadda chaired 16th 'Conference of Central Council of Health & Family Welfare (CCHFW)' at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
- CCHFW – apex advisory body of MoHFW, serving as institutional mechanism for cooperative federalism in health policy
  - Constituted under – Article 263 of Constitution of India
- He launched several landmark policy documents & digital health initiatives:
  - "Operational Guidelines on National Ambulance Services (NAS), 2026"
  - "SUMAN Roadmap 2030" | "Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK)"
- A series of DPI for Health initiatives developed under NHA & NRCeS was launched:
  - Aarogya Setu 2.0 (upgraded national health app)
  - eSushrut@clinic (a light ABDM-enabled Hospital Management Information System developed by C-DAC)
  - Ayushman Sarathi (PM-JAY WhatsApp chatbot) | Unified Health Interface (UHI) | A Drug Registry
- Key health milestones highlighted: 1.85 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs operational
  - 23 new AIIMS & 157+ new medical colleges established
  - Mission Indradhanush vaccinated 5.46 crore children & 1.32 crore pregnant women
  - HPV Vaccination Drive (launched Feb 28, 2026) reached 50+ lakh adolescent girls
  - India achieved a 21% decline in TB incidence (vs. global 12%), with 92% treatment coverage (vs. global 78%)
  - India also achieved Polio-free status, eliminated Neonatal Tetanus
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

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News - 341

- 16th 'India-Japan Annual Summit' – held at Hyderabad House
- India & Japan announced 16 outcomes focusing on 3 priority areas: economic security, energy resilience & technology
- 3 Joint Statements signed are:

  (1) India-Japan Joint Declaration on Economic Security

  (2) India-Japan Joint Statement on Cooperation in Field of AI

  (3) Joint Statement on Energy Resilience between MoPNG & Japan's METI
- 13 MoUs & agreements include:
  - MoC for India-Japan Cooperative Biogas for Growth (CBG) Initiative | MoC in Field of Batteries
  - MoC in Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices (API, KSM supply chain) | MoC in Geology & Mineral Exploration
  - MoC between IndiaAI Mission & METI Japan | MoC on Next Generation Mobility Partnership (NGMP)
  - MoU between C-CAMP & RIKEN Japan | MoU between NCBS-TIFR & RIKEN Japan
  - MoU between IIT Bombay, BharatGen Technology Foundation & Japan's National Institute of Informatics
  - MoU between SarvamAI & Preferred Networks Japan
  - MoU between NIXI & Japan Network Information Center/JPNIC
  - Exchange of Letters between IFSCA & Japan's Financial Services Agency (FinTech & RegTech cooperation)
  - A declaration designating 2027 as 'India-Japan Year of Shared Horizons'
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

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News - 342

- 3rd India-Australia Annual Summit – held in Melbourne, Australia, & 18 outcomes were released by MEA
- India + Australia = announced a Joint Declaration on Defence & Security Cooperation
- ICG + Maritime Border Command (Australia) = an MoU on maritime law enforcement & domain awareness
- India + Australia = finalised Administrative Arrangement under 2014 India-Australia Civil Nuclear Agreement
- India + Australia = announced operationalisation of a Rooftop Solar Training Academy at Pandit Deendayal Energy University, Gandhinagar
  - Developed with – Australia's Department of Climate Change, Environment & Water, India's Sector Skills Council for Green Jobs & ReNew
- CSIR + IP Australia = agreement for access to India's Traditional Knowledge Digital Library
- CSIR + University of Melbourne = agreement for collaborative drug-discovery research
- Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute (Kolkata) + Griffith Film School = an MoU
- Victoria University – received approval to set up a campus in Gurugram
- Australia – to repatriate 3 antiquities, including an 11th-12th century granite Nandi sculpture & a 12th century basalt Skanda sculpture
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

Join us

News - 343

- 49th Session of Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49) – held in Geneva, Switzerland (Jul 6 to 10, 2026)
  - It adopted 7 Codex standards & guidelines developed under India's chairmanship & co-chairmanship
  - 2 standards, for Dried Coriander Seeds and Fresh Curry Leaves, were developed under India's chairmanship
- It also approved India's proposal to undertake new work for development of a 'Codex Standard for Cashew Kernels'
  - Under Codex Committee on Processed Fruits & Vegetables
- India – also elected Co-Chair of Electronic Working Group on New Food Sources & Production Systems
- Indian delegation was led by – Rajit Punhani (CEO of FSSAI), along with technical experts from FSSAI & Spices Board
- Codex Alimentarius – established in 1963 by FAO & WHO
  - It is currently valued at over $1.7 trillion annually & is recognised by World Trade Organization

News - 344

- 1st-ever 'ICAR Technology Portfolio for Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Conclave 2026' in New Delhi – organised by ICAR & AgIn
- to strengthen partnerships among ICAR, corporate organisations, industry leaders, & philanthropic institutions
- The conclave focused on 5 thematic areas:
  - Climate-Proofing of Indian Agriculture
  - Soil Health Improvement through Nature-Based Solutions and Crop Diversification
  - Agriculture for Health
  - Agricultural Skilling
  - Women in Agriculture and Agricultural Extension
- Conclave was preceded by 4 regional ICAR CSR & Technology Portfolio Roadshows – held in Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Mumbai & Kolkata
- HQs of ICAR – New Delhi | DG – Mangi Lal Jat | Established in – 1929

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News - 345

- THSTI (BRIC) – hosted its 3rd annual industry business meet, 'SYNCHN 2026' (Synergistic Collaboration in Healthcare Innovation), at NCR Biotech Science Cluster campus in Faridabad
- HQs of BRIC – New Delhi | DG – Dr. Rajesh S. Gokhale | Established in – 2023

Join us

Ranks, Reports & Surveys

News - 346

- 8th edition of "Sustainability Impact Ratings 2026" – released by Times Higher Education (THE)
  - At 'Global Sustainable Development Congress' in Jakarta, Indonesia
- Top institute globally – The University of Manchester, UK
  - It remains only university to have finished in overall top 10 since its launch in 2019
  - It also finished outright top in 3 individual SDG tables (SDG 11, 12 & 15) & joint-1st for SDG 9 & SDG 14
- 2nd – Griffith University, Australia
- Asia – accounts for more than half of all ranked universities globally (962 of 1,646)
- Most represented nation (among individual countries) – Philippines (160 universities) | 2nd – India (110 universities)
- India's top-ranked institution (with global rank) – Lovely Professional University (23rd)
  - Followed by – Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham (37th) & JSS Academy of Higher Education & Research (74th)
- Manipal Academy of Higher Education (India) – secured World No. 1 rank for SDG 5 (Gender Equality)
- LPU topped world in SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy)
- Harbin Institute of Technology (China) – ranked No. 1 globally for SDG 9 (Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure)

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News - 347

- "Sustainable Development Report 2026" – released by UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)
- Top country – Finland (for 2nd consecutive year) | Followed by – Sweden & Denmark
- Bottom countries – Chad, Central African Republic & South Sudan
- India – 94th, with an overall SDG score of 68.3 out of 100 (from 99th in 2025)
- India faces significant challenges on 13 of 17 SDGs | Most pressing concern for India – Zero Hunger (SDG 2)
  - Only 33.3% of India's SDG targets are on track to be achieved by 2030
- India is deteriorating on Responsible Consumption & Production (SDG 12) and Climate Action (SDG 13)
  - India's per capita CO_2 emissions – 2.21 tonnes
  - Press Freedom Index score under Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions (SDG 16) – fell to 31.96 in 2026
- India's progress was recorded in expanding electricity access (SDG 7) & mobile broadband and internet use (SDG 9)
- NITI Aayog – nodal agency, in India, for tracking domestic progress through its separate SDG India Index

Join us

News - 348

- "Strategic Roadmap for Making Ayurveda Global" – released by NITI Aayog on Jul 2, 2026
  - Prepared by – NITI Aayog's Health Division in collaboration with PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC)
  - Launched by – Dr Ashok Kumar Lahiri (Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog)
  - It is built around a 3-pillar framework: Availability; Acceptability; & Propagation
- Ayurveda currently enjoys formal recognition in nearly 30 countries
- India has 3,55,000+ trained Ayurveda practitioners of whom about 95% practise only within country
  - Ayurvedic products – exported to nearly 150 countries
  - Ayurvedic exports – rose to $2.16 billion in 2023 (from $1.09 billion in 2014)
- Implementation is proposed to be overseen by a Mission Steering Group chaired by the Union Minister of AYUSH

News - 349

- 5th Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026 – released by Global Citizen Solutions (GCS)
- Top country – Sweden (with highest overall score of 96.05 out of 100) | Followed by – Switzerland & Finland
- India – ranked 125th (from 124th in 2025), with a score of 45.1
- Indian passport holders currently enjoy visa-free or visa-on-arrival access to 26 countries
- Within sub-indices, India's Quality of Living ranking improved by 11 places to 118th in 2026 (from 129th in 2025)
  - India's Investment ranking – climbed 3 places to 94th
- China – 104th | Namibia – 124th | Azerbaijan – 126th | Nepal – 164th | Bangladesh – 166th | Pakistan – 188th
- 5 lowest-ranked passports – Syria, Yemen, South Sudan, Somalia & Afghanistan

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News - 350

- "Report on the Performance Grading Index 2.0 for States/UTs (PGI-S)" & "Performance Grading Index for Districts (PGI-D) for 2025-26" – released by Ministry of Education
- PGI-S was developed by – Department of School Education & Literacy
- Chandigarh – topped for 5th consecutive year | It became only UT or state placed in 'Uttam-3' category
  - No state or UT reached 'Utkarsh', 'Uttam-1' or 'Uttam-2' bands
- 2nd – Punjab, Kerala, Delhi & Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu
- Meghalaya – recorded sharpest improvement nationally, climbing to 'Akanshi-1'
- Gap between best & worst performers – narrowed to 240.3 points in 2025-26 (from 291 points in 2024-25)
- At district level, 19 districts, led by 7 from Punjab, reached 'Uttam-2' grade in 2025-26
  - Number of districts in 'Uttam-3' grade rose to 97 nationally

Join us

News - 351

- Ministry of Education – released Report on Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) 2025-26 on school education in India
- Number of teachers – rose to 1,02,73,020 in 2025-26 (from 94,83,294 in 2022-23)
- Pupil-Teacher Ratio became: 10 at foundational level, 12 at preparatory level, 17 at middle level & 21 at secondary level
  - National Education Policy's recommended ratio – 30:1
- Dropout rates declined to: 1.8% – at preparatory level (from 2.3%) | 7% – at secondary level (from 8.2%)
- Retention rates – improved to 83.7% at middle level & 51.9% at secondary level
- Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) at secondary level – rose to 71.7% (from 68.5%)
- Transition rates reached: 99.2% – from foundational to preparatory level
  - 93.8% – from preparatory to middle level | 88.3% – from middle to secondary level
- Number of single-teacher schools – declined to 1,00,843
- Zero-enrolment schools – fell by around 29% to 5,663
- Computer access in schools – rose to 69.9% (from 64.7%)
- Internet connectivity – rose to 67.4% (from 63.5%)
- Women accounted for 54.9% of teaching workforce (from 54.2% a year earlier)
- Girls' enrolment – rose to 48.4%

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News - 352

- "World Investment Report 2026" – released by United Nations Conference on Trade and Development in July 2026
- India – became world's 11th-largest recipient of FDI in 2025, with inflows surging nearly 44% to $38.89 billion
  - Previous rank of India – 13th in 2024, with inflows of $27.09 billion
- India's outward FDI – increased 47% to $35.66 billion in 2025 (from $24.26 billion in 2024)
- Value of overseas greenfield projects announced by Indian companies – rose 41% to $25.29 billion
- Rana Group's $10 billion investment announcement for an automotive manufacturing facility in UAE – featured among world's 5 largest greenfield project announcements of 2025
- Value of announced greenfield investments into India – fell to $74.12 billion in 2025 (from $111.14 billion in 2024)
- India attracted world's largest single announced greenfield investment project of 2025
  - A $14.5 billion data centre investment by Alphabet Inc. (US)
- Largest FDI recipient globally – US ($277 billion) | China – retained 4th position ($104.66 billion)
- Based on RBI's methodology, India's net FDI – $3.34 billion in 2025 (from $2.83 billion in 2024)

Join us

News - 353

- Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI) rankings for May 2026 – released by DARPG
- In Group A category: Insurance Division (DFS) – secured 2nd position | Banking Division (DFS) – secured 6th position
- DFS – receives more than 2.5 lakh grievances annually
  - It has consistently featured among top 10 Ministries & Departments in GRAI rankings since Nov 2025
- DFS also conducted workshops on an 'Effective Grievance Redressal Framework'
  - With RBI, IRDAI, PFRDA & PSBs

News - 354

- "Global Liveability Index 2026" – released by Economist Intelligence Unit
  - It evaluated cities across 5 categories: stability, healthcare, culture & environment, education & infrastructure
- Copenhagen (Denmark) – topped for 2nd consecutive year, with an overall score of 98 out of 100
  - 2nd – Vienna (Austria) | 3rd – Melbourne (Australia) | 4th – Sydney (Australia) | 5th – Zurich (Switzerland)
  - 6th – Geneva (Switzerland) | 7th – Osaka (Japan) | 8th – Adelaide (Australia)
  - 9th – Vancouver (Canada) | 10th – Tokyo (Japan)
- Among Indian cities: New Delhi – 120th | Mumbai – 121st | Chennai – 123rd
- Last ranked cities: 173rd – Damascus (Syria) | 172nd – Tripoli (Libya) | 171st – Dhaka (Bangladesh)

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News - 355

- World Intangible Investment Report 2026 – jointly published by WIPO & Luiss Business School
- India – recorded highest growth in intangible investment among world's 15 largest economies (7.9% y-o-y in 2023)
- India's intangible investment – reached $78.2 billion in 2023
- Share of various factors in India's total intangible investment in 2023: Software & databases – 45%
  - Organisational capital – 21.8% | Research & development – 12.7% | Brands – 9.3% | Design – 11%
- India's intangible investment – 10% of formal-sector GDP in 2023 (from 9.7% in 2011)
- Globally, total intangible investment – exceeded $10 trillion for first time in 2025
  - US – accounts for nearly half of total
- World's most intangible-intensive economy – Sweden | Followed by – US & France
- Fastest-growing category of intangible assets globally between 2013 & 2023 – software & databases (7.3% annually)

News - 356

- "2026 Global Air Power Rankings" – released by World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA)
- India – ranked as world's 3rd most powerful military aviation nation | 1st – US | 2nd – Russia
- In terms of individual service branches: IAF – ranked 6th, with a TruVal Rating (TVR) of 69.4
  - Top 5 – US Air Force, US Navy, Russian Air Force, US Army, US Marine Corps

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- IAF's fleet (1,716 aircraft) includes – 542 fighters, 498 helicopters, 282 transport aircraft, 374 trainer aircraft & 20 special mission platforms

News - 357

- 2nd "Digital Threat Report 2025-26" – released by MeitY + CERT-In + CSIRT-Fin + SISA
  - For India's Banking, Financial Services & Insurance (BFSI) and payments ecosystem

News - 358

- As per data released by Ministry of Commerce & Industry:
- India's Wholesale Price Index (WPI) inflation – rose to 9.87% in Jun 2026 under new WPI series (from 9.68% in May)
  - New series was launched on Jun 15, 2026, with a revised base year of 2022-23 (from 2011-12)
- All-India WPI for all commodities – rose to 110.2 in Jun (from 109.9 in May)
- Inflation in June (compared to May): Primary Articles – 7% (from 4.99%) | Fuel & Power – 27.41% (from 30.33%)
  - Manufactured Products – 7.48%
- WPI Food Index – recorded inflation of 6.14% in Jun (from 4.49% in May)

News - 359

- As per "2026 Brand Finance India 100" report:
- Collective brand value of India's top 100 brands – reached $252.8 billion in 2026 (7% increase over 2025)
- India's most valuable brand – Tata Group for 18th consecutive year (with brand value of $33.6 billion)
  - Followed by – Infosys ($16.4 bn), LIC Group ($15.3 bn), HDFC Group ($13.9 bn) & Reliance Group ($10.8 bn)
- LIC Group ($15.3 billion) – only brand to feature in top five for both brand value & brand strength
- Adani Group – became India's 3rd most valuable conglomerate
- Adani Power ($1.8 billion) – India's most valuable energy brand

News - 360

- Jaipur (Rajasthan) – ranked 6th in Time Out's "2026 Survey of the World's Happiest Cities"
  - It became only Indian city to feature in this list
- English city of Bath – topped rankings | Followed by – Panama City & Guadalajara (Mexico)

News - 361

- MoSPI released India's 1st trial Index of Services Production (ISP) for 19 sub-sectors, with 2024-25 as its base year
  - It provides a monthly measure of short-term activity in country's formal services sector
- Of 19 sub-sectors covered: 14 – recorded double-digit y-o-y growth in Apr 2026 (from Apr 2025)
  - Led by – Accommodation & Food Services (37.2%), Retail Trade (30.8%), Administrative & Support Services (28.7%) & Real Estate Activities (27.7%)

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- Only sub-sectors to contract – Air Transport (-13.9%) & Railway Transport (-0.4%)

- Conceptual & methodological framework for ISP was guided by – a Technical Advisory Committee constituted in May'25
  - Under chairpersonship of – Debjani Ghosh (Fellow, NITI Aayog)
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 362

- UN Independent International Scientific Panel on AI – released its 1st Preliminary Report
  - 1st UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance – held in Geneva from Jul 6 to 7, 2026
- Panel is co-chaired by – Yoshua Bengio (Canada) & Maria Ressa (Philippines)
- US – controls around 75% of computing power behind world's leading AI systems | China – holds roughly 15%
- Panel noted that more than 40 AI governance frameworks & ethical guidelines already exist worldwide

News - 363

- Brand Finance's "India 100 - 2026" report – released in July 2026
- India's most valuable & strongest tyre brand – MRF Tyres, with its brand value rising 24% y-o-y to $863 million
  - MRF – climbed to 48th position among India's most valuable brands across all sectors (from 51st in 2025)
- MRF – ranked world's 3rd strongest tyre brand (with a BSI score of 87.7 out of 100)
- Michelin – world's most valuable tyre brand for 9th consecutive year, with its brand value rising 17% to $10.3 billion
  - Followed by – Bridgestone ($8.8 billion) & Continental ($3.9 billion)

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News - 364

- NITI Aayog – released its 1st-ever "Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) 2026"
- Among Large States, India's most investment-friendly state – Gujarat (scoring 56.6 out of 100)
  - Followed by – Maharashtra (53.7) & Tamil Nadu (53.3)
- Among other categories: Uttarakhand – topped Hilly & North-Eastern States group | Followed by – Assam & HP
  - Goa – topped UTs & City States category | Followed by – Delhi & Chandigarh
- Overall, top Performers – Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Goa & Odisha
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 365

- MoSPI released its latest quarterly update of PAIMANA Performance Monitoring Dashboard
  - MoSPI expands it to 165 indicators with addition of 44 new indicators since Apr 2026
  - PAIMANA – Project Assessment, Infrastructure Monitoring & Analytics for Nation-building
- It replaced Online Computerised Monitoring System (OCMS-2006)
- Civil aviation sector in FY27 – passenger traffic reached 7.1 crore & cargo handled rising 10.6% to 7.3 lakh tonnes
- India's energy storage requirement – rose to 888 GWh by FY36 (from 87 GWh in FY28)

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- Telecom sector: Mobile towers – rose 3.7% y-o-y to 8.55 lakh
- Base Transceiver Stations – rose 7.4% to 32.25 lakh
- National teledensity – improved to 93.26% in FY26

- FASTag electronic toll collection transactions – rose 39.7% y-o-y to 88 crore in FY27
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 366

- NITI Aayog – released "Roadmap for Building India as a Leading BioEconomy Powerhouse by 2035" outlining 10-year strategy to expand India's bioeconomy
- Bioeconomy target – projected to grow from $195.3 billion in 2025 to $691 billion by 2035 & $2.6 trillion by 2047
- India's bioeconomy – expanded ~16x from $10 billion in 2014 to $195.3 billion in 2025
  - contributing ~4.8% to GDP | Projected $392 billion by 2030
- Roadmap vision: create 30+ million high-value jobs & position India among world's top 3 biotechnology powers
- 6 National BioMissions – GeneIndia, AgriBio 2.0, BioX Foundry, One Health Grid, Marine Biotechnology & BioPharmaNext
- BioEconomy Growth Fund – recommended ₹50,000 Cr fund for 2026-2035 to support transition from laboratory research to commercial-scale manufacturing
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

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News - 367

- WTO prepared a report as part of 8th review of India's trade policies & practices, conducted in Geneva
  - India was represented by – Rajesh Agarwal (Commerce Secretary)
- India aims to increase its share of global merchandise exports to ~10% by 2047 (from ~1.8% in 2024)
- Share of India's services sector in global commercial services exports – 4.3% in 2024 (from 2% in 2005)
- HQs of WTO – Geneva, Switzerland | 7th DG – Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala (Nigeria) | Members – 166 | Founded – 1995

News - 368

- GoI released a factsheet titled "White Gold: India's Cotton Story - From Seed to Shirt"
- India – 1st globally in cotton cultivation area, with 114.84 lakh hectares (38% of world's total cotton acreage)
- India – 2nd globally in both cotton production & consumption
- India – only country in world cultivating all 4 recognisedcotton species
- India's cotton production – projected at 290.91 lakh bales for 2025-26 on a provisional basis
  - India contributes approximately 19% of global fibre production
- Domestic cotton consumption in India – 328 lakh bales for 2025-26
- Largest destination for India's cotton fabric & made-up exports – US (26.35%)
  - Followed by – Bangladesh (19.81%), Sri Lanka (5.11%), UK (2.38%) & UAE (2.32%)
- MSP for cotton: For 2025-26 – ₹7,710 per quintal for medium-staple cotton & ₹8,110 per quintal for long-staple cotton

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- For 2026-27 – ₹8,267 per quintal for medium-staple cotton & ₹8,667 per quintal for long-staple cotton

- During 2025-26 cotton season, CCI procured 105.09 lakh bales of cotton, valued at ₹41,530 Cr
- A 5-year 'Mission for Cotton Productivity' – launched in 2025-26 | Outlay – ₹5,659.22 Cr

News - 369

- "The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2026 (SOFI 2026)" report – released in Rome by 5 UN agencies
  - FAO, International Fund for Agricultural Development, UNICEF, WFP & WHO
- 7.8% of global population faced hunger in 2025 (from 8.1% in 2024 & 8.6% in 2022)
- World's largest hunger hotspot – Africa with 56.6% of its population facing moderate or severe food insecurity in 2025
  - Asia – 20.3% | Latin America & Caribbean – 22.9% | Northern America & Europe – 8.7%
- Average global cost – rose to 4.28 purchasing power parity dollars per person per day in 2025
  - Nearly 2.7 billion people – still unable to afford a healthy diet

News - 370

- Office of Economic Adviser (DPIIT) released revised series of Index of Core Industries (ICI), with base year 2022-23
- ICI was released for Jun 2026 as Provisional Estimates, along with back series from Apr 2023 to May 2026
  - It is compiled on a monthly basis & serving as a lead indicator for Index of Industrial Production (IIP)
- Now, total number of core industries – increased to 9 (from 8)
  - Coal, Crude Oil, Natural Gas, Refinery Products, Fertilisers, Steel, Cement, Electricity & Iron Ore
- Combined weight of these 9 core industries within IIP – 32.88% (from 40.27% under previous 2011-12 series)
- Provisional ICI for Jun 2026 – recorded growth of 5% (driven by inclusion of Iron Ore as 9th core industry)
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

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News - 371

- 20th edition of the "Henley Passport Index" – released by Henley & Partners in July 2026
- India's passport – ranked 81st globally (from 75th in Feb 2026 edition)
  - India shared its rank with – Mauritania & Algeria
  - Indian passport holders currently have access to – 55 destinations (either visa-free or visa-on-arrival)
- World's most powerful passport – Singapore (192 destinations) | 2nd – Japan, South Korea & UAE (188 destinations)
  - 3rd – Sweden (187 destinations)
- Bottom countries: 104th – Afghanistan (22 destinations) | 103rd – Syria (25 destinations)
  - 102nd – Iraq (28 destinations) | 101st – Pakistan (29 destinations) | 100th – Yemen (30 destinations)
- Over past two decades, average passport's visa-free access – rose to 108 destinations (from 58 destinations in 2006)
- Henley Passport Index – launched in 2006, when India ranked 71st

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Amount & Agreements

News - 372

- ADB approved a $42.2 million Small Expenditure Financing Facility (SEFF) to support development of bamboo industry across India's northeastern region
  - Title – "Inclusive and Sustainable Bamboo Value Chain Development in Northeast India Project"
- Aim: To boost agricultural productivity, strengthen rural livelihoods & reduce dependence on bamboo imports
- It will support community-based projects across 6 northeastern states: Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland & Tripura
- Northeast accounts for 35.8% of India's total bamboo resources
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

News - 373

- Cabinet approved an additional GoI investment commitment of ₹30,000 Cr to National Investment & Infrastructure Fund
  - It will double total Government of India commitment to NIIF to ₹60,000 Cr (from ₹30,000 Cr)
- National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) – India's sovereign-anchored investment platform
  - Established in – 2015 | Managed by – National Investment & Infrastructure Fund Limited (NIIFL)
  - GoI holds a 49% equity stake
- It currently manages capital commitments of ~₹40,000 Cr across its fund strategies
- NIIF's 1st flagship Infrastructure Fund (₹16,000 Cr) – India's largest domestic infrastructure fund

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News - 374

- ADB approved a $182.89 million loan to help India strengthen public school system in Karnataka
  - Including female & disadvantaged learners
- It will support "Strengthening Karnataka Public Schools Program"
- Loan will be complemented by a $10 million grant & a $25 million guarantee from International Finance Facility for Education (IFFEd)
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

News - 375

- ADB – approved a $230 million loan to modernise & expand water supply & sanitation infrastructure in Chennai
  - Under "Chennai Climate Resilient Water Security and Sewerage Project (CCRWSSP)"
- It will construct over 170 kms of water supply & sewer pipelines & will upgrade 7 water pumping stations & 38 sewer pumping stations
- It will make Chennai 1st Indian city to adopt closed-loop approach, maintaining balanced water pressure
- Tamil Nadu Urban Infrastructure Financial Services Ltd (TNUIFSL) – to serve as executing agency

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- Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board (CMWSSB) – to serve as implementing agency
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 376

- POWERGRID – secured a green loan of JPY 80 billion from Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)
  - To finance Khavda-Nagpur High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) transmission project
- Of total facility, JBIC is directly contributing JPY 48 billion
  - Remaining amount – co-financed by a syndicate of Japanese commercial banks
- Khavda Renewable Energy Park – in Gujarat
- HQs of POWERGRID – Gurgaon, Haryana | MD & Chairman – Burra Vamsi Rama Mohan

News - 377

- World Bank approved a financing package of $890 million to accelerate India's PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana rooftop solar programme
  - Aim: To expand clean energy access to millions of households & mobilising large-scale private investment
- It comprises: $820 million loan – from IBRD | $60 million concessional loan – from Clean Technology Fund
  - $10 million grant – from IBRD's Livable Planet Fund
  - $4.2 billion – to mobilise through private financing
- As of Mar 2026, India had installed 9.56 GW of rooftop solar capacity under this scheme
- India's commitments: To achieve net-zero emissions by 2070 & raise the share of non-fossil-fuel-based energy sources to 60% of its electricity mix by 2035
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

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Ordinance, Bills & Acts

News - 378

- MHFW amended 'Drugs Rules, 1945', to strengthen regulatory oversight of medicinal formulations containing high levels of ethyl alcohol
- Now, all formulations containing more than 12% v/v ethyl alcohol in quantities exceeding 30 mL will no longer be covered under Schedule K exemption
- Such products will now be required to obtain necessary licenses under Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940
- Amendment also moves these formulations to Schedule H1 of Drugs Rules, 1945
  - It mandates their sale only against prescription of a Registered Medical Practitioner
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

Join us

News - 379

- Chhattisgarh Legislative Assembly – passed "Chhattisgarh Ease of Doing Business Act, 2026"
  - It became 1st Indian state to introduce a comprehensive risk-based & trust-based business permission system
- In its 1st phase, legislation brings 43 services offered by 8 state government departments
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka

News - 380

- Goa – approved amendments to "Goa Public Gambling Act, 1976"
  - Fixing & clarifying minimum age for entry into casino gambling areas at 21 years
- Goa also approved 'Goa Public Gambling Rules' to regulate casino operations, which are yet to be notified
- Goa's licensed casino sector currently comprises several onshore venues & 6 offshore casino vessels
- Goa: Capital – Panaji | CM – Pramod Sawant | Governor – Pusapati Ashok Gajapathi Raju

News - 381

- MP Cabinet approved draft 'Madhya Pradesh Uniform Civil Code (UCC), 2026'
- MP – to become one of a small number of Indian states to adopt a common civil law framework
  – after Uttarakhand, Gujarat & Assam
- Draft was prepared by a high-level committee – headed by Ranjana Prakash Desai (a retired SC judge)
- It also sets legal marriageable age at 21 for men & 18 for women
- It will not apply to STs or to groups whose customary rights are protected under Part XXI of Constitution
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

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News - 382

- Cabinet approved a draft Bill to amend "Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024"
- Individuals involved in paper leaks will face a minimum punishment of 5 years' imprisonment, along with a fine
  - It proposes a jail term of up to 10 years & a maximum fine of ₹10 Cr
- The existing law currently provides for 3 to 5 years' imprisonment & 5 to 10 years' imprisonment with a minimum fine of ₹1 Cr for organised paper leaks

News - 383

- Govt continues to strengthen implementation of "SC & ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989"
- As per NCRB: 57,569 cases – registered under Act for crimes against SCs | 10,064 cases – for crimes against STs in 2022
  - Followed by – 57,766 SC cases & 12,959 ST cases (2023); and 55,685 SC cases & 9,961 ST cases (2024)
- As of 2024, 17,123 SC-related & 7,219 ST-related cases – remained pending investigation
- All India conviction rate: In 2022 – 34.1% for SC cases & 28.1% for ST cases
  - In 2023 – 32.4% for SC cases & 24.6% for ST cases | In 2024 – 33.9% for SC cases & 33.2% for ST cases

Join us

- ‘Police’ & ‘Public Order’ – State subjects under 7th Schedule of Constitution
- Central Assistance released during: 2022-23 – ₹392.71 Cr | 2023-24 – ₹535.30 Cr | 2024-25 – ₹495.29 Cr

MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships

News - 384

- IIT Bombay + SUNY (US) = signed a Letter of Intent (LoI) to jointly develop new educational & research opportunities at SUNY Old Westbury’s campus on Long Island, New York
- It marks IIT Bombay’s 1st overseas academic presence in United States
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare

News - 385

- Haryana + Rajasthan = signed an MoA for construction & implementation of ‘Yamuna Water Project’ in New Delhi
  - Project cost – ₹34,102 Cr
- It will convey ~580 MCM of water from Western Yamuna Canal to Rajasthan through 3 underground pipelines
- ‘Rajasthan-Haryana Yamuna Water SPV (RHYW-SPV)’ – to be constituted for implementation, construction, operation & maintenance of project
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde

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News - 386

- India + Saudi Arabia = an MoU on Cooperation in Water Resources
  - At 1st “Saudi Water Week” (Saudi Arabia’s first national water conference) – hosted in Jeddah
- India’s bilateral trade with Saudi Arabia – ~$43 billion in FY25
- Saudi Arabia – provides ~16% of crude oil imports to India
- Saudi Arabia – Riyadh – Saudi Riyal | PM – Mohammed bin Salman Al Saud | King – Salman bin Abdulaziz

News - 387

- Ministry of Tourism + Google India = an MoU to strengthen digital promotion of India’s tourism destinations
- It is structured around 3 principal areas of collaboration:
  (1) ‘Travel Trend Insights’ | (2) ‘Digital Discovery’ | (3) ‘Capacity Building’
- Minister of Tourism: Gajendra Singh Shekhawat | Constituency – Jodhpur, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Tourism: Suresh Gopi

Join us

News - 388

- Air India + SIAEC (Singapore) = an MoU to explore collaboration in Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) sector
  - Aim: To support development of India as a global aviation MRO hub
- It could also include formation of an MRO JV in India to serve growing requirements of Indian & regional aviation markets
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Campbell Wilson (subsidiary of Tata Group)

News - 389

- Agnikul Cosmos + ICEYE (Finland) = an MoU to explore building, launching & operating Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) Earth observation satellite systems from India
- Under this partnership, satellites will be manufactured in India using ICEYE's SAR technology & launched using Agnikul's responsive launch vehicles
- BharatInnovates conference – held in Nice, France
- ICEYE operates world's largest SAR satellite constellation, with over 70 satellites launched
- HQs of Agnikul Cosmos – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Co-Founder & CEO – Srinath Ravichandran

News - 390

- Adani Enterprises + IRH (Abu Dhabi) + Odisha = an MoU to develop a $11.5 billion integrated greenfield aluminium project in Odisha
- AEL & IRH – to form a 50:50 JV for this project
- It will comprise: 4 MMTPA alumina refinery – in Rayagada | 2 MMTPA aluminium smelter – in Sundargarh
  - 4,000-megawatt captive power plant including 400 megawatts of renewable energy
  - 1 MMTPA downstream manufacturing park
- It will be developed in two phases, with investments of ₹66,000 Cr & ₹44,000 Cr
- Odisha – holds nearly half of India's bauxite reserves & accounts for about 54% of country's aluminium output
- HQs of Adani Enterprises – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Gautam Adani | MD – Rajesh Adani
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

News - 391

- Bilateral Investment Agreement between India & Israel – came into force on Jul 4, 2026 (signed on Sep 8, 2025)
- India reduced local remedies exhaustion period for Israeli investors to 3 years
- Israel – 1st OECD member country with which India has signed such an agreement
- Between Apr 2000 & Mar 2026, India received $371.35 million in foreign direct investment (FDI) from Israel
- Israel – Jerusalem – Israeli Shekel | President – Isaac Herzog | PM – Benjamin Netanyahu

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News - 392

- Sharnbasva University (Karnataka) + Industrial University (Vietnam) = a 5-year MoU to strengthen academic ties
- Sharnbasva University – established in 2017 under Sharnbasveshwar Vidyavardhak Sangha
- IUH – a public technical university under Vietnam's Ministry of Industry & Trade
- Vietnam – Hanoi – Vietnamese dong | PM – Le Minh Hung | President – To Lam

News – 393

- Tamil Nadu + Hitachi Energy = an MoU to generate high-quality technology employment for around 1,000 people
  - Outlay – ₹1,000 Cr | To be implemented over next 3-5 years & expected
- Investment will be channeled into 2 projects:
  - Technology expansion of Hitachi Group's Global Technology & Innovation Centre (GTIC) in Porur, Chennai
  - Expansion of Hitachi Energy India's existing manufacturing facility in Chengalpattu
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar
- HQs of Hitachi Energy – Zurich, Switzerland | Chair – Alistair Dormer | President & CEO – Andreas Schierenbeck

News - 394

- Bisleri International Pvt Ltd + ICG (Kerala & Mahe) = signed a Letter of Association (LoA) in Kochi
  - To advance plastic waste management & promote environmental sustainability across coastal regions
- Aim: To strengthen waste management practices & support preservation of coastal & marine ecosystems
- Bisleri Int. – one of India's largest premium beverage businesses & India's largest seller of packaged drinking water
- HQs of Bisleri – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Angelo George | Chairman – Ramesh J Chauhan
- HQs of ICG – New Delhi | DG – S Paramesh | Founded in – 1977

News - 395

- Telecommunication Engineering Centre + BECIL = an MoU to collaborate on joint studies, technical contributions & standardisation activities in areas of convergence & broadcasting technologies
- Aim: To strengthen India's capabilities in standardisation & innovation in converged & broadcasting technologies
- HQs of BECIL – New Delhi | CMD – Cmde D.K. Murali, IN (Retd.) | Established in – 1995

News - 396

- India + Australia = signed a Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) Access Agreement to strengthen patent examination & protect traditional knowledge from misappropriation
- India-Australia summit – held in Melbourne
- IP Australia will gain access to India's Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (CSIR-TKDL)
- CSIR-TKDL – established in 2001 by GoI through a collaborative initiative of CSIR & Ministry of AYUSH
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

Join us

News - 397

- QCI + NSIC = a 5-year MoU to establish a collaborative ecosystem
  - To strengthen quality, competitiveness & market access for MSMEs across India
- ZED-certified MSMEs will receive enhanced digital commerce opportunities through MSME Global Mart
- They will constitute a Joint Coordination Committee (JCC) to identify new areas of collaboration & monitor progress
- India's nearly 6.5 Cr MSMEs employ about 28 Cr people & account for around 30% of the country's GDP
- HQs of QCI – New Delhi | Chairman – Jaxay Shah | Secretary General – Chakravarthy T Kannan | Established – 1997
- HQs of NSIC – New Delhi | CMD – Dr. Subhransu Sekhar Acharya

News - 398

- DoP + TRAI = an MoU to conduct India's largest village-level telecom network performance survey
- Aim: To strengthen rural telecom services & advance vision of Digital India
- HQs of TRAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Anil Kumar Lahoti | Established in – 1997

News - 399

- Digital Bharat Nidhi + Gujarat + GFGNL + BSNL = signed an addendum to existing agreement for implementation of Amended BharatNet Programme (ABP) in Gujarat under State-led model
- GoI approved financial support of ₹5,629 Cr for implementation of programme in Gujarat
  - It will be implemented through – GFGNL
- Cabinet approved Amended BharatNet Programme on Aug 4, 2023
- BharatNet – originally launched as National Optical Fibre Network in 2011 & renamed in 2015
- HQs of Digital Bharat Nidhi – New Delhi | Administrator – Shyamal Misra | Established in – 2024
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

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News - 400

- TCS + ABB (Switzerland) = collaboration to transform ABB's global network operations using AI
- TCS – reported consolidated revenues exceeding $30 billion for FY26
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968

News - 401

- DoT + TSDSI = an MoU to strengthen India's participation in global Standards Development Organisations (SDOs)
  - During 9th "TSDSI Technical Deep Dive (TTDD) 2026"
- TDIP Scheme – launched by DoT in 2026 | Outlay – ₹203 Cr for 2026-2031 period
  - It will provide financial support for participation in Global Standards Development Organisations
- Financial support provided to eligible DPIIT-recognised startups & MSMEs:
  - Up to 98% – with annual turnover up to ₹10 Cr | Up to 80% – with turnover between ₹10 Cr & ₹500 Cr
  - Travel assistance – up to 80% of eligible expenditure (capped at ₹5 lakh per person per international meeting)

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News - 402

- DPIIT approved a JV between Dixon Technologies (India) Ltd & Vivo Mobile India (VMI) Pvt Ltd with share of 51:49
  - To establish a domestic smartphone manufacturing company in India
- It will initially be incorporated with a paid-up share capital of ₹5 Cr
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

News - 403

- Google India + Dept of IT (Tripura) = an MoU to build an AI ecosystem in state
  - On 2nd day of Destination Tripura Business Conclave 2026 in Agartala
- This agreement was among 43 IT sector MoUs signed at conclave | Collectively worth – ₹10,000 Cr
- Conclave secured overall investment commitments worth ₹1,21,303 Cr through 342 MoUs
- Tripura: Capital – Agartala | CM – Manik Saha | Governor – Indra Sena Reddy Nallu
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998

News - 404

- NMPB + Bhaskaracharya College of Applied Sciences (University of Delhi) = an MoU to strengthen research, innovation & sustainable utilisation of medicinal plants

News - 405

- NCVET + ASQA (Australia) = signed a Letter of Intent (LoI) to strengthen bilateral cooperation in regulation & quality assurance of Technical & Vocational Education & Training (TVET)
- NCVET (established in 2018) – India's national regulator for vocational education & training
- ASQA – serves as Australia's national regulator for vocational education & training
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

News - 406

- MCD + NDDB = an MoU to establish Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) plants in Delhi for scientific utilisation of cow dung
  - To prevent dairy & cattle waste from flowing into Yamuna river & instead convert it into biogas & organic manure
- Cow dung from dairies & gaushalas – to be transported directly to gas & manure plants
  - To be established at – Nangli, Ghoga-Goyla & Ghazipur waste management facilities
- HQs of NDDB – Anand, Gujarat | Chairman – Meenesh Shah | Established in – 1965

News - 407

- pi-labs + Google Cloud = collaborated to accelerate delivery of secure, scalable & mission-ready AI solutions for India
- HQs of pi-labs – Pune, Maharashtra | Founder & CEO – Ankush Tiwari | Established in – 2023
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998

  CEO of Google Cloud – Thomas Kurian | MD at Google Cloud India – Sashikumar Sreedharan

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News - 408

- Arunachal Pradesh + Tidal Sail AS (Norway) = an MoU for 500 kW River Kinetic Energy Demonstration Project to establish India's 1st river kinetic energy demonstration plant
- The Project will demonstrate electricity generation from river currents without large dams or major civil infrastructure, offering sustainable & cost-effective renewable energy solution
- Arunachal Pradesh: Capital – Itanagar | CM – Pema Khandu | Governor – Lt. Gen. Kaiwalya Trivikram Parnaik

News - 409

- Akasa Air + BPCL = an MoU to develop & adopt Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) in India, supporting SAF ecosystem & aviation decarbonisation goals
- BPCL – investing in 61 KTPA Sustainable Aviation Fuel production facility at Mumbai Refinery
- HQs of Akasa Air – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder & CEO – Vinay Dube
- HQs of BPCL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Sanjay Khanna | Founded in – 1952

News - 410

- Office of CGPDTM (DPIIT) + CSIR-NIScPR = an MoU to bring CGPDTM into National Knowledge Resource Consortium
- NKRC – established in 2009 & is a network of libraries & information centres (currently serving 82 member institutions)
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)
- Location of CSIR-NIScPR – New Delhi | Director – Dr Geetha Vani Rayasam

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News - 411

- India + Sri Lanka = amended DTAA by incorporating Principal Purpose Test (PPT), an OECD BEPS framework anti-abuse provision
- PPT – enables tax authorities to deny treaty benefits where principal purpose of investment/transaction is obtaining tax advantage instead of genuine commercial activity
- Objective: eliminate double taxation while preventing non-taxation/reduced taxation through treaty-shopping arrangements
- India-Sri Lanka DTAA – originally signed January 22, 2013
- India – introduced similar PPT provisions earlier in Mauritius tax treaty through protocol signed in March 2024
- Sri Lanka – Colombo/Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte – Sri Lankan Rupee
  PM – Harini Amarasuriya | President – Anura Kumar Dissanayake

News - 412

- VSSC (ISRO) + CSIR-IICT (Hyderabad) = an MoU to develop indigenous, next-generation, environmentally sustainable technology for blowing agents used to create lightweight polymer foams for advanced strategic & space applications
- HQs of VSSC – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala | Director – Dr U P Rajeev

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News - 413

- ISSDA + GSSE = partnered to position stainless steel as a critical enabler of India's clean energy transition
  - At an event organised by Virgo Communications & Exhibitions in Mumbai
- India's stainless steel market – to reach ~$15.8 billion by 2030, growing at a CAGR of 9.1%
- India – world's 2nd-largest consumer of stainless steel
- HQs of ISSDA – Gurgaon, Haryana | President – Rajamani Krishnamurti | Established in – 1989

News - 414

- AP EDB + UAE Food Cluster = an MoU to boost investment, food processing, exports & international trade in Andhra's horticulture sector
  - To establish a UAE-backed Food Cluster in Andhra to facilitate investments in food processing, value addition & exports of horticultural produce
- Flour Masters International (Dubai) – ₹100 Cr investment to set up a food processing unit at Gangadhara Nellore in Chittoor district
- AP govt is transforming Rayalaseema into a major horticulture hub through public & pvt investments worth ₹1 lakh Cr
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- UAE – Abu Dhabi – Dirham | President – Khalifa bin Zayed Al Nahyan

News - 415

- NABARD + MAHAPREIT = an MoU to finance & promote green, climate-resilient & sustainable infrastructure across rural India
- MAHAPREIT + NGEL = a JV agreement to develop 10 GW of renewable energy parks & projects in Maharashtra
- HQs of NABARD – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shaji K. V. | Founded in – 1982
- HQs of MAHAPREIT – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shri Sanjay Shirsat | Established in – 2021
- HQs of NGEL – New Delhi | CEO of NGEL – Sarit Maheshwari

News - 416

- Paras Semiconductors Pvt Ltd + MP = an MoU to explore setting up a greenfield advanced IC Packaging OSAT facility in Indore-Ujjain region (Investment – ₹6,200 Cr)
- HQs of Paras Defence & Space Technologies – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Sharad Virji Shah
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

News - 417

- NRDC + NCISM = an MoU to establish a strategic partnership for promoting innovation, IP management, technology transfer & commercialisation of research outcomes in Indian System of Medicine
- HQs of NRDC – New Delhi | CMD – Commodore Amit Rastogi (Retd) | Established in – 1953
- HQs of NCISM – New Delhi | Chairperson – Maneesha Upendra Kothekar | Established in – 2021

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News - 418

- NIELIT + SCL (Mohali) = collaborated to make India's indigenous 1.2 µm Process Design Kit (PDK) available through eChipHub platform
- Process Design Kit – a library of pre-designed building blocks, containing technical files, rules & models that chip designers use to create ICs for a specific manufacturing process
- SCL Mohali – India's only integrated device manufacturing facility | eChipHub – managed by NIELIT
- NIELIT – also granted status of a Deemed-to-be University by Ministry of Education
- HQs of NIELIT – New Delhi | DG – Dr Madan Mohan Tripathi | Chairperson – Union Minister of MeitY

News - 419

- Sona BLW Precision Forgings Ltd + DENSO Corporation (Japan) = definitive agreements to establish 2 JVs
  - For developing, designing, manufacturing & marketing advanced electric & hybrid powertrain systems for multiple vehicle segments
- 1st JV – to focus on high-voltage liquid-cooled traction inverters, traction motors & generators for electric & hybrid four-wheeler passenger vehicles, commercial vehicles & larger vehicle applications
  - Shareholding – DENSO (51%) : Sona Comstar (49%)
- 2nd JV – to focus on electric & hybrid powertrain systems for two-wheelers & three-wheelers
  - Shareholding – DENSO (49%) : Sona Comstar (51%)
- HQs of Sona BLW Precision Forgings Ltd (Sona Comstar) – Gurugram, Haryana | Chairperson – Jeffrey Mark Overly | CEO – Vivek Vikram Singh

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News - 420

- Visvesvaraya Technological University (Belagavi, Karnataka) + Google = 1st-ever academic agreement
  - To provide engineering students & faculty with training in AI, cloud computing, data science & cybersecurity
- Students will receive access to Google's educational content for ₹350 (discounted from around ₹20,000)
- VTU + Qualcomm = to offer long-term training in AI, product prototyping, embedded systems & IoT
  - A Center of Excellence to be developed in phases with an estimated investment of ₹20 Cr
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998

News - 421

- HCLTech + Sarvam AI + Odisha = an MoU to establish HCLTech's 1st AI-optimised data centre at upcoming Odisha Sovereign AI Park, in Bhubaneswar
  - Outlay – ₹14,257 Cr
- HCLTech + Odisha = an MoU to establish a Global Technology Center in Bhubaneswar
  - To innovate & deliver AI-led digital solutions to global enterprises
- HQs of HCLTech – Noida, UP | Chairperson – Roshni Nadar Malhotra | MD & CEO – C Vijayakumar
- HQs of Sarvam AI – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-Founders – Pratyush Kumar & Vivek Raghavan
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

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News - 422

- EIL + CSIR-IMMT (Bhubaneswar) = an MoU to strengthen India's capabilities in critical mineral processing, extractive metallurgy & indigenous technology development
- EIL & CSIR-IMMT will pool their expertise in 4 key areas:
  - Joint research & development initiatives | Technology scale-up
  - Pilot & field projects | Knowledge-sharing & training
- CSIR-IMMT – designated a Centre of Excellence for critical minerals under National Critical Mineral Mission (NCMM)
- HQs of EIL – Gurugram, Haryana | CMD – Atul Gupta

News - 423

- MoT + Air India = an MoU to establish a strategic framework to promote India as a preferred global tourism destination
- A Joint Working Group will oversee implementation of MoU & identify potential areas of collaboration
- It will remain valid for an initial period of 2 years from effective date, extendable by 1 additional year
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Campbell Wilson (subsidiary of Tata Group)
- Minister of Tourism: Gajendra Singh Shekhawat | Constituency – Jodhpur, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Tourism: Suresh Gopi

❖ Important Obituaries in July 2026:

- **Vijaya Mehta** ("Bai'') – Noted Marathi Theatre Legend & Filmmaker
  (Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award, Padma Shri (1987), Kalidas Samman, and the Maharashtra Government Lifetime Achievement Award)
- **Lt Gen MM Lakhera** – Former Governor of Mizoram & Lieutenant Governor of Puducherry
  (Awards: Param Vishisht Seva Medal, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal, and Vishisht Seva Medal)
- **Girish Bharadwaj** ("Bridge Man of India") – a Legendary Social Worker
  (Padma Shri in 2017)
  (He built around 140 to 150 low-cost, eco-friendly suspension hanging footbridges over a span of three decades to connect remote, isolated villages to essential facilities like schools, hospitals, and markets.)
- **K. Bhagyaraj** ("King of Screenplay") – Veteran Tamil Filmmaker, Actor, & Screenwriter
  (Filmfare Award for Best Actor for his blockbuster film "Mundhanai Mudichu" (1983) & SIIMA Lifetime Achievement Award in 2014)
- **Puviyarasu –** Eminent Tamil Poet & Writer
  (Sahitya Akademi Award twice in 2006-7 & 2009-10)
- **Dr. Teejan Bai** – a Legendary Pandavani Folk Singer
  (Awards: Padma Shri in 1988, Padma Bhushan in 2003, Padma Vibhushan in 2019, Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1995, Fukuoka Prize in 2018)

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- **Poomani** – Tamil Writer
  (Awards: Sahitya Akademi Award in 2014, 1st edition of Gitanjali Literary Prize)
- **H. Hanumanthappa** – Former Rajya Sabha Member (Party - INC)
  (He effectively served as the Chairperson of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs).)
- **Moozhikkal Pankajakshi** – a "Nokkuvidya" Puppetry Exponent
  (Padma Shri in 2020 | Nokkuvidya Pavakali - Kerala's rare puppetry art form)
- **Sir Garfield Sobers** – West Indies Cricket Legend
- **Kevin Keegan** – England football legend
  (He won a Bundesliga title and cemented his elite status by winning back-to-back Ballon d'Or trophies (1978 & 1979). He remains the only English player to win the award twice.)
  (Football Writers' Association Player of the Year in 1976, PFA Players' Player of the Year in 1982)
- **Dr. Gunther von Hagens** (Doctor Death) – a German Anatomist & Inventor of Plastination

❖ Important One-liner Meetings, Conferences & Summits in July 2026:

- 16th BRICS National Security Advisers' (NSA) Meeting – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "Non-Traditional Security Challenges Confronting the World Today")
- BRICS Heads of Space Agencies Meeting (by ISRO) – **Bengaluru, Karnataka**
- 11th BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting – **Gurugram, Haryana**
  (Theme - "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability")
- 1st BRICS Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) Forum and 3rd Small and Medium Enterprises (SME) Working Group Meeting – **Agra, Uttar Pradesh**
- Industry Association Conclave of MY Bharat – **New Delhi**
- BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies Meeting – **Guwahati, Assam**
- BRICS Women Working Group Meeting 2026 – **Kochi, Kerala**
- UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance – **Geneva, Switzerland**
  (Indian delegation led by - Kirti Vardhan Singh)
- 2nd Meeting of India-Rwanda Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) – **New Delhi**
- Valedictory Session of "Vidhayi Gaurav Yatra: Former and Sitting Members Conclave" – **Jaipur, Rajasthan**
- 12th BRICS Labour and Employment Ministers' Meeting – **Hyderabad, Telangana**
- BRICS Network University Conference on Traditional and Indigenous Knowledge Systems – **India (virtual)**
- BRICS Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026 – **IIT Hyderabad, Telangana**
- 16th BRICS Health Minister's Meeting – **Chandigarh**
- 10th edition of India Mobile Congress 2026 (in Oct'26) – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "Scale without Boundaries")

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(10th edition of IMC is anchored around 4 key pillars – Srishti (Building the Future), Suraksha (Strengthening Trust), Sashakt (Expanding Opportunities) and Samvardhan (Fueling Growth))

❖ Some Important Species found in July 2026:

- "Georissa meghalayaensis" & "Acmella bensoni", two new species of microscopic, vividly colored cave-dwelling snails – discovered in Meghalaya's Khasi Hills
- "Cyttopsis indica" (Indian dory), a new species of deep-sea fish – discovered in the Arabian Sea off the southern coast of Kerala
- "Elaphropoda triangulate" & "Habropoda adi", two new species of rare solitary bees – discovered in Siang Valley, Arunachal Pradesh
- "Lestes paloti", a new species of damselfly – discovered in Kerala's Western Ghats
- "Simonia lawbah" & "Hamataliwa papikonda", two new species of spiders – discovered in Meghalaya & Andhra Pradesh
- Dr. Gunther von Hagens (Doctor Death) – a German Anatomist & Inventor of Plastination – passed away

❖ Appointments of some Important Brand Ambassadors in July 2026:

- Amitabh Bachchan – Brand Ambassador of Policybazaar
  (For "Parivaar Sabse Pehle" (Family Comes First) insurance awareness campaign)

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❖ Grand Prix Winners in July 2026:

- Australian Grand Prix 2026 – George Russell (British - Mercedes)
- British Grand Prix 2026 – Charles Leclerc (Monégasque - Ferrari)

❖ Some Important Acquisitions & Mergers in July 2026:

- The Government of India has launched an Offer for Sale (OFS) to divest up to a 2% stake in Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC). The two-day transaction completed in late June 2026, aiming to raise over ₹2,300 crore while improving public float and complying with SEBI's minimum public shareholding requirements.

- Pune-based Persistent Systems has announced a voluntary public takeover offer to acquire German digital engineering firm Nagarro SE for €81 per share in an all-cash deal valued at approximately €1.4 billion ($1.3 billion).

- Kotak Mahindra Bank has officially signed a definitive agreement to acquire Deutsche Bank AG's retail banking, affluent private banking, and wealth management businesses in India for approximately ₹281.7 crore.

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- The Competition Commission of India (CCI) has officially cleared two major corporate corporate actions: German financial giant DWS Group's 40% equity acquisition in Nippon Life India AIF, alongside the massive ₹16,660 crore buyout of the Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB) IPL franchise by an Aditya Birla Group-led consortium.

- A consortium led by global private equity firm TPG, alongside co-investors GIC (Singapore's sovereign wealth fund) and ICICI Bank, signed definitive agreements to acquire a 100% stake in Aseem Infrastructure Finance from the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF). The market estimates peg the landmark transaction at approximately ₹5,000 crore (~$500 million).

- Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) has successfully acquired absolute 100% control of the Brazilian exploration and production company, IBV Brasil Petróleo Limitada (IBV), for a cash consideration of ₹2,312 crore. In another development, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) signed a definitive agreement to acquire a 40% equity stake in Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited (TTSIPL) for a cash consideration of ₹85 crore.

- The Competition Commission of India (CCI) cleared a landmark ₹16,660 crore ($1.78 billion) all-cash acquisition of Royal Challengers Sports Private Limited (RCSPL), the entity owning the Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) cricket franchise by a consortium of Aditya Birla Group.

- State Bank of India (SBI) has agreed to acquire a 10% equity stake in RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL) from the National Housing Bank (NHB). Following the regulatory clearance and final completion of this transaction, NHB's total shareholding in RDCL will decrease from 39% to 29%.

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- State Bank of India (SBI) has successfully finalized a pre-initial public offering (pre-IPO) deal, divesting a 1.42% stake in its asset management subsidiary, SBI Funds Management Ltd (SBIFM), for ₹1,655 crore.

- British insurer Aviva plc has officially agreed to acquire the remaining 26% stake in Aviva Life Insurance Company India from its long-term joint venture partner, Dabur Invest Corp. This transaction makes Aviva the first foreign life insurance company to secure 100% absolute ownership of its operations in India.

- Temasek-backed MacRitchie Investments has offloaded a 2.05% stake in Lenskart Solutions for approximately ₹1,940 crore ($204 million) through open market transactions.

- The Government of India and the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) are in the final stages of a strategic disinvestment to sell a combined 60.72% stake along with management control in IDBI Bank. Revised financial bids from Fairfax Financial Holdings (Canada) and Emirates NBD (Dubai) are currently under evaluation. The proposed

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acquisition is estimated to be valued at approximately $5.7 billion at current market prices, ranking it among the largest foreign investments in India's banking sector.

- "Allographa keralensis", "Allographa nayakae", "Allographa paraconsanguinea", "Allographa persistinspersa", & "Allographa semicarbonisata", five new species of lichen-forming fungi – discovered in the biodiversity-rich Western Ghats region of India.

- RBI officially approved Areion Group's ₹936 crore acquisition of the troubled mortgage lender, Aviom India Housing Finance Private Limited. The deal is set to deliver an estimated 65% recovery rate for Aviom's secured financial creditors.

- CCI approved the merger of Go Digit Infoworks Services Private Limited into Go Digit General Insurance Limited (GDGIL).

❖ Do not miss to study our "Smart Topic-wise PDF" that includes following topics:

- National Parks / Wildlife Sanctuaries / Tiger Reserves
- Miscellaneous News & Current Static GK
- Books & Authors
- Appointments in One-liner form
- Awards & Recognitions in One-liner form
- India's Ranks in various Reports/Indexes
- Venues & Themes of All Important Meetings/Summits/Conferences (It includes some extra events too.)
- MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships in One-liner form
- Important Days & Themes
- Latest GDP Predictions by various organisations

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Important Books & Authors	
"Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" (Released by - Vice President, C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Dr. Jayanta Kumar Roy & Sangita Roy
"Politics, Policy and Predictions"	Derek O'Brien
"The Second Orbit' memoir"	Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla
"Strategy for Life"	Surya RamKumar
"Made in Nepal: Lesson in buisness building from the Land of Everest"	Vinod Choudhary
"The Voice of Justice: Justice Gavai Speaks" (Released by – Vice-President Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Prof. (Dr.) S. Sivakumar
"RSS @100: A Century of Service, Unity & Sacrifice" (Released by – VP C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Shyam Jaju & Anupam Trivedi

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Important Days	
June 25-July 1	Deafblind Awareness Week (Theme - "Bridging the Gap: Empowering Independence through Innovative Technology.")
July 1	SBI Foundation Day (established in 1955) (Tagline - "The Banker to Every Indian")
	National Doctor's Day (To honor birth & death anniversary of legendary physician & former CM of West Bengal, Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy) (Theme - "Behind the Mask: Who Heals the Healers?")
	78th National Chartered Accountants Day (It was on this day in 1949 that the 'Chartered Accountants Act' came into force)
	9th Goods and Services Tax (GST) Day (Theme - "GST – Simplified Tax System: Empowered India")
July 2	World Sports Journalists Day (Theme - "Championing Fair Play: Reporting with Integrity and Impact")
July 3	International Plastic Bag Free Day
July 4	International Day of Cooperatives (Theme - "Cooperatives for a Peaceful World")
July 6	World Rural Development Day (Theme - "Financing the First Mile of Food Systems")
	World Zoonoses Day (Zoonoses - infectious diseases caused by pathogens that jump naturally from non-human vertebrate animals to humans)
July 7	World Kiswahili Language Day (Kiswahili or Swahili is one of the most widely spoken languages in Africa and the first African language officially recognized by the United Nations.)
	World Bioproduct Day
July 10	Global Energy Independence Day
	National Fish Farmer's Day
July 11	World Population Day (Theme - "Realizing the Hopes and Aspirations of Young People - Today and For the Future.")
	World Horse Day
July 12	International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms
	International Malala Day (The day honors the advocacy of Nobel laureate Malala Yousafzai and the global struggle for girls' education.)
	2nd UN International Day of Hope
July 15	World Youth Skills Day (Theme - "Skills for a Shared Future")
July 16	World Snake Day
	AI (Artificial Intelligence) Appreciation Day
July 17	World Day for International Justice
July 18	UN Nelson Mandela International Day (since 2010) (He was the first Black President of South Africa, and received Nobel Peace Prize in 1993)

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July 20	World Chess Day (2026 - declared “Year of Chess in Education” by FIDE & International School Chess Federation)
	International Moon Day (Theme - “One Moon, One Vision, One Future”)
July 22	National Flag Day (The day marks the adoption of the Indian national flag on July 22, 1947.)
	Pi Approximation Day (Archimedes, the ancient Greek mathematician, was the first to estimate the value of “Pi (π)”.)
	World Brain Day (Theme - “Brain Health: Access for All”)
	National Mango Day
July 23	National Broadcasting Day (It commemorates the country’s first organized radio broadcast by the Indian Broadcasting Company in Bombay in 1927.)
July 24	167th Income Tax Day (Aaykar Diwas) (It commemorates the formal introduction of income tax in the country on 24 July 1860 by Sir James Wilson.)
July 25	World Drowning Prevention Day (since 2021) (Theme - “Unite to turn the tide”)
	2nd UN International Day for Women and Girls of African Descent
	International Day on Judicial Well-being
	World In Vitro Fertilization Day
July 26	Kargil Vijay Diwas (It commemorates the decisive military victory of the Indian Armed Forces over Pakistan during the 1999 Kargil War under “Operation Vijay”.)
	International day for the Conservation of the Mangrove Ecosystems
July 27	88th Raising Day of Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) (CRPF, established in 1939, is the largest Central Armed Police Force (CAPF) under Ministry of Home Affair. (Official motto - “Service and Loyalty”)
July 28	World Hepatitis Day (Theme - “Hepatitis: Let's break it down”)
	World Nature Conservation Day (since 1997)
July 29	16th Global Tiger Day (since 2011)
July 30	International Day of Friendship (since 2011)
	World Day Against Trafficking in Persons (Theme - “Trapped Behind the Scam”)

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